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7.2+ crore women supported under PM Surakshit Matritva Abhiyan

Sex Ratio at Birth improved from 918 to 929

4.6+ crore Sukanya Samridhi accounts opened

NETANYAHU AUTHORISES NEGOTIATIONS WITH LEBANON

War or peace? US, Iran prepare for talks amid shaky ceasefire

US Vice President JD Vance heads to Pakistan, signals optimism on talks

ASSOCIATED PRESS

DUBAI: Negotiators from Iran and the US prepared for high-level talks with their ceasefire still shaky on Friday, as Israel and Hezbollah traded fire and Tehran maintained its stranglehold on the Strait of Hormuz.

There remain many issues that could derail the truce — as well as negotiations for a broader deal to permanently end the war.

Iran's semiofficial Tasnim news agency, close to the Revolutionary Guard, claimed that talks set for Saturday wouldn't happen unless Israel stopped its attacks in Lebanon. And US President Donald Trump complained that Iran was "doing a very poor job" by not allowing the free flow of ships through the strait, through which 20 per cent of the world's traded oil once passed.

Kuwait, meanwhile, said it faced a drone attack Thursday night that it blamed on Iran and its militia allies in the region. Though Iran's paramilitary Revolutionary Guard denied launching any assault, it has carried out attacks across the Mideast in the past that it did not claim.

And yet, preparations for the talks between Iran and the US appeared to be moving forward, with US Vice President JD Vance heading to Pakistan from Washington. Negotiations between Israel and Lebanon, meanwhile, are expected to begin next week in Washington, according to a US official. **Continued on P4**



Displaced families extend their hands for donated food beside the tents they use as shelters after fleeing Israeli bombardment in southern Lebanon, in Beirut, Lebanon

KEY POINTS

» Israel and Hezbollah continue exchanges, threatening broader truce stability

» Iran links talks to Israel halting Lebanon strikes, Tasnim reports

» Donald Trump criticises Iran over restricted shipping in Strait of Hormuz

» Strait disruption affects global oil flow; once carried 20% of traded oil

» Kuwait reports drone attack, blames Iran and allied militias

» Iran's Revolutionary Guard denies involvement despite past regional strikes

» Vance says US open to "good faith" talks, warns against deception

» Israel excludes Hezbollah front from ceasefire, risking deal collapse

» BEIRUT STRIKES KILLED OVER 300; DEADLIEST DAY SINCE FEBRUARY 28 WHEN WAR STARTED

Quick News

PUTIN DECLARES CEASEFIRE IN UKRAINE FOR EASTER

MOSCOW: Russian President Vladimir Putin on Thursday announced a temporary halt in fighting in Ukraine to coincide with the Orthodox Easter weekend, setting the pause at 32 hours. According to a Kremlin decree, Russian forces are to cease hostilities from 4 pm local time on Saturday until the end of Sunday.

The move follows an earlier proposal by Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky, who suggested both sides refrain from striking each other's energy infrastructure during the holiday. Zelensky said the proposal had been conveyed through the United States, which has been involved in mediation efforts between Moscow and Kyiv as the war enters its fifth year.

Kyiv did not immediately respond to Moscow's announcement. Past ceasefire efforts have yielded limited results. A similar unilateral 30-hour truce declared **Continued on P4**

KHERA GETS ONE WEEK BAIL IN ASSAM CASE

HYDERABAD: The Telangana High Court on Friday granted interim relief to Congress leader Pawan Khera, providing him temporary anticipatory bail for one week in connection with a case filed by Assam Police. The case stems from allegations he made against Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma's wife.

Hearing Khera's petition, Justice Sujana Kalasikam allowed him time to approach the appropriate court. "The petitioner is granted time for one week to file an application before the concerned court," the judge said, while setting conditions for the interim protection.

The case relates to remarks made by Khera on April 5, in which he alleged that Riniki Bhuyan Sarma holds multiple passports and owns foreign property that was not disclosed in the chief minister's election affidavit ahead of the April 9 Assembly polls. Following these claims, a case was registered at Guwahati Crime Branch Police Station under provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, including sections related to false statements in elections and cheating. **Continued on P4**

Mathura: 10 tourists dead as steamer capsizes in Yamuna

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MATHURA: At least 10 tourists, including six women, died and several others remained missing after a steamer carrying pilgrims from Punjab capsized in the Yamuna River near Kesi Ghat in Vrindavan on Friday afternoon, triggering a large-scale rescue operation and raising concerns that the toll could rise further.

The incident occurred around 2:45 pm, about 2.5 km from the Banke Bihari temple, when the vessel, carrying between 30 and 32 passengers, reportedly lost balance midstream. Officials said the tourists were part of a larger group of around 150 pilgrims from Ludhiana and Muktsar districts who had travelled to Vrindavan for darshan. Mathura District Magistrate Chandra Prakash Singh confirmed



Rescue personnel during a search operation in the Yamuna River after a boat carrying pilgrims capsized near Kesi Ghat, in Mathura district, on Friday PTI

that 10 bodies had been recovered. Earlier, authorities had reported six deaths, with four more victims found later during search efforts. Medical officials at Vrindavan Joint Hospital said the deceased included six men and four women. While 16 to 17 passengers were rescued safely, three to four people **Continued on P4**

Qatar vows to remain reliable energy supplier to India

Jaishankar highlights crisis impact, Puri leads efforts to stabilise supplies

MPOST BUREAU

PORT LOUIS: India on Friday intensified its diplomatic and economic outreach amid the West Asia crisis, with External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar voicing concern over escalating tensions, Petroleum Minister Hardeep Singh Puri engaging Qatar to secure energy supplies, and Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal coordinating with Gulf partners to restore disrupted trade flows, as New Delhi pushed for stability, uninterrupted shipping and an early return to normalcy in the region.

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar on Friday described



the situation as "deeply concerning" and reiterated India's firm opposition to attacks on civilians, infrastructure and commercial shipping, while highlighting the broader economic fallout of the

HIGHLIGHTS

» Hardeep Singh Puri visits Qatar to secure energy supplies

» Qatar assures India it will remain a reliable energy supplier

» Qatar supplies 45 percent LNG and 20 percent LPG to India

» Conflict halts Gulf energy exports, causing shortages and rising costs

» Piyush Goyal engages Gulf partners to stabilise trade flows

» India UAE, Kuwait stress restoring supply chains and smooth trade movement

» India Gulf trade valued at USD 178 billion faces major disruption

conflict. His remarks came as uncertainty persisted over a fragile two-week ceasefire between Iran and the United States, announced after Israeli strikes on Lebanon escalated hostilities.

Addressing the Indian Ocean Conference, Jaishankar said countries across the region were facing immediate and long-term consequences of the conflict. **Continued on P4**

India voices concern over mounting civilian casualties in Lebanon

Embassy in Lebanon monitoring citizen safety closely

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India on Friday voiced "deep concern" over reports of mounting civilian casualties in Lebanon.

New Delhi's comments came amid increasing Israeli strikes on Lebanon that triggered uncertainty over the stability of a precarious US-Iran ceasefire agreement. Tehran has been maintaining that Lebanon has been covered under the deal while the US and Israel disputed the Iranian assertion.

At least 300 people were killed in Israeli air strikes on Lebanon on Wednesday, according to Lebanese authorities.

"We are deeply concerned by reports of a large number of civilian casualties in Lebanon," External Affairs ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said at a media briefing.

"As a troop contributing country to the UNIFIL (UN Interim Force in Lebanon) that is invested in Lebanon's peace and security, the direction of events is very disturbing," he said.

"India has always emphasised the protection of civilians as the foremost priority. Observing international law, and respecting sovereignty and territorial integrity of states is essential," he added.

The MEA spokesperson said India continued to reach out to the countries in the Gulf region and referred to the ongoing visit of Petroleum Minister Hardeep Singh Puri to Qatar.

Jaiswal also noted the upcoming visit of External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar to the United Arab Emirates

HIGHLIGHTS

» MEA calls civilian protection the top priority

» India urges adherence to international law and sovereignty

» Randhir Jaiswal terms situation "very disturbing"

» India highlights role as UNIFIL troop-contributing country

that is expected to focus on exchanging views on the West Asia conflict.

India on Thursday had welcomed the two-week ceasefire between the US and Iran and called for unimpeded freedom of navigation and flow of commerce through the Strait of Hormuz while hoping that lasting peace will return to West Asia.

On the precarious security situation in Lebanon, Jaiswal said Indian embassy there remained in close touch with the Indian community for its safety and security.

Earlier this month, India condemned the deadly attacks on UN peacekeepers in southern Lebanon and called for the "inviolability" of the mission.

The reaction had come following the deaths of two Indonesian 'Blue Helmets' that has sparked global concerns over the safety of UN peacekeepers in the conflict zone.

The fatalities occurred against the backdrop of a sharp escalation in cross-border violence between the Israeli Defence Forces (IDF) and Hezbollah.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

OVER 84 LAKH VOTERS ADDED IN FINAL LIST

UP finalises 13.39 crore voters after purge of around 2 crore names

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: Uttar Pradesh has finalised an electorate of 13.39 crore voters following a sweeping revision exercise that combined large-scale deletions with fresh enrolments, reshaping the state's electoral rolls ahead of upcoming elections. The final list, published on April 10 after a 166-day Special Intensive Revision (SIR), reflects a net increase of more than 84 lakh voters even as around two crore names were removed during verification, underscoring both expansion and consolidation in the coun-



try's largest electoral base.

Chief Electoral Officer Navdeep Rinwa said the revision, conducted between Octo-

ber 27, 2025 and April 10, 2026, aimed to improve accuracy by removing duplicate, shifted and unverifiable entries while

ensuring that eligible citizens were added. "If a name present in the draft roll is missing in the final list, it is either due to a Form-6 application or a decision taken by the Electoral Registration Officer after due hearing," he said, adding that no deletion was carried out without following due process.

The final roll places the total number of voters at 13,39,84,792, comprising 7,30,71,071 male voters and 6,09,09,525 female voters, along with 4,206 third gender voters. Compared to the draft roll published on January 6, which **Continued on P4**

CASH DISCOVERY ROW

Allahabad HC judge Yashwant Varma resigns, impeachment process rendered infructuous

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI/ALLAHABAD: Allahabad High Court judge Yashwant Varma resigned with immediate effect on April 9, bringing an abrupt end to rare impeachment proceedings initiated in Parliament over allegations linked to the recovery of burnt currency notes from his Delhi residence last year. Officials said the resignation has rendered the Lok Sabha's removal process "infructuous", halting the inquiry that

had been underway against the 57-year-old judge, who was otherwise due to retire on January 5, 2031.

Justice Varma submitted his resignation in a letter addressed to President Droupadi Murmu, stating he was stepping down with "deep anguish" and calling it an honour to have served as a judge of the Allahabad High Court. Under Article 217 of the Constitution, a high court judge can resign by writing to the President, and such a resignation takes **Continued on P4**

WEAPONS, SIM-BASED DEVICES SEIZED

Pak-ISI espionage module busted, 11 caught; solar CCTV network exposed

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Special Cell of the Delhi Police has busted an inter-state terror, arms and espionage module allegedly backed by handlers from Pakistan and its intelligence agency Inter-Services Intelligence, an official said on Friday.

The team uncovered a covert surveillance network involving solar-powered CCTV cameras installed near sensitive military locations across Punjab and Rajasthan, the official said.

The operation, carried out in two coordinated strikes, led to the arrest of 11 accused and exposed a larger conspiracy linked to the banned outfit Babbar Khalsa International, he said.

The module was engaged in espionage, arms smuggling and reconnaissance of critical defence installations, pos-



ing a serious threat to national security.

Investigations revealed that the accused had installed at least nine solar-powered SIMs in CCTV cameras at strategically significant locations, particularly in areas witnessing frequent movement of Army and paramilitary forces.

"These locations included

Kapurthala, Jalandhar, Pathankot, Patiala and Moga in Punjab, as well as Ambala in Haryana, Kathua in Jammu and Kashmir, and Bikaner and Alwar in Rajasthan," Additional Commissioner of Police (Special Cell) Pramod Singh Kushwah said.

The officer said these locations are considered highly

HIGHLIGHTS

» Accused had installed at least 9 solar-powered SIMs in CCTV cameras at strategically significant locations, particularly in areas witnessing frequent movement of paramilitary forces

» 'These locations included Kapurthala, Jalandhar, Pathankot, Patiala and Moga in Punjab...'

the module was working under direct instructions from Pakistan-based operatives, who were coordinating espionage activities through encrypted communication platforms.

"The accused were tasked with capturing visuals of defence establishments, monitoring troop movements, and relaying critical information across the border," said the Additional CP Kushwah.

He said the installation of solar-powered CCTV cameras near such sensitive zones indicates a well-planned and sustained surveillance attempt aimed at tracking movement patterns of security forces.

Two operations led to 11 arrests in an ISI-linked module; CCTV surveillance, arms network exposed, terror plot foiled, with accused recruited via smuggling proceeds and tasked with espionage.

Delhi plans police posts under flyovers, subways

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In a bid to improve safety and better utilise public infrastructure, the Delhi government plans to set up nearly 300 police posts across flyovers, FOBs and pedestrian subways, PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said on Friday.

The Public Works Department (PWD), which maintains around 106 flyovers, 115 foot overbridges (FOBs) and nearly 70 subways, will construct the proposed police posts for the Delhi Police.

According to the minister, an initial proposal from Delhi Police to set up about 50 posts under flyovers has already been approved.

"While we have approved that proposal, going further, we plan to cover all road assets like flyovers, pedestrian subways, and FOBs, approximately 300 police posts will be set up," Singh said.

In the later phase of the project, PWD is considering allowing commercial establish-



'The objective of this proj is to further provide a sense of security, also to users of subways. After this, we plan to open shops inside subways'

ments inside pedestrian subways, but the proposal has yet to be approved.

"The objective of this project is to further provide a sense of security, also to users of subways. After this, we plan to open shops inside subways," Singh added.

Usually, PWD closes its

subways at night hours, due to safety concerns and deploys security guards at its FOBs to prevent theft of electrical items, officials said.

In July last year, a decision was taken regarding the 'adopt a flyover' project based on the PPP model for cleanliness and better care of road infrastructure.

Recently, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta announced a corporate social responsibility (CSR) initiative inviting private companies to transform spaces beneath six flyovers into clean, organised and visually engaging public areas.

According to officials, the revamp is expected to include landscaped green zones, artistic wall murals, improved sanitation systems, seating facilities and other essential public amenities.

Under the initiative, private firms will be allowed to adopt public infrastructure, taking responsibility for its maintenance, beautification and cleanliness in exchange for limited advertising rights.

HARERA flags violations in Trehan Sector 71 projs

OUR CORRESPONDENT

GURUGRAM: The Haryana Real Estate Regulatory Authority (HARERA) has flagged alleged regulatory violations by M/s Trehan Hospitality & Reality Pvt. Ltd. (THRPL) in its "Trehan Seventy One - A to F" projects in Sector 71.

In an order dated March 30, 2026, the authority recorded a prima facie breach of Section 3 of the Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act, noting that the developer undertook construction, marketing and sale of residential floors without mandatory prior registration.

According to the proceedings, the development spans about 103 plots and around 412 residential floors, with a built-

The dev spans about 103 plots & around 412 residential floors, with a built-up area of nearly 70,000 sq metres—well above the 20,000 sq metre threshold requiring environmental clearances

up area of nearly 70,000 sq metres—well above the 20,000 sq metre threshold requiring environmental clearances. HARERA observed that multiple registration applications appeared to fragment what is effectively a single, contiguous project, potentially to bypass

regulatory requirements.

The authority further noted that construction allegedly proceeded without key approvals, including Environmental Clearance (EC), Consent to Establish (CTE) and Consent to Operate (CTO), alongside possible violations of building norms.

The order also cited inspections by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change and show-cause proceedings by the Haryana State Pollution Control Board.

HARERA has issued a show-cause notice under Section 59(1), proposing a penalty of up to 5 per cent of the estimated Rs 521.66 crore project cost. The developer has been asked to respond within 10 days.

Fake loan app fraud: Two Rapido riders among six apprehended by Delhi Police

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: The Cyber Cell of the Delhi Police has arrested two Rapido drivers for their alleged involvement in a cyber fraud syndicate running fake loan application scams under Operation Cyhawk 4.0.

The accused, identified as Karan Kumar (24) and Shami Ahmad (27), both residents of Kapashera, were apprehended during the ongoing probe. With these arrests, the total number of accused held in the case has risen to six. Police recovered two mobile phones containing incriminating WhatsApp chats.

The action followed an investigation into an FIR registered under Section 112(2) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, relating to online financial



The probe began with the analysis of mule bank accounts used to siphon off defrauded money: Police

fraud through fake loan applications. Four accused had been arrested earlier.

According to police, the probe began with the analysis of mule bank accounts used to siphon off defrauded money. One such account in Bank of Baroda, registered in the name of a Kapashera resident, was found linked to multiple com-

plaints of fake loan app fraud.

Further technical analysis led investigators to another suspicious account in the Bank of India belonging to Karan Kumar, which was also linked to several complaints. A team led by Inspector Praveesh Kaushik traced Kumar in Kapashera using technical surveillance and local inputs.

Yamuna pollution worsened in March: DPCC reports spike in faecal coliform & BOD levels

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Pollution Control Committee's (DPCC) latest data on the water quality status of the Yamuna for March shows a further rise in the faecal coliform levels, as compared to the months of January and February, indicating that a significant amount of untreated sewage is entering the river.

The report also shows high levels of Biological Oxygen Demand (BOD), a measure of the amount of dissolved oxygen required by microorganisms to break down organic matter in water -- a higher BOD value indicates higher levels of pollution, often leading to oxygen depletion and harm to



aquatic life.

The water quality testing by DPCC involves collecting water samples from eight locations along the course of the Yamuna through the capital, measuring several parameters such as BOD, dissolved oxygen, chemical oxygen demand, pH, and faecal coliform, to determine pollution level.

These eight locations include Palla, Wazirabad, ISBT Bridge, ITO Bridge, Nizamuddin Bridge, Hindon Cut, Okhla Barrage and Asgarpur in Kidwali, Haryana.

The March report shows faecal coliform levels as high as 400,000 Most Probable Number per 100 millilitres (MPN/100 ml) at Asgarpur,

which far exceeds the permissible limit of 2,500 and the desirable level of 500.

The level at the same site was 350,000 MPN/100 ml in January and 92,000 MPN/100 ml in February 2026.

Among the eight locations, only one has shown improvement since January. The faecal coliform level at ISBT Bridge was recorded at 160,000 MPN/100 ml, as compared to 110,000 MPN/100 ml in February and 220,000 MPN/100 ml in January. Coliform levels rose again in March at several sites, while BOD breached norms up to 60 mg/l; activists flagged delays in DPCC data on river pollution monitoring. PII

25-yr-old fatally stabbed over love-linked dispute

Faridabad: A 25-year-old man was allegedly stabbed to death following an altercation with three youths outside a hotel near the Badarpur border under Sarai Khawaja police station area here, an official said on Friday.

It is suspected that the attack was prompted by a love affair linked dispute, he added. The police have detained a young man and a woman in this connection, claiming the main accused who stabbed the deceased has been arrested.

The main accused was identified as Sunny, a resident of Badoli village in Haryana's Palwal, and residing in Santosh Nagar in Faridabad. The knife used in the crime has

also been recovered.

The family of the deceased, however, alleged two police personnel from the Sarai Khawaja police station were present when the incident took place, claiming that the cops failed to intervene during the incident, but later took the man who stabbed him into custody.

According to police, the deceased -- Sachin Mehra, a resident of Surya Vihar colony under Palla police station -- worked as a sweeper at a private hospital. Sachin was stabbed to death outside a hotel by Sunny after a dispute over a woman; two accused fled. Police arrested Sunny, launched raids, and registered an FIR. MPOST

He said the child's mother fed him, after which he stepped out again, saying he was going to visit his aunt who lived nearby.

Vipin further said he worked as a mason and was engaged in construction work near the farmhouse along with the child's father, identified as Bengali Majhi. The family had been staying in the area for the past three months after moving to the capital from Bihar's Bhagalpur in search of work.

"He would usually move around between the houses and come to the work site to play. He was familiar with the area," he added.

After the child went missing, family found his clothes near a farmhouse pool; his body was later recovered. Police have registered a case against the owner, probing possible safety lapses. PII

Fake visa-job racket busted; 3 held: Cops

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police has busted an interstate cyber fraud racket that duped people under the pretext of providing overseas jobs and visa services, arresting three people, an official said on Friday.

The accused have been identified as Nand Kishor Prasad, Ahmad Hayat Khan and Mustaq Khan. Police identified Shadab, also known as

Mohd Khusnood, as the mastermind who generated leads through online platforms; however, he is absconding.

Police arrested a suspect in Rani Bagh for running a fake overseas job scam, luring victims via social media and collecting Rs 15,000-90,000; multiple victims were duped before contact was cut off, and devices, passports and forged visa documents were seized during the raid.



On April 9, the Green Circle of Delhi hosted its annual fellowship lunch for Lodhi Garden staff, marking the garden's 90th year with all 90 gardeners present MPOST

EV registrations jump 29% in Capital, petrol vehicles still dominate: Analysis

Hybrids surge, diesel declines as market mix gradually shifts

NEW DELHI: The national capital saw a 29 per cent rise in electric vehicle registrations in 2025-26 compared to the previous year, while petrol vehicle registrations continued to grow, data analysed by EnviroCatalysts has showed.

Experts say the new electric vehicle (EV) policy and recent trends point to a further increase in EV purchases in the coming years.

An analysis of data from the Vahan dashboard of the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways by EnviroCatalysts, an independent research body, showed that EV registrations rose from 83,512 in 2024-25 to 1.07 lakh in 2025-26. EV hybrid vehicles also recorded an increase, rising from 6,796 to 8,476 during the same period.



At the same time, conventional fuel segments continued to expand. Petrol and petrol-ethanol vehicles increased from around 5.30 lakh in 2024-25 to about 6.21 lakh in 2025-26, indicating that even as cleaner technologies gain ground, polluting fuel-based vehicles still account for a significant share of total registrations.

Among other segments, CNG vehicle registrations rose from 25,330 to 32,224, reflecting a continued shift towards relatively cleaner fossil fuel options. In contrast, diesel

CNG vehicle registrations rose from 25,330 to 32,224

vehicles declined from 12,007 to 11,498, marking one of their lowest levels since 2019.

Fossil hybrid vehicles recorded the sharpest growth, more than doubling from 15,804 to 32,902, even as they remain dependent on conventional fuels. Meanwhile, petrol-CNG vehicles declined from 47,192 to 36,130, while vehicles under the 'other fuels' category saw only a marginal increase from 20 to 23.

Looking at broader trends, experts said petrol and petrol-

ethanol vehicle growth could moderate in the coming years as policy push and consumer preference increasingly favour electric mobility.

Sunil Dahiya of EnviroCatalysts said that diesel registrations declined while petrol registrations remained largely consistent with the previous year, indicating that although electric vehicle adoption has grown significantly, it has not yet substantially reduced the share of petrol and CNG vehicles in overall registrations.

EV growth remains strong but has not dented petrol and CNG volumes; new policy incentives, scrappage benefits and tax exemptions aim to boost adoption, while overall registrations rise and conventional fuels continue to dominate. PII

City Briefs

RS 25 LAKH ROBBED FROM TRADER IN NORTHWEST DELHI; INVESTIGATION ON

NEW DELHI: A 47-year-old trader was allegedly robbed of Rs 25 lakh by two bike-borne men in northwest Delhi's Subhash Place area, police said on Friday. The victim, Mangal Sen, was intercepted, overpowered and robbed while returning on his motorcycle. A PCR call alerted police, who reached the spot. A case has been registered, and CCTV footage is being scanned to identify the accused.

BIKE-BORNE ASSAILANTS FIRE SHOTS; ROB MAN, GRANDSON OF RS 1 LAKH

NEW DELHI: Two motorcycle-borne assailants allegedly fired in the air and robbed a man and his grandfather of around Rs 1 lakh in east Delhi's Madhu Vihar on April 9, police said on Friday. The incident occurred near a banquet hall in Joshi Colony when the family returned home from Noida and had just alighted from their vehicle. The accused threatened them with a firearm, snatched a bag containing cash and fled. A family member briefly chased them, hitting their motorcycle. The assailants escaped on foot, abandoning the bag and weapon, both later recovered. An FIR has been registered.

STUDENTS, FACULTY JOIN DRIVE

Rekha Gupta backs Nari Shakti Vandan Act at Delhi Univ drive

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a strong push for gender-inclusive governance, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Friday joined a signature campaign at Delhi University's Arts Faculty in support of the Nari Shakti Vandan Act, calling for a greater role for women in decision-making across political and administrative spaces.

Addressing students, teachers and citizens gathered at the campus, Gupta emphasised that meaningful societal transformation hinges on women occupying leadership roles. "Meaningful change can only happen when women occupy decision-making positions, enabling them to address issues that directly affect society, families and their own lives," she said, underlining the need for structural reforms to ensure equal participation. The Chief Minister described the Nari Shakti Vandan Act as a watershed moment in India's democratic journey. "Nari Shakti



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, centre, interacts with faculty at DU PTI

Vandan Act will mark a new chapter in political representation," she stated, while expressing gratitude to Prime Minister Narendra Modi for enabling its passage. She added that the legislation builds on earlier initiatives aimed at empowering the girl child, saying it carries forward the vision from "Beti Bachao" to "Beti Badhao". Highlighting the Delhi government's efforts in promoting women's empowerment, Gupta

pointed to flagship schemes such as 'Lakhpati Bitiya' and 'Anmol'. She noted that these initiatives reflect a governance approach rooted in inclusivity and sensitivity. "Schemes like 'Lakhpati Bitiya' and 'Anmol' are strengthening women's empowerment and social security," she said. The campaign at the university also resonated with strong messages advocating women's leadership, with slogans such

CLOSER LOOK

» Addressing students, teachers and citizens gathered at the campus, Gupta emphasised that meaningful societal transformation hinges on women occupying leadership roles

» 'Meaningful change can only happen when women occupy decision-making positions, enabling them to address issues that directly affect society, families...'

as 'It's time for women to lead' and 'Empowered women, prosperous nation' drawing attention from participants. A large number of students and faculty members took part in the drive, lending their support to the cause.

Tracing the historical roots of the demand for women's political representation, Gupta noted that the movement dates back to 1931. She said the enactment of the law

in 2023 marks the culmination of decades-long efforts. "The demand for greater political representation for women has been decades in the making... ensuring its effective implementation is now a collective responsibility," she said, urging the youth to take ownership of the initiative.

Calling for wider public participation, the Chief Minister encouraged people to support the campaign and help transform it into a mass movement. "True democratic strength lies in equal participation in decision-making," she remarked, expressing confidence that the legislation would lead to a more balanced and progressive democracy.

Participants could register support via missed call, expanding outreach. Gupta later interacted with students and women faculty, stressing accessible dialogue. The visit highlighted focus on grassroots engagement and commitment to advancing women's representation in governance.

'Delhi has natural advantage to emerge as centre of arbitration'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

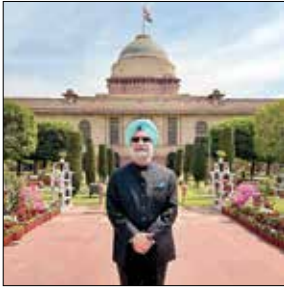
NEW DELHI: Concentration of institutional, legal and commercial activity provides Delhi a natural advantage in emerging as a centre of arbitration and legal services, Lt Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu said on Friday.

Addressing the International Conference on "Arbitration in the era of Globalisation", Sandhu said the development of Delhi as a global arbitration hub is not merely a matter of infrastructure but of institutional alignment and sustained policy support.

He said Delhi holds a unique position in the arbitration ecosystem for being home to key institutions such as the Supreme Court, Central Ministries, regulatory authorities, diplomatic missions, the presence of leading law firms and arbitration practitioners.

"This concentration of institutional, legal and commercial activity provides Delhi with a natural advantage in emerging as a centre of arbitration and legal services," he said.

Sandhu described arbitration as not just an alternative mechanism of dispute resolution but an essential pillar of



TAKEAWAYS

» Delhi holds a unique position in the arbitration ecosystem for being home to key institutions such as the SC, Central Ministries, regulatory authorities, diplomatic missions, the presence of leading law firms and arbitration practitioners

» 'This concentration of institutional, legal and commercial activity provides Delhi with a natural advantage in emerging as a centre of arbitration and legal services,' L-G stated

global commerce.

Its value lies in three core

attributes -neutrality, predictability and enforceability, he pointed out in the context of India's emergence as an economic powerhouse.

"As India continues to expand its role in the global economy, the importance of reliable dispute resolution systems becomes even more critical," he stated.

The LG said India is increasingly pursuing a policy of multi-alignment, engaging with multiple partners across regions while advancing its own national interests.

"Investors today look beyond market opportunities. They seek assurance of stability, consistency and trust in the institutional framework," he said, highlighting the role of conference organiser Indian Council of Arbitration (ICA).

He said the ICA is well placed to act not just as an administrator of disputes but also as a driver of institutional excellence.

It can contribute to building global confidence in India as a credible arbitration destination by promoting best practices, enhancing procedural efficiency and fostering greater alignment with international standards.

Rekha Gupta clears slum housing & gig worker welfare plans at DUSIB meeting

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Friday chaired the 35th board meeting of the Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board (DUSIB), clearing key proposals on slum rehabilitation, gig worker welfare and urban infrastructure, while reiterating the government's focus on inclusive development.

Highlighting the broader vision, Gupta said, "Dignified housing, food and a better life for every needy citizen is our goal," adding that efforts are underway to build a system that supports workers and vulnerable sections.

A major decision was the rollout of resting centres and



'The aim is to make life easier for those who work tirelessly across the city,' she said, noting that the idea emerged from direct interactions with workers

public utility hubs for gig workers and labourers across the city. These facilities will be integrated with Atal Canteens to provide food, rest and essential services under one roof. "The aim is to make life easier for those who work tirelessly across the city," she said, noting that the idea emerged from direct interactions with workers.

The Atal Canteen scheme will also be revamped, with 100 centres being reorganised and revised meal timings introduced, lunch from 10:30 am to 2:00 pm and dinner from 6:00 pm to 9:30 pm.

On housing, the board approved allotment of EWS flats in Savda-Ghevra to 717 slum dwellers, including residents from Bhai Ram Camp,

Masjid Camp and DID Camp. Financial assistance of Rs.1.12 lakh per beneficiary will be provided, while allottees will contribute Rs.30,000 towards maintenance. Infrastructure upgrades also received a push, including repair of 1,060 EWS flats in Sultanpuri and development works for 7,400 flats in Bhalswa. Several housing units in Dwarka Sector 16-B will also be made habitable.

In an administrative step to speed up execution, the financial powers of the DUSIB CEO were increased from Rs.3 crore to Rs.10 crore. Gupta stressed timely implementation, stating, "The goal is not just to roll out schemes, but to make sure they translate into real change on the ground."

NEW DELHI: In a move aimed at streamlining digital governance, the Delhi government has decided to divide its existing eOffice system into three distinct platforms catering separately to government departments, public sector undertakings (PSUs), and academic institutions. The decision follows an official advisory issued recently.

At present, the eOffice system, developed by the National Informatics Centre (NIC), functions as a unified digital workspace for all entities under the Government of NCT of Delhi (GNCTD).

Officials said the restructuring is designed to improve efficiency, reduce system load, and strengthen data

'Each of these platforms will function independently, with separate digital infra'

management across different categories of users.

As part of the transition, two new dedicated platforms will be introduced. One will cater to PSUs, autonomous bodies, and local institutions, while another will be exclusively designed for universities and academic organisations. The current platform will continue to support core government departments.

According to officials, each of these platforms will function independently, with separate digital infrastructure, allowing better scalability and smoother

operations. The move is also expected to enhance cybersecurity by isolating data environments and reducing vulnerabilities associated with a single, shared system.

The Department of Information Technology (DIT) has been tasked with executing the technical aspects of the transition, including splitting the system and ensuring secure migration of existing records to the respective platforms. Officials noted that this step would significantly ease congestion on the system, which has grown with increasing

usage across sectors.

However, users may face temporary disruptions during the migration phase. The advisory has asked all departments, PSUs, and academic institutions to complete urgent tasks before 6:00 pm on April 10, as eOffice services will be briefly suspended.

The government has outlined a phased restoration plan. Services on the primary platform for government departments will resume on April 13.

The PSU and local bodies platform will go live on April 15, followed by the academic platform on April 17; officials expect faster processing, smoother workflows and stronger digital governance. **MPOST**

L-G flags rising narco-terror threat

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Lieutenant Governor Tranjit Singh Sandhu on Friday highlighted the growing threat of narco-terrorism, calling for a coordinated, multi-dimensional response to tackle its expanding global footprint.

Addressing the International Conference on Counter-terroring Narco-Terrorism organised by Indic Researchers Forum, the LG described the global narcotics trade as one of the largest illicit economies, generating hundreds of billions of dollars annually and rivaling several formal sectors in scale.

He underlined that the impact of this trade extends well beyond economics. The financial flows linked to narcotics, he said, are closely intertwined with networks of money laundering, organised crime and terror financing, posing serious challenges to governance and national security.

Highlighting the growing nexus between drugs and terrorism, Sandhu noted that trafficking has emerged as a steady funding source for non-state actors, complicating counter-terror efforts both in India and globally.

Drawing attention to emerging domestic trends, he flagged increasing evidence of synthetic drug manufacturing, including methamphetamine and other amphetamine-type stimulants. Rising seizures across regions, he said, suggest a shift from India being a transit route to a potential production and distribution hub.

The LG also raised concerns over substance abuse among youth and its broader social and economic impact, including pressure on public health systems and workforce productivity.

MCD begins monsoon desilting

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi has targeted to remove 1.41 lakh metric tonnes of silt from drains by June 30 as part of its annual desilting exercise from city drains ahead of the monsoon, officials said on Friday.

The civic body has allocated a budget of approximately Rs 36 crore for the exercise this year, covering around 545 km of drains that are wider than four feet in the national capital, they said.

According to the officials, about 16 per cent of the desilting work has been completed so far, while most of the tenders for the project have already been awarded.

MCD's department of environment management services committee chairman Sandeep Kapoor said that the silt removed in the city is being

tracked on a daily basis, and the corporation is trying to fast-track the exercise.

"We are hopeful that we will be able to achieve our desilting targets in a timely manner, as work has been allocated and is being tracked, and officials have been instructed to adhere to the determined timeline," Kapoor said, adding that debris collected on the side of the road is also being collected in a timely manner.

There are close to 13,000 drains with a depth of less than four feet, having a combined length of approximately 6,000 km, which are desilted throughout the year, the officials said.

MCD's three-month desilting drive spans 40 divisions; 793 major drains targeted, with silt to be cleared and dumped weekly. **MPOST**

Delhi speeds up drain cleaning as min reviews monsoon preps

NEW DELHI: In a major step towards tackling chronic waterlogging, Delhi's Irrigation and Flood Control (IFCD) Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh on Friday inspected desilting work at the Delhi Gate and Barapulla drains, highlighting intensified efforts to prepare the capital for the monsoon.

A key highlight of the inspection was the opening of the Delhi Gate drain, which had remained covered for nearly four decades. The slab-covered structure had long hindered proper cleaning, contributing to recurring flooding in surrounding areas. Officials have now begun dismantling the slabs to enable comprehensive desilting and restore the drain's full capacity.



According to the minister, desilting at the Delhi Gate drain has crossed 70 per cent, with over 21,000 metric tonnes of silt already removed. Work is progressing rapidly with visible deployment of machinery and labour on site.

At the Barapulla drain, another major drainage channel, nearly 78 per cent of desilting has been completed, with more than 31,000 metric tonnes of silt cleared so far.

Reviewing the broader progress, Singh said that of the 77 identified IFCD drains, around 50 per cent desilting has been completed, removing over 14 lakh metric tonnes of silt against a target of 28 lakh metric tonnes.

"This is not just about cleaning drains, it is about correcting years of neglect and ensuring that Delhi is prepared before the rains arrive," Singh said. "The Delhi Gate drain, which remained covered for nearly 40 years, is now finally being opened and cleaned properly."

He stressed urgency in desilting, saying work is being done seriously; improved drainage is expected to ease waterlogging in key areas before monsoon. **MPOST**

DMRC survey till May 10

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) will roll out an online Customer Satisfaction Survey from April 13 to May 10, as part of an international benchmarking exercise aimed at assessing commuter experience and improving services.

The survey is being conducted by the Transport Strategic Centre (TSC), London, which manages the COMET benchmarking group of metro systems worldwide. According to the official announcement, the initiative seeks to gather detailed feedback from passengers on various aspects of metro operations.

Officials said, "The primary aim of this survey is to know what the Metro commuters think about various aspects of Metro operations, including

feedback and suggestions on improving the quality of service." The exercise is part of a global effort where metro networks compare performance and adopt best practices.

Commuters can participate by visiting the official DMRC website and filling out the survey form, which will be available in both English and Hindi. The questionnaire covers key service parameters such as availability, accessibility, ease of use, information before and during travel, reliability, customer care, comfort, crowding, security and overall satisfaction. The survey will help DMRC benchmark services globally, understand commuter expectations and adopt best practices; officials urged wide participation to ensure comprehensive, representative feedback and improve service quality across the network.

Delhi to open 10-bed TB centre

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In a significant step to strengthen tuberculosis care, the Delhi government has announced the development of a District TB Centre and Chest Clinic at the Rural Health Training Centre (RHTC) in Najafgarh, aimed at improving access to diagnosis and treatment in South West Delhi.

The upcoming facility, to be developed under the National Tuberculosis Elimination Programme (NTEP), will include a 10-bed indoor patient department (IPD) catering to both drug-sensitive and drug-resistant TB patients. Officials said the centre will provide integrated services, including specialist consultations and advanced diagnostics, under one roof.

Health Minister Dr. Pan-kaj Kumar Singh said, "The Delhi Government is strengthening last-mile healthcare by developing a dedicated TB



Centre at Najafgarh, ensuring timely diagnosis, quality treatment, and better outcomes for patients across South West Delhi."

Najafgarh serves a large rural population of around 3-4 lakh residents, including nearby areas such as Nangli, Sakrawati and Dharampura. Currently, many patients travel to RTRM Hospital in Jaffarpur for treatment. The new centre is expected to reduce this burden by offering services closer to home.

Highlighting the broader vision, Singh said, "By integrating advanced diagnostic support, dedicated indoor beds, and specialist care under one roof, we are ensuring that no patient is left behind due to distance or lack of resources."

The announcement comes alongside intensified efforts under the TB Mukta Bharat Abhiyaan 2.0. In a 15-day campaign from March 24 to April 9, the government conducted 432 screening camps, covering over 38,800 individuals. During this period, 3,760 TB cases were identified through extensive testing, including X-rays and NAAT tests.

Officials added that the new centre will utilise CBNAAT and TrueNat technologies for rapid detection, including drug-resistant TB, strengthening the continuum of care.

The initiative reflects the government's push to expand accessible and quality healthcare while accelerating progress towards a TB-free Delhi.

AT LEAST 10 DEAD AND SEVERAL MISSING

UP boat capsize: Video shows pilgrims in devotional spirit before tragedy hit

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MATHURA: Moments before tragedy struck, the group of pilgrims from Punjab whose boat overturned in Vrindavan were seen clapping, chanting “Radhe Radhe” and soaking in the spiritual atmosphere on the Yamuna.

A purported video now circulating widely captures the final carefree moments -- smiling faces surrounded by the calm waters of the river. Soon, disaster unfolded near Kesi Ghat, leaving at least 10 people dead and several others missing.

The visuals have also raised serious safety concerns, as none of the 30-odd passengers on board the motorised boat appeared to be wearing life jackets, with some survivors alleging the boat was crammed with people well beyond its capacity.

Officials and eyewitness



Locals gather along the Yamuna riverbank during a search operation after a boat carrying pilgrims capsized near Kesi Ghat, in Mathura district, Friday

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The visuals have also raised serious safety concerns, as none of the 30-odd passengers on board the motorised boat appeared to be wearing life jackets
- » Officials and eyewitness accounts suggest basic safety measures were ignored, which proved fatal

accounts suggest basic safety measures were ignored, which proved fatal.

The boat, carrying pilgrims largely from Ludhiana, Muktsar and Jagraon in Punjab and a few from Hisar in Haryana, reportedly sank in the deep waters between Kesi Ghat and Banshi Vat after hitting a float-

ing pontoon.

Most of those on board were part of a larger group of over 100 pilgrims. Families and relatives were together for what was meant to be a spiritual outing.

Survivors said the signs of danger were visible, but ignored.

“We told the boatman two to three times to slow down,” recalled a young survivor. “The wind was strong, and the boat was moving too fast. But he didn’t listen.”

According to him, around 25 to 27 people were crammed into the boat, far beyond its reported capacity of about 15.

None of them was given a life jacket.

As the boat approached a pontoon bridge, passengers again warned the boatman to stop. “We could see the bridge ahead and asked him to slow down. Twice, the boat narrowly avoided hitting it. The third time, it crashed,” another survivor said.

The boat lost balance after hitting the pontoon and overturned, throwing everyone into the deep waters, estimated to be around 30 feet deep.

“There was chaos. People screaming, struggling to stay afloat,” the survivor said. “We kept shouting for help, asking someone to call divers.

Rescue, when it came, was led not just by official teams but by nearby boatmen, workers repairing the pontoon bridge and locals. Some survivors credit these locals and divers for pulling them out of the river in time.

Man kills pregnant wife, two daughters, to marry minor girl

OUR CORRESPONDENT

HYDERABAD: A 29-year-old man, who has allegedly murdered his pregnant wife and two daughters by pushing them into a swimming pool in Hanumakonda district of Telangana, was arrested on Friday, police said.

The man allegedly committed this crime on April 1 so that he could marry a minor girl, who is his relative, so that he believed he could sire a male child, they added.

Nine other suspects, including his family members, a doctor and a nurse, were arrested as the slain woman had allegedly been subjected to abortion twice in the past, said police

Nine other suspects, including his family members, a doctor and a nurse, were arrested as the slain woman had allegedly been subjected to abortion twice in the past, said police

who carried out the abortion and another who performed the sex-determination test— are absconding, police said. According to police, the man, on the pretext of offering ice cream, took his wife (26 years old) and their daughters to a swimming pool and allegedly pushed the woman first, followed by the children, into the pool. All three drowned.

Police further said the man fell in love with a minor girl, a relative. However, as he was already married, the girl initially rejected his proposals.

He subsequently coerced

her into agreeing to marry him by threatening to kill her if she refused. Convinced that the minor girl would continue to reject his love because he already had a wife and children, the man resolved to eliminate them, the police said.

Subsequently, when his wife became pregnant again in March this year, he and his parents quarrelled with her, pressuring her to undergo an abortion out of fear that she might give birth to a girl child again.

However, as she refused to undergo the abortion despite their repeated insistence, the man resolved to kill both her and the children so that he could marry again and beget a male child, police said.

Explaining the gory details of the incident, police said after all the customers at the swimming pool had left, he switched off the lights and disconnected the CCTV at the pool premises and later picked up his wife and two daughters in his car, and drove them to the swimming pool.

From Page 1

War or peace? US, Iran

Boarding Air Force Two on his way to Pakistan, Vance said he believes negotiation with Iran will be “positive.” “We’re looking forward to the negotiation. I think it’s gonna be positive. We’ll, of course, see,” Vance said.

He cited Trump in saying, “If the Iranians are willing to negotiate in good faith, we’re certainly willing to extend the open hand.” But he added, “If they’re gonna try and play us, then they’re gonna find that the negotiating team is not that receptive.” Israel’s insistence that the ceasefire in Iran does not include a pause in its fighting with Hezbollah, which joined the war in support of its backer, Iran, has threatened to scupper the deal.

The day the truce was announced, Israel pounded Beirut with airstrikes, killing more than 300 people, according to Lebanon’s Health Ministry. It was the deadliest day in the country since the war began Feb. 28.

Trump said Thursday that he has asked Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu to dial back the strikes. Early Friday, Israel’s military said it hit approximately 10 launchers in Lebanon that had fired rockets toward northern Israel a day earlier.

Iran’s parliament speaker, Mohammad Bagher Qalibaf, warned Thursday that continued Israeli attacks on Hezbollah would bring “explicit costs and STRONG responses.”

Netanyahu, meanwhile, said that he authorised the negotiations with Lebanon “as soon as possible” with the aim of disarming Hezbollah militants and establishing relations between the neighbours, which have technically been at war since Israel was established in 1948.

In a first statement since Israel announced direct negotiations with Lebanon, Hezbollah chief Naim Kassem urged Lebanese officials to stop offering “free concessions” but did not take a clear stance on the talks.

Iran’s closure of the Strait of Hormuz has sent oil prices skyrocketing, driven stocks down and roiled the world economy. Tehran’s control over the waterway has proved to be its biggest strategic advantage in the war.

The spot price of Brent crude, the international standard, was around USD 97 Friday, up more than 30 per cent since the war started.

Before the conflict, over 100 ships passed through the strait each day — many carrying oil to Asia. With the ceasefire in place, only 12 have been recorded passing through.

The head of the United Arab Emirates’ major oil company, Sultan al-Jaber, said some 230 ships loaded with oil were waiting to get through the strait and must be allowed “to navigate this corridor without condition.”

Trump complained about that situation, writing on his social media platform: “Iran is doing a very poor job, dishonourable some would say, of allowing Oil to go through the Strait of Hormuz.”

“That is not the agreement we have!” Trump wrote of the trickle of ships Iran has allowed to pass.

Questions also remain over the fate of Iran’s missile and nuclear programs, which the US and Israel sought to eliminate in going to war.

The US insists Iran must never be able to build nuclear weapons and wants to remove Tehran’s stockpile of highly enriched uranium, which could be used to make them. Iran insists its programme is peaceful.

Trump has said that the US would work with Iran to remove the uranium, though Tehran has not confirmed that.

The chief of Iran’s nuclear agency, Mohammad Eslami, said Thursday that protecting Tehran’s right to enrich uranium is “necessary” for any ceasefire talks.

More than 3,000 people have been killed in Iran, a top Iranian medical officer told the state-run Iran newspaper. Iran’s government has not provided any definitive death toll from the weeklong war.

In Lebanon, more than 1,888 people have been killed, and 1 million have been displaced. Over a dozen people have died in Gulf Arab states and the occupied West Bank, while 23 civilians were killed in Israel. Thirteen US service members have also been killed.

Mathura

were still unaccounted for, though initial reports suggested that more than 10 could be missing.

Eyewitness accounts pointed to strong winds as a key factor behind the accident. Manohar Lal, a tourist from Jagraon, said the boat began swaying due to high wind speed before going out of control. Weather data from private forecaster Skymet indicated wind speeds of around 31 km per hour at the time, contributing to turbulent river conditions.

According to officials, the vessel may have collided with a floating pontoon drum left behind after a temporary pontoon bridge in the area was dismantled due to rising water levels. The impact is believed to have caused the steamer to overturn. Some witnesses also said the boat struck part of the pontoon structure before capsizing.

Rescue operations were launched immediately, involving personnel from the State Disaster Response Force, fire services, civil defence teams, police and local authorities. Around 50 local divers joined the search, with one diver, identified as Gulab, stating that nearly 15 people had been pulled from the river, some in critical condition. National Disaster Response Force teams were also being mobilised to assist.

Senior officials, including the district magistrate, superintendent of police and other administrative and police officers, remained at the site to oversee ongoing efforts. Additional Director General of Police Anupam Kulshreshtha and other senior officials were also present to coordinate operations.

Authorities are also investigating reports of another boat possibly missing in the area. The exact number of passengers onboard the ill-fated vessel is still being verified.

Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath expressed grief over the loss of lives, calling the incident deeply distressing. He conveyed condolences to the families of the victims and instructed officials to expedite rescue efforts and ensure proper medical care for the injured.

Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann spoke with Adityanath and assured that all necessary assistance would be extended to the affected families. He confirmed that many of those onboard were from Jagraon.

Meanwhile, the Ludhiana administration set up dedicated control rooms to assist families seeking information and dispatched special teams of civil and police officials to Vrindavan to support relief operations.

UP finalises

had 12,55,56,025 voters, the electorate grew by 84,28,767. The increase includes 42,27,902 male voters, 42,00,778 female voters and 87 third gender voters.

A notable feature of the revision is the surge in young voters. The number of electors aged 18 to 19 rose sharply from 3,33,981 in the draft roll to 17,63,360 in the final list, an increase of 14,29,379. Despite the jump, this age group accounts

for about 1.32 per cent of the total electorate. The gender ratio also improved from 824 to 834 female voters per 1,000 male voters, indicating a gradual narrowing of the gap.

Officials described the verification process as one of the most extensive undertaken in the state. Around 1.04 crore voters were identified as “non-mapped” during field checks, while 2.22 crore entries showed logical discrepancies. After notices were issued starting January 14 and hearings conducted between January 31 and March 27, a substantial number of such entries were removed, leading to the deletion of roughly two crore names.

The exercise covered all 75 districts, 403 assembly constituencies and polling stations statewide. It involved 75 district election officers, 403 electoral registration officers, 12,758 assistant EROs, 18,026 booth-level officer supervisors and 1,77,516 booth-level officers. In addition, 5,82,877 booth-level agents from recognised political parties participated in the process, alongside extensive public cooperation and awareness campaigns across media platforms.

Political parties were engaged throughout the revision, with five formal meetings held between October 2025 and January 2026 and 904 meetings conducted at the district level. A total of 107 memoranda were submitted by parties, including 85 from the Samajwadi Party, 10 from the Bharatiya Janata Party and nine from the Congress, among others. Officials said all complaints raised were addressed during the process.

Regionally, Prayagraj recorded the highest increase in voters at 3,29,421, followed by Lucknow with 2,85,961, Bareilly with over 2,57,000, Ghaziabad with 2,43,666 and Jaunpur with 2,37,590. At the assembly segment level, Sahibabad in Ghaziabad saw the largest rise with 82,898 additional voters, followed by Jaunpur (Assembly segment 366) with 56,118. Lucknow West, Loni and Firozabad also reported significant increases.

Rinwa said the scale of participation reflected coordinated efforts by election authorities, political stakeholders and voters. He also outlined a grievance redressal mechanism, noting that individuals dissatisfied with decisions can file a first appeal before the district magistrate within 15 days of the final roll’s publication, and a second appeal before the Chief Electoral Officer within 30 days of the district authority’s decision.

With 13.39 crore registered voters, Uttar Pradesh remains the country’s most consequential electoral arena, where even small changes in voter composition can influence outcomes across constituencies.

Yashwant Varma

immediate effect if no future date is specified.

The case against Justice Varma stemmed from an incident on the night of March 14, 2025, when a fire broke out at his official Lutyens’ Delhi residence around 11:35 pm during Holi. Firefighters responding to the blaze reportedly discovered a large quantity of burnt currency notes at the premises. At the time, he was serving as a judge of the Delhi High Court and was later repatriated to the Allahabad High Court following the controversy.

A multi-party impeachment motion against him had been admitted in the Lok Sabha on August 12, triggering a formal inquiry under the Judges (Inquiry) Act. A three-member committee comprising Supreme Court judge Justice Aravind Kumar, Madras High Court Chief Justice Manindra Mohan Shrivastava, and senior advocate B V Acharya was tasked with investigating the allegations.

However, Justice Varma withdrew from the inquiry shortly before resigning, writing to the panel that his continued participation would legitimise a process that required him to “answer the unanswerable” question about the source of the

money. In a detailed 13-page communication, he described himself as the target of a “vilification campaign” based on what he called unfounded allegations.

He argued that no evidence had been presented to establish that the cash belonged to him or was placed in the storeroom with his knowledge. He also claimed procedural lapses, alleging that 27 of 54 witnesses who did not testify against him were dropped without explanation. According to him, the inquiry relied on presumptions rather than proof and reversed the burden of establishing guilt.

Justice Varma further stated that he was not present at the residence when the fire occurred, as he was on a planned vacation, and questioned the logic of storing cash in such a location. “The alleged facts defy ordinary logic and common sense,” he said, adding that continuing with the proceedings would be unfair both to him and to the institution.

Earlier, then-Chief Justice of India Sanjiv Khanna had advised him to resign following adverse findings in an in-house inquiry, and later wrote to the President recommending his removal after the judge declined to step down. The Supreme Court had also dismissed Justice Varma’s challenge to the impeachment process on January 16, holding that legal provisions could not be used to stall parliamentary proceedings.

Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla confirmed that a committee had been constituted after the motion was admitted, but noted that the status of the resignation would be known only to the President’s office. Legal experts pointed out that by resigning, Justice Varma remains entitled to post-retirement benefits, including pension, which would have been forfeited if he had been removed by Parliament. With his resignation, he ceases to hold constitutional office, leaving open the possibility of criminal proceedings if the government chooses to pursue them.

The resignation also places Justice Varma alongside a small group of judges, including V Ramaswami and Soumitra Sen, who stepped down amid impeachment proceedings, underscoring the rarity and gravity of such cases in India’s judicial history.

Putin declares

by Russia during last year’s Easter saw both sides accuse each other of violations.

In its statement, the Kremlin said orders had been issued “to cease hostilities in all directions,” while instructing troops to remain ready to respond to “possible provocations” or aggressive actions. It added that Russia expects Ukraine to follow suit.

Despite intermittent ceasefire declarations, Russia has rejected a broader 30-day truce backed by Washington and Kyiv. Negotiations have stalled, and fighting continues along a roughly 1,250-km front line.

AGENCIES

Khera gets

Khera, who filed his plea on April 7, listed Hyderabad as his residence and sought protection from arrest. Appearing for him, Congress MP and senior advocate Abhishek Singhvi alleged political vendetta by the Assam government, remarking that Khera was in Hyderabad when the FIR was lodged.

Opposing the plea, Assam Advocate General Devajit Saikia argued that the complaint was filed by a private individual and not politically motivated, adding that the allegations lacked merit. Meanwhile, an Assam Police team had earlier visited Khera’s Delhi residence.

Chief Minister Sarma has rejected the accusations and criticised the Congress for failing to verify documents, warning that police would pursue the matter rigorously.

MPST

Qatar vows to remain reliable energy supplier...

Continued from Page 1

“All of us are deeply concerned about the conflict and would like to see an early return to normalcy. We firmly oppose the targeting of civilians, infrastructure and commercial shipping,” he said.

He underlined the importance of keeping maritime routes open, particularly the Strait of Hormuz, which carries nearly 20 per cent of global oil and liquefied natural gas shipments. Iran’s move to restrict access to the narrow passage has driven up global oil and gas prices and triggered widespread concerns about supply disruptions.

“When energy becomes scarce and expensive, it has an overarching implication for the entire society,” Jaishankar said, adding that disruptions extend beyond fuel markets. He noted that constraints on fertiliser supplies could have direct consequences for food security, while trade bottlenecks affect multiple sectors simultaneously.

India, which depends heavily on West Asia for its energy needs, has been closely monitoring developments. New Delhi had earlier welcomed the ceasefire and called for unimpeded navigation and free flow of commerce through critical sea lanes. Talks between Iran and the United States are expected to take place in Islamabad over the weekend in an effort to stabilise the situation.

Parallel diplomatic efforts have focused on securing energy supplies. Petroleum and Natural Gas Minister Hardeep Singh Puri visited Doha on April 9 and 10, where he held discussions with Saad Sherida Al-Kaabi, Qatar’s Minister of State for Energy Affairs and President and CEO of QatarEnergy.

During the visit, Puri conveyed a message of solidarity from Prime Minister Narendra Modi to Qatar’s leadership, including the Amir Sheikh Tamim bin Hamad Al Thani and Prime Minister Sheikh Mohammed bin Abdulrahman Al Thani. The outreach followed the escalation of conflict that has disrupted energy production and exports across the Gulf.

Qatar, India’s largest supplier of liquefied natural gas and liquefied petroleum gas, reassured New Delhi of its continued commitment. Al Kaabi said the country would remain a “reliable energy supplier” and expressed readiness to strengthen bilateral cooperation.

India sources about 45 per cent of its LNG and 20 per cent of its LPG from Qatar. The stakes have risen sharply after a major Qatari LNG export facility was struck during retaliatory attacks linked to the conflict, forcing a shutdown and declaration of force majeure on gas exports, including supplies to India.

The six-week conflict has severely curtailed energy exports from Gulf countries, leading to industrial supply shortages and rising costs in India. The country relies on imports to meet roughly half of its natural gas demand and about two thirds of its LPG consumption, making it particularly vulnerable to disruptions.

Both sides welcomed the April 8 ceasefire and stressed the urgency of restoring stability in global energy markets. They also highlighted the need for uninterrupted maritime navigation and the smooth functioning of supply chains.

The discussions in Doha also covered broader aspects of India Qatar relations, including trade, investment, culture and people to people ties. Indian officials noted that leaders from both countries had earlier spoken twice in March, agreeing on the importance of dialogue and diplomacy to resolve the crisis.

At the same time, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal has been engaging with regional partners to address trade disruptions and stabilise supply chains.

Goyal held virtual talks with Kuwait’s Commerce Minister Osama Khaled Boodai, where he conveyed India’s willingness to assist in resolving supply chain challenges, particularly those related to food security. Both sides agreed that dialogue should take precedence and that energy and trade flows must be restored quickly.

In separate discussions with the United Arab Emirates Minister of Foreign Trade Thani bin Ahmed Al Zeyoudi, Goyal reviewed measures to ensure continuity of trade. The two sides acknowledged significant strain on regional supply chains and called for coordinated efforts to maintain smooth movement of goods.

India also recognised the UAE’s logistical initiatives, including the development of alternate routes and multimodal transport systems to bypass disrupted maritime channels. Goyal highlighted steps taken by India to support exporters and ensure availability of essential goods domestically.

Further consultations were held with Jaseem Mohamed Al Budaiwi, Secretary General of the Gulf Cooperation Council, where both sides expressed hope that the ceasefire would hold and pave the way for long-term stability. Goyal also met Bahrain’s Industry and Commerce Minister Abdulla Bin Adel Fakhro, stressing the importance of predictable trade flows across maritime and other routes.

The Gulf Cooperation Council countries, comprising the UAE, Saudi Arabia, Oman, Bahrain, Qatar and Kuwait, are among India’s most significant trading partners. Bilateral trade between India and the region stood at USD 178 billion in 2024-25, including exports of USD 56.87 billion and imports of USD 121.67 billion.

The ongoing conflict has disrupted shipping routes and posed challenges for exporters across sectors such as petroleum products, chemicals, engineering goods, rice, pharmaceuticals and gems and jewellery. Attacks on Iran by the United States and Israel have compounded instability, affecting vessel movement in international waters and slowing trade flows.

As tensions continue, India’s multi-pronged approach combining diplomatic outreach, energy negotiations and trade coordination reflects the urgency of safeguarding its economic interests while advocating for de-escalation.

Officials across ministries have reiterated that restoring peace and ensuring uninterrupted access to critical resources and trade routes remain central priorities, amid concerns that prolonged instability in West Asia could have lasting global repercussions.

KHARGE TO HOST OPPOSITION MEET NEXT WEEK

Congress flags ‘political motive’ behind women’s reservation Bill

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Congress on Friday accused the Narendra Modi government of playing politics in the name of women’s reservation law and asserted that the proposed delimitation exercise linked to it was “not constitutional” and could have “grave consequences” that warrants thorough deliberation after the ongoing assembly polls.

The Congress Working Committee met here to deliberate on the government’s move to amend the women’s reservation law, the proposed delimitation exercise and the West Asia conflict.

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge will now call a meeting of top leaders of all opposition parties, most likely on April 15, to discuss and formulate a joint strategy for the “special session” of Parliament from April 16 to 18, during



Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge with party leaders, at Indira Bhawan, New Delhi, on Friday

which the government is set to bring bills for amending the women quota law.

The top Congress leadership while deliberating on the issue said they were in favour of the women reservation law implementation, but were opposed to the “rushed” delimitation exercise to increase the number of seats in Lok Sabha

solely for “political gains”.

Both Kharge and former party president Rahul Gandhi said the issue was not women reservation implementation but the manner in which the delimitation exercise was being pushed in the midst of the election process. Several Congress leaders of the south, including Karnataka Chief Minister

Highlights

» The Congress Working Committee met to deliberate on the government’s move to amend the women’s reservation law, the proposed delimitation exercise and the West Asia conflict

» Both Kharge and former party president Rahul Gandhi said the issue was not women reservation implementation but the manner in which the delimitation exercise was being pushed in the midst of the election process

Siddaramaiah, Telangana Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy and Thiruvananthapuram MP Shashi Tharoor, opposed the reported proposal of the government to increase Lok Sabha seats by about 50 per cent, which, they claimed, would hurt the southern states as they would proportionately fall behind the big states of the

North.

In his opening remarks, Kharge said the government is convening the Parliament sitting with the sole intention of securing political advantage, which is a “violation” of the Model Code of Conduct (MCC). He said the proposed amendments are of such a nature that they can potentially have a profound impact on the country’s electoral system.

“Therefore, we will formulate a collective strategy by holding discussions on these issues with our colleagues in the opposition as well. We will move forward unitedly,” Kharge asserted.

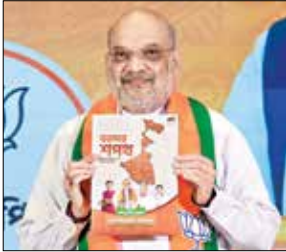
“The Congress remains steadfastly committed to ensuring women’s empowerment and social justice,” Gandhi said.

The meeting, chaired by Kharge with Congress Parliamentary Party chief Sonia Gandhi attending the meeting through video conferencing.

Bengal battle intensifies with Shah’s UCC gambit

Sharpens BJP’s poll pitch with ‘son of soil’ CM

OUR CORRESPONDENT



Amit Shah poses with the ‘BJP Sankalp Patra’, the party’s manifesto, on Friday

KOLKATA: Mixing headline promises on infiltration, the Uniform Civil Code and “Ram Rajya” with a welfare-heavy package for women, unemployed youth and farmers, the BJP on Friday unveiled its West Bengal poll manifesto in what appeared to be its sharpest bid yet to prise away the social coalition that has kept the TMC in power since 2011.

Union Home Minister Amit Shah turned the ‘Sankalp Patra’ release programme here into a pitch wrapped in welfare promises, Bengali symbolism and a sharp attack on Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee, seeking to frame the election as a direct contest over identity and welfare.

He promised that if voted to power, the BJP would implement the Uniform Civil Code in Bengal within six months, appoint a “son of Bengal” as chief minister and establish

what he called “Ram Rajya” in the state.

Defending the UCC promise amid TMC attacks that it was majoritarian, Shah said the proposal did not originate with the BJP. “It is the Constituent Assembly that recommended it. Is having the same law for every citizen appeasement? Or is it appeasement when one citizen is allowed four marriages and another only one?” he said.

The manifesto also promised strict laws against “love jihad” and “land jihad” and a

law guaranteeing every citizen the freedom to practise religion and faith.

Shah also declared that a BJP government would adopt a “detect, delete and deport” policy against infiltrators.

“We will move with zero tolerance towards infiltration,” he said, promising to seal Bengal’s borders, stop cattle smuggling and clear government land of “encroachers and infiltrators”.

The BJP said that within 45 days of coming to power, it would provide all land needed for border fencing and introduce modern scientific patrolling in rivers and canals with the Centre’s help. The reference to Bangladesh dovetailed with the BJP’s campaign around infiltration. “Mamata Banerjee has a different definition of infiltrators. By infiltrators, I mean those who are not citizens of India. We will expel all such infiltrators and give citizenship to refugees.”

UDF will win, claims Venugopal; slams BJP’s ‘unholy partnership’

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM/NEW DELHI: Congress general secretary KC Venugopal on Friday contended that despite an alleged “unholy political partnership” between the Left and the NDA, and the “widespread distribution of money” by the BJP, the UDF will win “comfortably.”

The Kerala Assembly polls were held on Thursday, with results for all 140 constituencies to be declared on May 4.

Speaking to reporters in Delhi, Venugopal, who is also the MP from the Alappuzha Lok Sabha constituency, asserted that “clear instances of cash being offered for votes” and the distribution of kits by



KC Venugopal said cash distribution by BJP won’t work

the BJP were seen in many parts of Kerala, including Palakkad and Thrissur.

He alleged that the BJP’s classification of certain constituencies as ‘A category’ meant they were seats earmarked for the distribution of money.

“The BJP spent huge amounts of money to get votes. On one side, there was the unholy political partnership between the Left and the NDA, and on the other, money. But the results will uphold the dignity of the voters in Kerala, who survived both,” he contended.

He also accused the CPI(M) of attempting fraudulent voting in Kannur and assaulting Congress workers in the northern Kerala district. The MP from Alappuzha said that the Congress and the UDF approached the elections professionally, with a positive outlook, a clear agenda, and a strong narrative. “We did not backtrack from our agenda on it,” he said.

‘My legacy will last forever’: TN CM Stalin

THANJAVUR: Tamil Nadu Chief Minister on Friday lashed out at AIADMK chief Edappadi K Palaniswami for targeting him personally, and said that though death was universal, his (Stalin’s) achievements, including his numerous welfare initiatives, will live forever.

Reacting sharply to the AIADMK general secretary’s comments, which became a cause of controversy, during a recent election campaign, the chief minister said death was natural for everyone and that he (Stalin) could not be an exception. “Palaniswami has been highly critical of me. I wish to say that death is common to all. We can become dust, even I, but my programmes and initiatives will remain forever. No



MK Stalin’s son Udhayanidhi during a rally, in Chennai, on Friday

one can destroy them,” Stalin, who is the president of DMK, said while addressing a poll rally here.

At the campaign rally here, Stalin said Palaniswami’s intention to target him by making personal remarks would not

be showcased to the world,” the DMK president said and added that April 23 was an important date as the people will on that day put an end to Palaniswami’s “arrogance.” Stalin questioned Palaniswami’s silence over the Central government’s alleged attempt to discourage incentives to farmers over and above the MSP for paddy procurement and said if Palaniswami was a real farmer and their custodian, as he claimed, then he wouldn’t have supported the three farm laws. He accused the AIADMK general secretary of betraying the farmers.

Also, he accused the BJP of transferring the Tamil Nadu Chief Secretary to “indulge in electoral malpractices for personal gain.”

Will let work talk: Raghav Chadha

NEW DELHI: Sideline AAP Rajya Sabha MP Raghav Chadha on Friday responded to criticism of his parliamentary performance by asserting that his record speaks for itself. In a post on Instagram, Chadha shared a video titled “Voice Raised Price Paid,” a compilation of clips showing him addressing various public issues. “With due respect to those who are questioning my parliamentary performance, I will let my work do the talking,” Chadha wrote.

Repoll in one polling booth in Assam

GUWAHATI: The Election Commission on Friday ordered repoll in a booth of Karimganj (North) constituency in Assam’s Sribhumi district.

The repoll has been ordered in booth number 239 at Babyland High English School.

Repolling will be held on Saturday from 7 am to 5 pm. The re-election was ordered following clashes between supporters of the BJP and Congress. There are 14 candidates in the fray in this Barak Valley constituency, with a triangular contest among BJP’s Subrata Chaudhari, Congress’s Jakaria Ahmed and Choudhury Hibbur Rasul Usama Mabru of the AIUDEF.

Bihar CM Nitish begins new innings as Rajya Sabha member

NEW DELHI: Bihar Chief Minister Nitish Kumar on Friday took oath as a member of Rajya Sabha, marking the end of his two-decade rule in the eastern state and paving the way for a new chief minister.

The oath was administered by Rajya Sabha Chairman CP Radhakrishnan in his chamber at a brief ceremony. The Chairman later welcomed him as a member of the Upper House and also on his return to Parliament.

Kumar took the oath in Hindi in the presence of Union Minister J P Nadda, who is also leader of the house, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman, Panchayati Raj Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh, Minister of State for Agriculture and Farmers



Vice-President CP Radhakrishnan administers oath to Bihar CM Nitish Kumar

Welfare Ram Nath Thakur and Minister of State for Law and Justice Arjun Ram Meghwal.

Bihar deputy chief minister Samrat Chaudhary was also present at the oath-taking.

JDU leader and party’s working president Sanjay Kumar Jha, Congress chief whip in Rajya Sabha Jairam Ramesh, besides BJP MP and former union minister Rajiv Pratap Rudy and BJP

chief whip in Lok Sabha Sanjay Jaiswal, were among those present during the oath-taking.

“Vice President of India and Chairman, Rajya Sabha, Shri C. P. Radhakrishnan administered the oath to Shri Nitish Kumar as an elected Member of Rajya Sabha, from Bihar, at Parliament House today,” the Vice President’s office said on X, while sharing pictures of the oath-taking.

Over 4K candidates, 234 seats: Tamil Nadu gears up for mega Assembly poll clash

A total of 7,599 candidates, including independents, filed their nomination papers

CHENNAI: Over 4,600 candidates are in the fray for the upcoming Tamil Nadu Assembly elections, setting the stage for a crowded and high-stakes political battle across the state’s 234 constituencies.

According to the Election Commission, a total of 4,610 candidates will contest in the April 23 Assembly polls after scrutiny of nominations. The final list reflects intense electoral competition, with 7,599 candidates having originally filed nominations. Of these, 2,460 were rejected, while 529 candidates withdrew from the race before the deadline on April 9. The large number of contestants highlights the scale of political activity in Tamil Nadu, where major parties, smaller outfits, and a significant number of independents are in the fray.

In key constituencies, the contest is particularly crowded. In Kolathur, where Chief Minister MK Stalin is seeking re-election on behalf of the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK), 41 candidates will be



Scenes during the Deputy CM Udhayanidhi Stalin rally on Thursday

contesting. In Chepauk-Thiruvallikeni, where Deputy Chief Minister Udhayanidhi Stalin is seeking a second consecutive term, 26 candidates are in the fray.

The Edappadi constituency, a key stronghold of the opposition, will see 15 candidates contesting, including former Chief Minister and AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K Palaniswami, who is the lone star campaigner for his party and is aiming for a political

comeback after five years in opposition.

Other notable constituencies also show significant contestation. Perambur in Chennai has 47 accepted nominations, while Tiruchirappalli East has 27 candidates in the fray. Actor-politician Vijay, making his electoral debut, is contesting from two constituencies, adding further attention to the race. Karur constituency has emerged as the most crowded battlefield, with a record 85

Key Points

» A total of 529 candidates withdrew from the race, the election commission said

» In the Kolathur constituency in Chennai, where Chief Minister and DMK president M K Stalin is contesting, the EC has accepted the nominations of 41 candidates

candidates contesting. The constituency had earlier been in the news following a tragic stampede at a rally held by TVK chief Vijay on September 27 last year, which claimed 41 lives. At the other end of the spectrum, Ambasamudram has the lowest number of candidates, with just five in the fray.

Beyond individual constituencies, the broader political contest pits the ruling DMK, which is seeking a second consecutive term.



OUR CENSUS

OUR DEVELOPMENT

(First Phase of Census 2027)

Common queries on Self-Enumeration (SE) and their Answers (Part-1)

WHAT IS SELF-ENUMERATION?

Self-Enumeration is an online process in which you fill and submit your household details on the SE portal (se.census.gov.in) yourself, without waiting for an enumerator



❖ **Is Self-Enumeration mandatory?**
No, it is an additional facility. If you do not do it, an enumerator will collect data during field visit

❖ **Can I do Self-Enumeration in any language?**
This facility is available in Hindi, English and 14 Indian languages

❖ **Is internet required for Self-Enumeration?**
Yes, internet is required to access the portal

❖ **Is my information safe?**
Yes, all data is secure, encrypted and stored on government servers

❖ **What is SE ID and its use?**
After submission of information, you will receive a unique 11 digit SE ID (Also via SMS/email) which must be shown to the enumerator during her/his visit to your house

❖ **What if SE ID is forgotten?**
It can be retrieved using the registered mobile number on the portal

❖ **Will an enumerator visit after Self-Enumeration?**
Yes, the enumerator will visit your home and confirm your details using the SE ID

❖ **Do I need to upload any documents?**
No documents are required to be uploaded

❖ **Is help available on the portal?**
Portal has user guide, flowcharts, tutorial videos, FAQs and tooltips

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MISRI ALSO MET SECRETARY OF STATE MARCO RUBIO ON THURSDAY

Foreign Secretary Misri meets senior White House officials, NSC leadership

MPOST BUREAU

WASHINGTON: Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri held productive discussions with senior White House officials and the National Security Council leadership on issues of mutual strategic interest and recent developments in West Asia, the Indian embassy here said on Friday.

Misri's meetings at the White House come as the US and Iran have agreed to a two-week ceasefire for the war that broke out on February 28.

A delegation led by Vice President J D Vance is headed to Pakistan for negotiations with the Iranian leadership on Saturday to end the war.

The Foreign Secretary's discussions also focused on the Indian Ocean Strategic Venture, an initiative announced during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to Washington in February last year.

"Foreign Secretary Vikram



Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri during a meeting with the US Under Secretary of State for Economic Affairs Jacob S Helberg, in Washington, DC

Misri had productive discussions with senior White House officials. He met NSC leadership and exchanged views on issues of mutual strategic interest, including the Indian Ocean Strategic Venture and recent developments in West Asia," the Indian embassy said in a

social media post. Indian Ocean Strategic Venture seeks to emerge as a whole-of-government forum to advance coordinated investments in economic connectivity and commerce in the Indian Ocean.

"The United States believes

Highlights

» Misri's meetings at the White House come as the US and Iran have agreed to a two-week ceasefire for the war that broke out on February 28

» A delegation led by US Vice President Vance is headed to Pakistan for negotiations with the Iranian leadership on Saturday to end the war

» Foreign Secretary's discussions also focused on the Indian Ocean Strategic Venture

Defence, said during a visit to India last month.

Indian Ambassador to the US Vinay Mohan Kwatra hosted a reception in honour of Misri at the India House here. The officials from the US administration also attended the reception.

"At a reception hosted by @AmbVMKwatra in India House, Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri interacted with friends and partners from across the US Administration, reaffirming the strong and vibrant bilateral partnership, and joint efforts to further strengthen ties," the Indian Embassy said.

Misri arrived here late Tuesday night on a three-day visit.

He has held meetings with senior officials from the Department of Defence, Commerce and State.

Misri also met Secretary of State Marco Rubio on Thursday.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

FY26: Scheduled Caste finance body disburses record Rs 775 cr

In a statement, the ministry said the disbursement was the highest in the corporation's 37-year history

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation (NSFDC) recorded its highest-ever annual disbursement of Rs 775.26 crore in 2025-26, a growth of 27 per cent over the previous financial year, the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment said on Friday.

In a statement, the ministry said the disbursement was the highest in the corporation's 37-year history.

NSFDC, a public sector undertaking under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, covered 59,002 beneficiaries during 2025-26, registering a 41.32 per cent increase over 2024-25. Of these, 39,804 were women beneficiaries, marking a growth of 48 per cent.

Under the Vanchit Ikai Samooah aur Vargon ki Aarthik

Takeaways

» Under VISVAS Yojana the corporation disbursed Rs 26.09 crore, benefiting 98,748 individuals

» Ministry said Rs 215.39 crore was disbursed under the National Fellowship Scheme for Scheduled Castes

The ministry said Rs 215.39 crore was disbursed under the National Fellowship Scheme for Scheduled Castes, supporting 4,219 scholars pursuing higher education.

With an authorised share capital of Rs 1,800 crore and paid-up capital of Rs 1,515 crore, NSFDC has achieved cumulative disbursement of Rs 9,567.14 crore, benefiting more than 16.96 lakh Scheduled Caste individuals as on March 31, 2026, it said.

The ministry said NSFDC has developed a new website compliant with GIGW 3.0 guidelines and Digital Brand Identity Manual norms, which is ready for launch.

It has also developed a Loan Accounting and Management System (LAMS) integrated with the PM-SURA portal to enable end-to-end digitisation and improve transparency in loan management, the statement said.

Sahayta (VISVAS) Yojana (Interest Subvention Scheme), the corporation disbursed Rs 26.09 crore, benefiting 98,748 individuals, registering a growth of more than 334 per cent over the previous year, the statement said.

Under the Scheme for Economic Empowerment of DNTs (SEED), Rs 11.18 crore was disbursed to 1,450 self-help groups across four states, reflecting a 76 per cent increase in disbursement.

Hassle-free arrangements for procurement across mandis, says Haryana CM

Attacks Cong for misleading farmers



A delegation of Bharatiya Mazdoor Sangh expressing gratitude to Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini for the historic increase in the minimum wages of workers, at his residence Sant Kabir Kutir in Chandigarh

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Friday shared that hassle-free arrangements have been made by the state government for procurement across mandis.

He said nodal officers have been appointed in every mandi while Additional Chief Secretary-level officers have been assigned district-wise responsibilities.

Saini slammed the Congress and other Opposition parties for misleading farmers over crop procurement.

Addressing a press conference here, the Chief Minister said that MLAs and senior officers are continuously monitoring the situation on the ground to ensure that farmers do not face any inconvenience. Social Justice and Empowerment minister, Krishan Kumar Bedi was also present on the occasion.

Taking a dig at the previous Congress govt led by Bhupinder Singh Hooda, the Chief Minister

ter said that during its 10-year rule, governance took a backseat and farmers were left to suffer.

He alleged that farmers had to wait 3 to 7 days outside mandis to sell their produce, faced shortage of gunny bags, and their crops were often damaged due to rain, forcing them to arrange tarpaulins at their own expense.

He further said that Congress should clarify how many warehouses were constructed during its tenure to safeguard crops. Procurement deductions, delayed payments and even token compensation of Rs. 2 reflected the insensitivity of the previous regime towards farmers, he said.

Meanwhile, CM Saini has directed officials that in the Shri Sheelta Mata Devi Medical College and Hospital being established in Gurugram, 33 per cent each of the 150 MBBS seats and 850 beds should be reserved for students and residents of Haryana.

BSF constable shot dead in Manipur's Ukhrul district

IMPHAL: A Border Security Force constable was shot dead on Friday while on patrolling duty in Manipur's Ukhrul district, officials said.

Constable Mithun Mandal from West Bengal was "struck by a bullet fired from an unknown direction around 4.30 pm", an official said.

Mandal, who hailed from Bhagjan Tola village of West Bengal, was taken to a hospital in Imphal, where he died around 6 pm. Chief Minister Y Khemchand Singh condemned the killing, and offered condolences to his family members.

"Strongly condemn the tragic martyrdom of Constable Mithun Mandal (170 Bn, BSF), who was fatally injured by a bullet from an unknown direction while on patrol at Mongkot Chepu, Ukhrul today. He succumbed at RIMS, Imphal.

"A brave son of West Bengal, his sacrifice in the line of duty will never be forgotten. My deepest condolences to his bereaved family. Prayers for strength and peace in this hour of grief. Om shanti," Singh said.

AGENCIES

Ludhiana admin sets up dedicated control rooms for UP boat tragedy



An injured person receives treatment at a hospital after a boat carrying pilgrims capsized near Kesi Ghat, in Mathura district, Friday

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Regarding the unfortunate boat accident in Vrindavan (Uttar Pradesh), Deputy Commissioner Ludhiana, Himanshu Jain has urged residents not to spread rumours or create panic as District Administration Ludhiana as well as the Punjab government is already touch with authorities in Vrindavan.

He informed that for the help of people, a 24x7 dedicated helplines, numbers 01624223226 (SDM Jagraon

office) and 01612403100 (Deputy Commissioner Office Ludhiana) have also been set up at Jagraon as well as District Headquarters Ludhiana.

He informed that as soon as the incident came to the notice of District Administration, special teams comprising both civil and police officers have already been dispatched to Vrindavan for better coordination amongst the authorities.

He once again urged the people to remain together in this hour of crisis and not believe in any rumours.

'MOVE AIMED TO PLUG CORRUPTION'

BJP's flagship scheme 'Himcare' revamped: HP CM

ASHWANI SHARMA

Closer Look

» Sukhu said he was not happy with the implementation of the Himcare scheme

» CM stressed need for several qualitative improvements to be made to strengthen Himcare Scheme

SHIMLA: Under scrutiny for alleged irregularities and mismanagement, the Congress government has revamped Himcare, a flagship health insurance scheme introduced during the previous BJP government.

At a high-level meeting of the health department, Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu said he was not happy with the implementation of the Himcare scheme, which, instead of relief for the needy, has become a source of misuse of public funds meant for suffering humans.

During the meeting, the Chief Minister stressed the need for several qualitative improvements to be made to strengthen

the Himcare Scheme. These reforms will ensure transparency in the scheme and help curb the possibility of corruption, he hoped.

Under the Himcare Scheme, government hospitals will be paid the lower amount between the actual cost of treatment

(including consumables) and the fixed package rate. Hospitals will be required to submit bills for the actual expenses along with their claims. Expenditures such as registration fees, bed charges, nursing, and boarding will not be included in such claims.

"In addition, fees for surgeons, anaesthetists, doctors, and consultants, as well as charges for anaesthesia, blood transfusions, oxygen, operating theatre use, surgical equipment, medicines, and patient meals, will not be part of these reimbursement claims," a senior official of the health department briefed the media later after the meeting.

These expenses are borne separately under the Himcare Scheme and are also provided

to government hospitals through budgetary allocations.

Earlier, funds for similar components were being provided through two different mechanisms. After this rationalisation, the funds allocated to government hospitals through the budget will no longer be included as part of the Himcare package claims. Instead, the government will continue to provide funds for these components directly through the budget.

Launched by the previous BJP government led by Jai Ram Thakur, controversy around Himachal Pradesh's HIMCARE (health insurance) has been under the scanner for alleged financial irregularities, misuse, structural issues, and political disagreement.

Census 2027: Over 5.72L households choose online self-enumeration

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: Over 5.72 lakh homes nationwide have signed up via the web-based self-response platform ahead of Census 2027, showing growing public involvement.

With authorities shifting toward tech-driven data collection, digital registration numbers continue climbing gradually.

Participation gains momentum even as officials promote online submission over traditional methods.

Now available online, the self-enumeration option lets people enter their household information directly. Earlier censuses relied solely on face-

to-face visits by field staff. With digital access comes less need for physical outreach. Previously, every piece of data came through handwritten forms collected in person.

Since the portal began, more people join each month - answers arrive from villages as well as cities. Households share essential data through this online system: who lives there, schooling levels, jobs held, faith practised, languages spoken, plus whether clean water or electricity is available at home.

Following setbacks in the ten-year population count caused by the COVID outbreak, officials have turned to updated techniques to speed up information gathering. Though

digital responses are promoted, face-to-face interviews remain part of the process - this helps reach individuals offline. Because some households lack web tools, in-person follow-ups fill gaps left by online efforts alone.

With fewer tasks piling up, workers might find daily routines easier under the new system. Though changes take time, early signs suggest better results in how information gets handled.

Some shifts began when public messages started promoting online involvement. Reaching more individuals became possible once outreach efforts expanded through different channels.

GAGANYAAN MISSION

ISRO successfully conducts second integrated air drop test

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Space agency ISRO has successfully conducted the second integrated air drop test (IADT-02) for the upcoming Gaganyaan mission at the space station in Andhra Pradesh's Sriharikota.

The system is essential to ensure a safe recovery of the crew module -- the capsule in which astronauts sit during re-entry and landing.

Union minister Jitendra Singh congratulated the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) for successfully conducting the test.

"Congratulations #ISRO for the successful accomplishment of Second Integrated Air Drop Test (IADT-02) for #Gaganyaan, India's first Human Space flight scheduled next year. The second Integrated Air Drop Test (IADT-02) was successfully conducted at Satish Dhawan Space Station Sriharikota," Singh said in a post on X.

The IADT-02 follows the successful completion of the



An IAF Chinook helicopter carries out the second integrated air drop test of the Gaganyaan crew module during a joint trial with ISRO

first IADT, which took place on August 24, 2025, at the Satish Dhawan Space Centre in Sriharikota.

Air drop tests recreate the last leg of a spacecraft's return

to Earth. An aircraft or helicopter drops the spacecraft from a height to test various systems under different scenarios.

These are the deployment of the parachute system in case the mission is aborted mid-flight, system performance when one parachute fails to open and the spacecraft's orientation and safety during splashdown etc.

In the IADT-02 test, a simulated crew module, weighing about 5.7 tonnes, was lifted by an Indian Air Force Chinook helicopter to an altitude of about three kilometres and released over a designated drop zone in the sea, near the Sriharikota coast.

In a statement, the ISRO said, "Ten parachutes of four types were deployed in a precise sequence during the descent of the crew module, gradually reducing the velocity for safe touchdown. Subsequently, the simulated crew module was successfully recovered in coordination with the Indian Navy."

Nation Briefs

NFR: GM CONDUCTS SAFETY INSPECTION FROM KATI HAR TO NEW JALPAIGURI



MALIGAON: The General Manager of Northeast Frontier Railway Chetan Kumar Shrivastava, conducted a comprehensive safety inspection drive from Katihar to New Jalpaiguri recently, covering a wide range of operational and infrastructural aspects. During the onward journey, the General Manager undertook rigorous inspections of critical railway assets in the Katihar-Dandkhora and Mukuria-Barsoi sections. These included examination of level crossings, track geometry, gang working, curves, major bridges and Switch Expansion Joints to ensure adherence to safety standards. A detailed inspection of Dalkhola station, point machinery and level crossing infrastructure was also carried out.

DANAPUR DIVISION: AUTOMATIC BLOCK SIGNALING WORK CHANGES TRAIN OPERATIONS

HAJIPUR: Due to non-interlocking work on April 11, 2026 for the automatic block signalling work at Rampur Dumra, Barhiya etc. stations of the Danapur division, changes have been made in the operation of trains.



EDITORIAL
UNANSWERED
QUESTIONS
REMAIN

The resignation of Allahabad High Court judge Yashwant Varma has drawn a contentious episode to a formal close, but it leaves behind deeper institutional questions that cannot be so easily resolved. By stepping down, Justice Varma has rendered the ongoing impeachment proceedings infructuous, effectively ending Parliament's role in adjudicating the matter. While resignation is within his constitutional right, the timing raises a critical concern: does such an exit allow the system to avoid a definitive conclusion? In a democracy governed by the rule of law, accountability is not merely procedural—it must also be visible. When serious allegations against a sitting judge culminate not in a verdict but in a resignation, the system risks appearing incomplete, if not evasive. The issue, therefore, is not just about one individual, but about whether the existing framework for judicial accountability is adequate to inspire public confidence.

The facts of the case have already unsettled that confidence. The recovery of burnt currency notes from the judge's official residence following a fire in March 2025, the subsequent inquiry by an in-house panel, and the eventual move towards impeachment created an extraordinary situation for the judiciary. The Supreme Court's decision to upload elements of the inquiry report, including visual evidence, marked a rare step towards transparency, signalling the seriousness with which the allegations were being treated. Yet, even as the process unfolded—from internal scrutiny to parliamentary action—it exposed the structural limitations of the current system. India's Constitution makes the removal of judges deliberately difficult, requiring a rigorous impeachment process to safeguard judicial independence. But that very design, while essential, also renders the system slow and susceptible to disruption, as seen in this case.

Judicial independence is rightly regarded as a cornerstone of democracy. Judges must be insulated from political pressure to ensure they can uphold the Constitution without fear or favour. However, independence cannot be conflated with immunity. The Varma episode underscores the tension between these two principles. The in-house mechanism, though useful, lacks statutory backing and enforceability. Its findings, however serious, do not carry the force of law unless followed by impeachment—a process that is not only complex but also political in nature. When a judge resigns before the process reaches its conclusion, the system is left in a grey zone: there is neither a formal exoneration nor a conclusive finding of misconduct in the public domain. This ambiguity weakens the very trust that judicial independence seeks to protect.

This is not an isolated occurrence. India's judicial history has seen similar instances where impeachment proceedings faltered or were rendered irrelevant due to resignation. From Justice V. Ramaswami to Justice Soumitra Sen, the pattern suggests that the current framework, while robust in theory, struggles in practice. It allows for accountability in principle but often fails to deliver closure in reality. This raises the need for systemic reform. One possible approach is to formalise the in-house inquiry mechanism through legislation, giving it clearer authority, defined timelines, and enforceable outcomes. Another is to revisit the idea of a judicial oversight body that operates independently of both the executive and the legislature, ensuring that complaints against judges are addressed in a credible and time-bound manner. Such reforms must be carefully designed to avoid undermining judicial autonomy, but the absence of reform carries its own risks.

Ultimately, the resignation of Justice Varma should not be seen as the end of a controversy, but as the beginning of a necessary institutional introspection. The judiciary derives its authority not only from constitutional provisions but also from public trust—a trust that depends on both independence and accountability. When proceedings end without resolution, that trust is inevitably tested. India's democracy has matured to a point where it can no longer rely solely on convention and discretion to uphold institutional integrity. It requires transparent, predictable, and credible mechanisms that ensure justice is both done and seen to be done. The challenge, therefore, is not to choose between independence and accountability, but to strengthen both in tandem. Only then can the judiciary retain the moral authority that is essential to its role in a constitutional democracy.

PEOPLE'S
VOICE



NARENDRA MODI

Phule's life reminds us that reform begins with courage and conviction. His ideas remain not just history, but a living blueprint for a more equal India

Jyotirao Phule's Enduring Legacy

On his bicentenary, Mahatma Jyotirao Phule's legacy of education, equality and social justice remains a powerful guide for an India still grappling with inequality

Today, April 11, is a deeply special day for all of us. It is the birth anniversary of Mahatma Jyotirao Phule, one of India's greatest social reformers and a guiding light for generations. This year, the occasion carries even greater significance, as it marks the beginning of his 200th birth anniversary celebrations.

Mahatma Phule was a great reformer. In addition to that, his was a life of moral courage, restless enquiry and unshakable commitment to social good. Mahatma Phule is remembered for the institutions he built and the movements he led. At the same time, his contribution to our civilisational journey lies in the hope he aroused, the confidence he instilled and the strength his thoughts continue to give to millions of people across the nation.

Born in the great state of Maharashtra in 1827, Mahatma Phule emerged from modest beginnings. But his initial hardships never stood in the way of his learning, his courage or his commitment to society. This is a trait that remained with him forever: whatever the challenges may be, one must work hard, acquire knowledge and mitigate those challenges instead of doing nothing about them. From his school days, young Jyotirao was deeply curious and became a voracious reader, often reading books far beyond what children his age were expected to engage with. Years later, he said, "The more questions we generate, the more knowledge emerges from them." Clearly, the spirit of enquiry he was blessed with since his childhood remained constant in his journey.

Throughout his life, learning and education became central to Mahatma Phule's mission. He recognised with rare clarity that knowledge is not a privilege to be guarded, but a force to be shared. At a time when the joys of learning were denied to many, he opened pioneering schools for girls and for those kept out of formal education. He used to say, "Any improvement that comes in children through mothers is deeply valuable. Therefore, if schools are to be opened, they should first be opened for girls." He worked to create a new social imagination in which the classroom became an instrument of justice and equality.

His vision for education inspires us greatly. Over the last decade, we have worked to make research and innovation a cornerstone for the youth of India. Efforts are being made to create an ecosystem where young minds are encouraged to question, explore and innovate. By investing in knowledge, skills and



As India marks the 200th birth anniversary of Mahatma Jyotirao Phule, his life and work offer more than remembrance

opportunity, India is empowering its youth to become problem-solvers and drivers of national progress.

Due to his knowledge and wisdom, Mahatma Phule developed a strong understanding of areas such as agriculture, healthcare and rural development. He often said that injustice towards our farmers and workers weakens our society. He saw how social inequalities manifested themselves in daily life, be it in the farms or in villages. Hence, he immersed himself in ensuring dignity for the poor, the downtrodden and the marginalised. At the same time, he made every possi-

ble effort to ensure social harmony was maintained.

Mahatma Phule opined, "जो पर्यंत समाजतील सर्वाना समान अधिकार मिळत नाहीत, तोपर्यंत खरे स्वातंत्र्य मिळत नाही" (True freedom cannot be achieved until everyone in society is granted equal rights). And for that, he built institutions that translated this vision into action, contributing to a just society. The Satyashodhak Samaj, founded by him, was one of the most important social reform movements in modern India. It was at the forefront of social reform, community service and furthering human dignity.

It became an effective voice for women, youngsters and those living in villages. This movement reflected Mahatma Phule's intrinsic belief that society could be strengthened by placing at its core justice, respect for every person and a spirit of collective progress.

His personal life, too, carried lessons in courage. Always working and being among the people took a toll on his health. But even the most serious health challenges did not dim his resolve. After suffering a debilitating stroke, he continued to work and fulfil his vision. Yes, his body had been tested, but his commitment to society had not yielded. For millions today, especially those who draw courage from struggle, this remains one of the most powerful dimensions of his life.

No remembrance of Mahatma Phule can be complete without a respectful mention of Savitribai Phule, who was herself one of the tallest reformers of our nation. As one of India's pioneering women teachers, she played a defining role in advancing education for girls, thus giving them the opportunity to pursue their dreams. After Mahatma Phule's passing, Savitribai carried forward that torch and, in 1897, during a plague outbreak, she served victims with such devotion that she herself contracted the disease and lost her own life.

Our land has been blessed, time and again, by great men and women who have strengthened society through thought, sacrifice and action. They did not wait for change to arrive from somewhere else. They became its source. For hundreds of years in our land, the clarion call for social betterment has often risen from within society itself, from those who could see suffering clearly and refused to accept it as fate. Mahatma Jyotirao Phule was one such voice.

I fondly recall my visit to Pune in 2022, when I had offered tributes to Mahatma Phule at his grand statue in the city. As we mark the beginning of his bicentenary year, the most fitting tribute to Mahatma Jyotirao Phule is about renewal. Renewal of our commitment to subjects close to his heart, such as education. Renewal of our sensitivity to injustice. Renewal of our faith that society can improve itself from within. His life tells us that the power of community can achieve miracles in India when joined with moral clarity and public purpose. That is why he still gives strength to millions. That is why his words and work still carry hope. And that is why, nearly two hundred years after his birth, Mahatma Jyotirao Phule remains not a figure of the past, but a guide for India's future.

AT
VANTAGE



SHUTAPA PAUL

THE WRITER IS AN AUTHOR AND MEDIA ENTREPRENEUR

From being ignored in design to dominating demand, women are reshaping markets, conversations and the future of consumer innovation

Women's Buying Power

A rising trend of selling to women proves the emergence of the female buying economy and ultimately, an acknowledgement of their needs

Ask my mother's generation about menopause and they'll downplay it. Ask them about perimenopause and they'll look bewildered. Their generation wouldn't even have heard about the latter, and had little to navigate the former. But now, partly thanks to a new awakening towards women-led health needs, my generation knows how to tackle perimenopause and menopause when the day comes. It's incredible that for decades, innovations in health, engineering, and design have almost completely left out the female perspective. Machines were built keeping the male anatomy in mind, clinical trials were done mostly on men, and female participation in everything was limited and/or absent. Even basic innovations improved male lives first, before years later, realising that hey, women are right there too, asking for ease of living.

That half of the world's population that's revered and abused, deified and demonised, used to start wars or end one — has shockingly been overlooked in modern innovation. Therein lies the most critical element of contemporary arguments that favour enhanced participation of women in the workforce. It's only by getting more women into the room that we can ensure that the female eye is on things, that the female voice gets heard, and female requirements are eventually reflected in upcoming trends. At long last, we are finally hearing conver-



Whether driven by awareness or capitalism, women are no longer an afterthought—they are the centre of the conversation

sations that are focused on women, and offerings slowly abound that are adapted to our needs.

The advent of women-focused consumerism has taken over the product market. If you just look around, there has been sudden progress made in perimenopause or female mid-life related products and treatments, even before it did for periods. The sales market has realised an ignored truth — women are the decision-makers in almost 85 per cent of household spends, more and more financially independent women have superfluous incomes, women are more amenable to spending on health, education, family welfare, over 25 per cent of investors are women, and there's a growing brood of single women who are focussed on health and wellness. And that's about enough to have hormone-

balancing gummies, an oversupply of protein supplements, hair, skin, longevity pills — you name it, and we suddenly have access to it all. Some reports even suggest that urban Indian women have more purchasing capacity than their male counterparts, and therefore, are playing pivotal roles in major buys such as residential real estate as well. And today, even though it comes at the cost of consumerism, women in India have ample options to deal with women-specific matters that have been historically ignored by male innovators. More importantly, erstwhile taboo topics have shed their garb of secrecy with growing awareness and literacy being created around them.

Marketing reports have often highlighted that about 72 per cent of women have felt unseen by brands. Looking back, how can one forget the numerous washing

powders, cooking oils, and pressure cooker advertisements targeting women buyers! Assuming that only women were the cleaners, cooks, and housekeepers, and not men. But those were the times then, and now, the winds are changing. The current shift has meant great business as well by selling to younger and older women with strong buying power. A Flipkart report noted an annual uptick of 34 per cent among female shoppers; a majority of them being Gen Z. Forbes has called women over-50 "super consumers" predicted to control 75 per cent of global discretionary spending by 2028. So whether it's driven by capitalism or social awakening, or maybe a bit of both — I'll take it. The ladies have arrived on the product platforms, and there's no looking back.

Views expressed are personal

WHO SAID
WHAT

Rajdeep Sardesai
@sardesairajdeep

While Justice Yashwant Varma has finally resigned, the questions remain: Will we ever know whose cash it was that was found at the judge's house in March last year? Why was no FIR filed at the time, with no police investigation? And what happens now to the report on impeachment that was to be submitted in Parliament's monsoon session? Why resign now after pleading innocence for over a year? Who will hold judges accountable? Many questions, few answers.

Kavitha Kalvakuntla
@RackKavitha

Nobel for Hafiz Saeed and Masood Azhar next? A terror state like Pakistan demanding a Nobel for its leaders is laughable. First, they wanted one for Trump; now they demand three for their own. In the future, they might as well demand one for terrorists like Hafiz Saeed and Masood Azhar. While it seems funny now, as Indians, it is our fundamental duty to expose Pakistan on the world stage. We must tweet, post, and act at every level to ensure this rogue nation doesn't even make it to the nominations.

MOST OF THE CEASEFIRE WORK REMAINS TO BE DONE

Gaza marks six months of ceasefire

DEIR AL-BALAH: Friday marks six months since Gaza's ceasefire deal took effect, a milestone largely lost in the confusion over the new and even more fragile ceasefire in the Iran war.

The ravaged Palestinian territory of 2 million people has seen the most intense fighting stop between Israeli forces and Hamas-led militants. But most of the ceasefire work remains to be done, from disarming Hamas and ending its two-decade rule to deploying an international stabilisation force and beginning vast reconstruction. Gaza residents are in limbo, with limited aid entering through a single, Israeli-controlled border post.

Such challenges could represent what's to come in the latest war, as US President Donald Trump's approach to peace-making appears to be stopping bombardment and leaving the bigger picture for others to work out.

Whether Trump can force



Palestinians youth look on as they stand in an area next to tents at a makeshift camp for displaced people, at sunset in Khan Younis on Thursday

through that kind of deal on Iran, with more actors in play and global markets quivering

at every statement, is yet to be seen.

Focusing on a deal's details

is crucial. Already, the Iran war's two-week ceasefire has created deadly confusion over

Highlights

» The ravaged Palestinian territory of 2 million people has seen the most intense fighting stop between Israeli forces and Hamas-led militants

» Gaza residents are in limbo, with limited aid entering through a single, Israeli-controlled border post

NINE DAYS AFTER THE BOARD'S INITIAL MEETING, US AND ISRAEL ATTACKED IRAN

Lebanon as Israel insists the deal doesn't apply there and continues to attack the Iranian-backed Hezbollah, while Iran insists it does and threatens to upend the agreement. Israel

made a surprise announcement on Thursday, authorising direct negotiations with Lebanon, despite the lack of diplomatic ties.

Not long ago, the US-created and Trump-led Board of Peace kicked off with \$7 billion in pledges and sweeping intentions of resolving not only Gaza but also other conflicts that emerge around the world.

Nine days after the board's initial meeting, the US and Israel attacked Iran.

The Board of Peace has not met again, and it's still waiting for Hamas to respond to its proposal on disarming, a major concession and perhaps the hardest step. Hamas' founding charter calls for armed resistance against Israel.

A US official said Hamas has not been given a definite deadline to respond to the proposal but added that "patience is not unlimited." The official was not authorised to comment publicly and spoke on condition of anonymity.

Kuwait blames Iran for drone strikes as Trump casts doubt on ceasefire

DUBAI: US President Donald Trump appeared to cast doubt on the effectiveness of the two-week ceasefire over Iran's continued chokehold on the Strait of Hormuz, while Kuwait accused Iran and its proxies of launching drone attacks despite the ceasefire.

Iran's paramilitary Revolutionary Guard denied launching attacks Thursday night on Persian Gulf states.

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu offered a potential boost to ceasefire efforts in the region when he said he had approved direct talks with Lebanon. The Lebanese government has not responded as of Friday morning. The announcement came after Israel pounded Beirut on Wednesday, killing more than 300 people. The negotiations are expected next week in Washington, according to a person familiar with the matter.

Questions remained over what will happen to Iran's stockpile of enriched ura-



US President Donald Trump

“IRAN'S PARAMILITARY REVOLUTIONARY GUARD DENIED LAUNCHING ATTACKS ON PERSIAN GULF”

nium at the heart of tensions, how and when normal traffic will resume through the Strait of Hormuz, and what happens to Iran's ability to launch future missile attacks and support armed proxies in the region.

‘Impartial judicial justice will be true tribute to Gen Z martyrs’

KATHMANDU: Nepal President Ram Chandra Paudel on Friday said “impartial judicial justice would be the true tribute to the Gen Z martyrs”.

At least 76 people, including around two dozen youth, were killed in the Gen Z movement of September 8 and 9 last year, that erupted following a ban on social media and alleged corruption, and led to the ouster of the coalition government led by K P Sharma Oli.

Addressing a joint session of both houses of the parliament at Singha Durbar secretariat for the first time since the Gen Z movement, the president stressed the need for speedy delivery of public services so as to make the people feel the presence of government at their doorstep.

Paudel outlined a 17-point agenda covering governance, economic reform, employment



Nepal President Ram Chandra Paudel

and foreign policy priorities of the government. Addressing the House of Representatives and the National Assembly, Paudel said the newly-elected government has a serious responsibility to strengthen good governance, improve service delivery and accelerate economic development.

Paying tribute to those who lost their lives during Nepal's democratic movements, the president thanked political parties, election officials, security personnel and voters for ensur-

ing “peaceful and credible” parliamentary elections.

He said that the new parliament reflects unprecedented participation of young representatives, signalling growing youth engagement in Nepal's federal democratic system.

Paudel said public aspirations include transparent governance, an end to corruption, job opportunities within the country, social justice and faster economic and social development.

He stressed the need to create employment at home, reform the education system to match labour market demand and address the growing outflow of young workers abroad.

He also underscored the importance of efficient public services, stronger coordination among federal, provincial and local governments, and the rule of law.

Ten Indian nationals indicted for visa fraud conspiracy in US

NEW YORK: Ten Indian nationals, living illegally in the US, have been indicted by a federal grand jury in Boston for conspiring to carry out staged armed robberies at convenience stores for the purpose of visa fraud. They have been indicted by a federal grand jury with one count of conspiracy to commit visa fraud in connection with a conspiracy to carry out staged armed robberies at convenience stores for the purpose of allowing store clerks to falsely claim they were crime victims on immigration applications.

The defendants are Jiten-drakumar Patel, 39; Mahesh-kumar Patel, 36; Sanjaykumar Patel, 45; Dipikaben Patel, 40, deported to India after unlawfully residing in Massachu-

setts; Rameshbhai Patel, 52; Amitabhahen Patel, 43; Ronakkumar Patel, 28; Sangitaben Patel, 36; Minkesh Patel, 42 and Sonal Patel, 42. All 10 defendants were previously charged by criminal complaint and released on conditions. Rameshbhai Patel and Ronakkumar Patel have been taken into immigration custody.

The defendants are subject to deportation upon completion of any sentence imposed, the Justice Department said Thursday.

This case stems from an investigation into Rambhai Patel, the organiser of the scheme, and getaway driver Balwinder Singh – both of whom were charged in December 2023 and later convicted in May 2025.

China's Xi meets Taiwan Oppn leader for the first time in a decade

BEIJING: President Xi Jinping on Friday said peace is the common wish of the people on both sides of the strait, but Taiwan's independence is the chief culprit that is stalling unity, as he met Taiwan's opposition leader Cheng Li-wu here. Cheng is the first Kuomintang (KMT) chairperson to visit China in a decade amid Beijing's efforts to ramp up military and diplomatic pressure on Taiwan to reintegrate with the mainland.

Their meeting comes ahead of US President Donald Trump's visit to China in May.

China claims Taiwan as part of it and pledges to reunite it with the mainland.

“Compatriots on both sides (of the strait) are both Chinese, and we need peace, we need development, we need communication, and we need cooperation. This is a common



Chinese President Xi Jinping, third from right, holds talks with Kuomintang (KMT) party leader Cheng Li-wu, third from left, at the Great Hall of the People in Beijing on Friday

wish,” Xi said.

Xi said that “Taiwan independence” is the chief culprit undermining peace across the Taiwan Strait. “We should neither condone nor tolerate it,” he was quoted by the state-run Xinhua news agency as telling Cheng.

No matter how the interna-

tional landscape and the situation across the Taiwan Strait may evolve, the overarching trend toward the great rejuvenation of the Chinese nation will not change, and the prevailing momentum for the Chinese on both sides of the Strait to come together will not change, he said.

Over 2,200 Sikh pilgrims from India arrive in Pak



People queue at the India-Pakistan Attari-Wagah border to depart for a pilgrimage to gurdwaras in Pakistan ahead of Baisakhi festival, in Attari on Friday

LAHORE:W Over 2,200 Sikh pilgrims from India on Friday arrived in Pakistan's Punjab province through the Attari-Wagah border to participate in the Baisakhi festival and the 327th Khalsa Janam Din celebrations.

Pakistan Punjab's Minority Minister Ramesh Singh Arora and Evacuee Trust Property Board (ETPB) Additional Secretary (Shrines) Nasir Mush-taq received the pilgrims at the Wagah border.

Pakistan had issued 2,800 visas to Indian Sikh pilgrims for Baisakhi festival scheduled to be held on April 14.

“As many as 2,238 Sikh pilgrims crossed into Pakistan from India today to take part in Baisakhi festivities,” Evacuee Trust Property Board (ETPB) spokesperson Ghulam Mohyuddin told PTL.

The main ceremony will be held on April 14 at Gurdwara Panja Sahib in Hasan Abdal, some 400 kms from Lahore.

Besides participating in the annual Baisakhi Mela in Pakistan, the Sikhs from India will also visit Gurdwara Janama Asthan, Nankana Sahib and Kartarpur Sahib.

Arora said despite strained relations between Pakistan and India, more than 2,800 Sikh pilgrims were issued visas.

ETPB's Nasir Mushtaq

“PAK HAD ISSUED 2,800 VISAS TO INDIAN SIKH PILGRIMS FOR BAISAKHI SCHEDULED TO BE HELD ON APRIL 14”

said comprehensive arrangements have been made for the pilgrims, including accommodation, langar (food), transportation and medical facilities.

He said foolproof security arrangements have also been made and buses have been provided for travel.

Jatha leader from the Shiromani Gurdwara Parbandhak Committee (SGPC) Surjit Singh appreciated the respect and hospitality extended to Sikh pilgrims in Pakistan.

The pilgrims were transported in three groups to Gurdwara Janam Asthan, Nankana Sahib, some 80 kms from Lahore. After a two-day stay in Nankana Sahib, they will proceed to Gurdwara Panja Sahib, Hasan Abdal, where the main Baisakhi ceremony is scheduled to be held.

Baisakhi or Vaisakhi is celebrated on the first day of the month of Vaisakh and also marks the beginning of the harvest season.

Ship-tracking data shows tanker movement in Strait of Hormuz

Around 12 ships passed through the Strait since ceasefire

NEW YORK: Underlining Iran's continued control of the Strait of Hormuz, a Botswana-flagged liquefied natural gas tanker called the Nidi attempted to travel out of the Persian Gulf via a route ordered by the Revolutionary Guard but suddenly turned around and headed back early Friday, ship-tracking data showed.

On Thursday, four tankers and three bulk carriers crossed through the Strait of Hormuz, bringing the total number of ships passing through since the ceasefire to at least 12, according to the data firm Kpler.

However, other ships not transmitting their locations may have passed through as well. The strait typically saw well over 100 ships passing through it daily in peacetime.



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

On Thursday evening, US President Donald Trump appeared to be casting doubt on the effectiveness of the ceasefire that has halted the Iran war. “Iran is doing a very poor job, dishonorable some would say, of allowing Oil to go through the Strait of Hormuz,” he wrote on his social media

site. “That is not the agreement we have!”

The post came after Trump posted earlier that “There are reports that Iran is90 charging fees to tankers going through the Hormuz Strait – They better not be and, if they are, they better stop now!”

In his first 100 days, Mamdani brings unique star power to NYC governance

Crowds of supporters show up to his news conferences

NEW YORK: In his first 100 days in office, New York City Mayor Zohran Mamdani has governed with a star power unusual in politics.

Crowds of supporters show up to his news conferences. Basic municipal services have been infused with newfound excitement. Celebrities help him promote his agenda.

In the process, he's been able to notch a few notable early wins. And he's reached a detente — at least for now — with President Donald Trump, a mercurial leader with an affinity for celebrities.

But as Mamdani, a Democrat, marks an early milestone in his mayoralty, it remains to be seen whether he'll be able to leverage his fame into achieving the progressive policy proposals that propelled him to



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

office.

Though he's not without staunch critics, many of whom still view his past criticisms of the police department and

Israel as major problems, the mayor has been able to ease concerns among at least some sceptics.

“It's early, but so far, so

‘We may not agree on everything philosophically, but he is getting the job done’

good,” said Jay Jacobs, chair of the state's Democratic Party, who made waves for not endorsing Mamdani during the election.

“We may not agree on everything philosophically, but he is getting the job done.”

As the mayor approached his 100th day — long a benchmark for judging an administration's opening vision — his team has moved to highlight the administration's commitment to the everyday responsibilities of the job.

World Briefs

SHRAM SANSKRITI PARTY'S RUBY KUMARI ELECTED DEPUTY SPEAKER OF NEPAL PARL

KATHMANDU: Ruby Kumari Thakur of the Shram Sanskriti Party was on Friday elected the deputy speaker to Nepal's House of Representatives with the backing of the ruling Rastriya Swatantra Party (RSP). During the voting in the Lower House, the majority of the lawmakers endorsed a proposal to elect Thakur, 25, as deputy speaker. Speaker Prasad Aryal, who was elected to the post last week representing the RSP, announced her victory.

PAK NAVY RESCUES 18 CREW MEMBERS OF MERCHANT VESSEL IN ARABIAN SEA

ISLAMABAD: The Pakistan Navy on Friday rescued 18 crew members, including Chinese and Bangladeshi nationals, of a merchant vessel in the Arabian Sea in response to a distress call. The call originated from the Merchant Vessel (MV) Gold Autumn, which was operating in the North Arabian Sea at 200 nautical miles (approx 370 km) off Pakistan's coast and a ship of the Pakistan Navy responded immediately, as per statement by the Pakistan Army. It said that PNS Hunain conducted a search and rescue operation.

Nepal: 2 new ministers join Balendra Shah-led govt

KATHMANDU: Nepal's Prime Minister Balendra Shah on Friday inducted two new ministers into his Cabinet. President Ramchandra Paudel administered the oath of office and secrecy to Gauri Kumari Yadav and Ramji Yadav, representing Rastraiya Swatantra Party, at a ceremony at the president's office at Sheetalniwas.

Gauri Kumari Yadav was appointed Minister for Industry, Commerce and Supplies, while Ramji Yadav became Minister for Labour, Employment and Social Security, said a notice issued by the president's office.

With this, the number of cabinet members has increased to 16.

Balendra Shah was sworn in as Nepal's prime minister last month, nearly six months after the dramatic collapse of the Oli government in an unprecedented youth movement.

AGENCIES



GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA, HOME DEPARTMENT (PORTS & TRANSPORT)

MAHARASHTRA MARITIME BOARD

Indian Mercantile Chambers, 2nd Floor, Rajajibai Kanani Marg, Ballard Estate, Mumbai - 400 001. Tel: 022-69041777 Fax: 022-69041740

Website : <https://maharimmb.maharashtra.gov.in>

Email: ceo.mimb@maharashtra.gov.in / ceomimb@gmail.com



E-Tender Notice - (Year 2026-27)

Main Portal: <https://mahatenders.gov.in>

Digitally signed E-Tender for following work is invited by the Chief Executive Officer, Maharashtra Maritime Board, Mumbai, from suitable Agencies etc. having required experience and meeting eligibility criteria, for the following work.

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Earnest Money Amount in Rs.	Blank Tender form amount in Rs.
1.	Development of Integrated Shipbuilding and Ship Repair facility at Griye, Vijaydurg, Taluka - Devgad, District - Sindhudurg, Maharashtra, India	10,00,000/-	11,200/-

The details can be viewed online and downloaded directly from the Government of Maharashtra E-Tendering Portal <https://mahatenders.gov.in> **09.04.2026 at 18:50 to 08.05.2026 at 17:00 hours (IST).**

The right to reject any or all tenders without assigning any reason is reserved.

Sd/-
(Capt. Pravin Khara)
Chief Port Officer,
Maharashtra Maritime Board, Mumbai.

Dgipr/2026-27/166

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Corrigendum

Tender Notice No. 93/2025-2026 dated: 11.03.2026

S.No.: 04 Tender Number 07265018 is due on 13.04.2026

In reference to the above cited tender, the due date of opening of Tender No.07265018 has been postponed from 13.04.2026 to 21.04.2026. The all-other Terms & Conditions of the subject tender will remain unchanged. The Corrigendum has been published on Website www.ireps.gov.in

1199/2026

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NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE

(Through e-tendering)

Tender No. 558-Sig-16-M-TENDER-1474 Dated: 10.04.2026

Name of work with its location	Provision of RTU at Interlocked Mid-Section LC Gates over Delhi Division.
App. Cost of the work (₹)	₹ 3,75,30,585.43/-
Bid Security (₹)	₹ 7,50,600.00/-
Address of the office	Senior Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer-C, Northern Railway, 3rd Floor, Annexe-1, DRM office, New Delhi-110055.
Date & Time for uploading the tender / closing of the tender	Tender uploading 10.04.2026/ closing date & time - 04.05.2026 up to 15.00 hrs.
Website particular & notice board location where complete details of the tender can be seen etc.	See the Northern Railway website www.ireps.gov.in & Notice board at S&T branch, 3rd Floor, DRM office, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055

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NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE

Invitation of Tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

N.I.T.No.	NIT	01/2026-27
1 Name of work with its location	01	Provision of prefabricated S&T building in C/with interlocking of 18 Nos of LC gates With TVU-20000 over Delhi Division. Similar Nature of work: Any structural work made of Pre-cast PSC/RCC panels.
Cost Of Work	01	Rs. 4,86,23,687.61
3 Earnest Money Deposit	01	(It should be in the form of net banking or payment gateway) Only Note:- FDR will not be accepted as EMD for tender invited on IREPS as per Railway Boards letter no 201025/CE-1/CT/51 dated 31.08.2016) Rs. 972500.00
4 Completion period of Work	01	06 Months
5 Date and time for submission of tender and opening of tender: Upto 15.00 hrs on 05.05.2026 Opening of tender at 15.00 hrs. On 05.05.2026.		
6 Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc. Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in .		
No. 128-W/280/OET/2026-27/W-IV/NIT-01 Date 10.04.2026		1216/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

Executive Engineer Office, P. W. Division No. 1, Thane

Parking Plaza Building 8th Floor, Service Road, Off Eastern Express Highway, Near Jupiter Hospital, Thane - 400601.

email : thane1.ee@mahapwd.gov.in Phone : 022-25369293

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST NOTICE NO. 03 OF 2026-27

Expression of Interest (EOI) is called for Appointment of Road Safety Expert for Road Design and Post-Construction iRAP Assessment, Road Safety Improvement and Capacity Strengthening for PWD road network under MRCIGP in Maharashtra.

The detailed EOI notice can be viewed / downloaded from CSRN portal <https://csrm.aadb.org> sof ADB. The detailed EOI notice can also be viewed, on <https://pwd.maharashtra.gov.in> The last date of submission of EOI shall be on 20.05.2026

The authority reserves the right to accept or reject all/ any of the offers without assigning any reason whatsoever. Conditional bid is not accepted.

No./TD/Tender / 4b34 Office of the Executive Engineer P.W. Division No.1 Thane (W) Eastern.Express Highway Date -00u 12o 2_c5

Executive Engineer P.W. Division No.1 Thane

No./TD/Tender / 4034 Sd/-
Office of the Executive Engineer Executive Engineer P.W. Division No.1 Thane (W) P. W. Division No.1 Thane Eastern Express Highway DGIPR/2026-27/155 Date 08.04.2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE

(Through e-tendering)

Tender No. 558-Sig-16-M-T-AMC-097 Dated: 10.04.2026

Name of work with its location	Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract of SSDAC of CEL make for three years over Delhi Division.
App. Cost of the work (₹)	₹ 4,75,02,443.52/-
Bid Security (₹)	₹ 9,50,100.00/-
Address of the office	Senior Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer-C, Northern Railway, 3rd Floor, Annexe-1, DRM office, New Delhi-110055.
Date & Time for uploading the tender / closing of the tender	Tender uploading 10.04.2026 / closing date & time- 04.05.2026 up to 15.00 hrs.
Website particular & notice board location where complete details of the tender can be seen etc.	See the Northern Railway website www.ireps.gov.in & Notice board at S&T branch, 3rd Floor, DRM office, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 1195/26

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, Rupa, W/o Sh. Puran Singh Currently R/o House No. 35, gate No. 405/Foot Road, Near Hanuman Mandir, Shajal Colony, Faridabad, Haryana (and formerly residing at House No. 1955, Plangi Village, Kotla Mubarakpur, Lodhi Road, H.O. South Delhi-110033) hereby declare the following Akash in his biological son, and Manita is his wife. They do not need any of our instructions; instead, they engage in daily quarrels and altercations within the home, display abusive behavior, use filthy language, and habitually lie. I have become utterly distressed by their conduct. Consequently, I have disinherited my sons, Akash, and his wife, Manita, from all my movable and immovable assets. Furthermore, I declare that, effective from this day forward, neither I nor my family shall maintain any form of relationship or connection with Akash and his wife, Manita any individual who, in the future, engages in any form of transaction with our disowned son, Akash, and his wife, Manita, shall be solely responsible for their actions; neither I nor my family shall bear any responsibility or liability in this regard. Furthermore, should any person become entangled in any legal proceedings or disputes arising from or caused by my son Akash and his wife Manita, neither I nor my family shall bear any responsibility whatsoever.

Applicant : Rupa

Noida

NEW OKHLA INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

Administrative Building, Sector-6, Noida G.B. Nagar, (U.P.)

Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tenders are invited from eligible contractors/firm for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in & <https://etender.up.nic.in>. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.

A) Fresh-Tender Work:

S. No.	Jobs No.	Name of the Work	Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs)
1	83/GM/SM(WC-5)/2025-26	M/o Building (R/o Staff Quarter E-3/1C, E-3/7D, 11D/E-3, E- 5/10C, E-5/01D & E-111 in Shatavadi Vihar, Sector-52), Noida.	22.02
2	77/GM/SM(WC-5)/2025-26	D/o Village (Repair, Boundary wall and Renovation in Community Centre in Village-Gijhore), Noida.	25.74
3	58/GM/SM(WC-2)/ET/2025-26	Strengthening of Road (P/L DBM & BC, D & C Block Internal road Sector-20), Noida.	28.46
4	01/GM/SM(WC-2)/ET/2026-27	M/o Building (R/o Boundary wall, toilet, Kota Stone & other misc. work for A-73, A-599 & Mother Dairy Market in Sector-19), Noida.	20.75

The above tenders can be uploaded from dated **13.04.2026 to 27.04.2026 up to 5.00 PM**. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on dated **28.04.2026 at 11.00 AM**.

B) Re-Tender Work:

S. No.	Jobs No.	Name of the Work	Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs)
5	23/DGM/SM(WC-1)/2025-26	Other Maintenance Work (S/o Water Tanker with Labour in Order NGT in Work Circle-1 Area), Noida.	25.09
6	03/GM/SM(WC-1)/2025-26	Boundary wall and Barbed wire (P/F Concertina wire behind H.No.-111-158 and SDF/Indian Oil Servant Quarter 251 to 263 back side boundary wall in Sector-15A), Noida.	13.59
7	31/DGM/SM(WC-2)/ET/2025-26	M/o Drain (Strengthening and covering of drain along ward No.5A, Sector-29), Noida.	16.33
8	33/DGM/SM(WC-2)/ET/2025-26	D/o Village and Maintenance (C/o culvert & M.S. Jaal and other misc. work over drain at different location in Village Nithari Sector-31), Noida.	19.48
9	39/DGM/SM(WC-2)/ET/2025-26	M/o Road (P/F Retro Reflective overhead Signage Board in A, B, C-Block, Sector-31), Noida.	22.99

The above tenders can be uploaded from dated **13.04.2026 to 20.04.2026 up to 5.00 PM**. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on dated **21.04.2026 at 11.00 AM**.

General Manager (Civil) NOIDA

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE Noida

Government of Jharkhand

Rural Works Department

JHARKHAND STATE RURAL ROADS DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY (JSRRDA)

3rd Floor, F.F.P. Building, Dhurwa, Ranchi 834004

NOTICE INVITING TENDERS

(National Competitive Bidding Through e-Procurement)

Re- eTender No.- 04/ 2026-27- 451 (Encl) Ranchi, Dated: 10.04.2026

PR No- 364457 dated 18.10.2025

The undersigned on behalf of Government of Jharkhand invites item rate bids through e-Procurement from the eligible bidders registered* in appropriate class with any State/Central Government/State /Central Government Organization for construction and maintenance for five years of the works (List of schemes shall be displayed in the website pmgsytendersjhr.gov.in) of Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojna PM-JANMAN (Batch-1, 2025-26).

Sr. No	District Name	Block Name	Tendering Package	Road Name / Bridge Name	Road Length (Kms)	Sanction Construction Cost (in lakhs)	Sanction Maintenance Cost (in lakhs)	Total Sanction Cost with Maint. (in lakhs)	Total Package Cost (in lakhs)	Earnest Money (In Lakh)	Time of Completion (in month)
1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11
	Sahibganj	Borio		L023-BANJHI To Narganj reo road to Dey pahar via Champa	6.2	615.74	49.59	665.33			
	Sahibganj	Borio		L044-Sahebganj borio pwd road ro Tetariya	0.8	78.98	0.35	79.33			
1	Sahibganj	Borio	JH-19-PMJANMA N-SBI-01/2025-26 (2 nd Call)	L043-Sahebganj Birio pwd road to PWD Road Paharpur Jabardaha	1.355	131.03	8.6	139.63	1250.67	25.02	15
	Sahibganj	Borio		L047-Sahibganj Borio road Paharpur to Maridih via Tala tola	2.45	233.48	8.83	242.31			
	Sahibganj	Borio		L038-Murgabani to Bara Bangon	1.46	108.84	15.23	124.07			
2		Mandro	JH-19-PMJANMA N-SBI-09/2025-26 (2 nd Call)	L025-Mines Road to Tetaria	1.85	125.63	6.92	132.55			
		Mandro		L032-Mirachauki Karamtola PMGSY Road to Jani	1.00	83.26	3.45	86.71	1229.59	24.59	15
		Mandro		L026-Kolbhanga to Kalajor via Chatra	11.05	888.25	50.74	938.99			
		Borio		L030-Churi reo road to ghuti	0.75	71.01	0.33	71.34			
		Total			26.915	2336.22	144.04	2480.26	2480.26		

The bid should be submitted online in the website pmgsytendersjhr.gov.in. The bidders should have valid Digital Signature Certificate for online submission of bid. Details of bid submission is as under:

Procurement Officer	Place of Opening	Availability of tender (on-line) for bidding	Last date & time of seeking clarification	Last date and time of bid submission	Date & time of opening (on-line) of tender
		From To			Technical bid Financial bid
1	2	3	4	5	6
Engineer in Chief, JSRRDA, Ranchi	Engineer in Chief JSRRDA, Ranchi	13.04.2026 at 10.00 AM	28.04.2026 upto 5.00 PM	20.04.2026 upto 2.00 PM	28.04.2026 at 05.30 PM
* Non-registered bidders may also submit bid, however the successful bidders must get registered in appropriate class with appropriate authority before signing the contract. ** Cost may change.					
Note :- 1. Amount of Bid Security should be taken as mentioned in the Bid Data Sheet of the Bidding Document.					
2. Cost of Bid Document (Rs. 10000) and Bid Security (as mentioned in the Bid Data Sheet) shall be deposited online in form as mentioned in Bid Data Sheet failing which the bid will be treated non responsive and action shall be taken as per Sec. 2 of ITB clause 12.2 (d).					
3. In case, it is found, even after the award of work that the bidder has submitted/ uploaded any false/erroneous/fraudulent statement/document, he/she is liable for blacklisting and forfeiture of Bid Security.					
4. Bidders must submit GST registration certificate without which bid is liable to be rejected.					
5. Bidders whose names appear in the Debar/banlist of RWD or any department of GoI/GoI (including JSRRDA) shall not be allowed to participate in the above bids.					
6. Bids submitted by bidders, who have long pending ATR(s) made inordinate delay in execution of earlier allotted construction/ maintenance works of PMGSY, may be rejected summarily.					
7. In case of any discrepancy/dispute about units in BOQ, units as mentioned in Current SOR on which BOQ has been prepared shall prevail.					
8. Participating bidders are free to submit grievances, if any, against the decision of technical evaluation within five days from the date of uploading of decision of technical evaluation only through email at jh-ee@pmgsy.nic.in Grievance submitted after stipulated period shall not be considered.					
9. Bidders must have valid registration with Employee Provident Fund organization under EPF and Miscellaneous Provisions Act 1952 failing which the bid shall be rejected.					
10. Bidders must not quote rate for routine maintenance. The amount for routine maintenance as indicated in the Bill of Quantities must be acceptable to bidders.					
11. For unbalanced bids, extra security will be required to be deposited by the bidder at the time of Agreement.					
12. The undersigned reserves the right to cancel the tender at any stage without giving prior notice/reason.					
All other details can be seen in the bidding document which is available in website pmgsytendersjhr.gov.in as per schedule mentioned above.					

Engineer-in- Chief
Rural Works Department- Cum-
JSRRDA, Ranchi

PR 377161 (Rural Work Department) 26-27 (D)

Bandhan Bank

Regional Office: Netaji Marg, Nr. Mithakhali Six Roads, Ellisbridge, Ahmedabad-6. Phone: + 91-79-26421671-75

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE

NOTICE is hereby given under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, the Authorized Officer issued demand notice to the borrower(s) on the date mentioned against the account stated hereinafter calling upon them to repay the amount within 60 days from the date of receipt of said notice. The borrower(s) having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular the borrower(s) that the undersigned has taken the symbolic possession of the property described herein below under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said Rules on the date mentioned against the account. The borrower(s) in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealing with the property will be subject to the charge of the Bank for the amounts, interest, costs and charges thereon. The borrowers' mortgagors' attention is invited to the provisions of sub-section (8) of Section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

Name of borrower(s), Guarantor & Loan Account No.	Description of the property mortgaged (Secured Asset)	Date of Demand Notice	Date of Symbolic Possession Notice	O/s Amount as on date of Demand Notice
Mr. Krishna Kumar W/o Sh. Rita Jaysawal M/O Sh. Chuni Lal 90001339932369	All The Piece And Parcel H.No. 43a, Area Measuring 40 Sq. Yds, Out Of Khasra No. 536, Situated At Sai Dham Colony, VillageGachhiyana Bujurg (Railway Line Ke Par), Pargana & Tehsil- Dadri, Distt.- G.B Nagar, U.P.-203207, Owned By Rita Jaysawal W/O Sh. Chuni Lal Chaudhary And Same Bounded As Under: North: Other Property, East: Other Property, West: Other Property, South: Rasta 20 Ft. Wide Kachha	December 15, 2025	April 08, 2026	Rs.25,56,266.38

Place: Dadri
Date: April 11, 2026

Authorised Officer
Bandhan Bank Limited

UJVN Limited

(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)

H.O. "UJJAWAL" Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road Dehradun 248006
Telephone-0135-2763808, Fax 0135-2763808
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website : www.ujvnl.com

पत्र सं: 295 दिनांक: 10 / 04 / 2026

Tender Notice

The office of Executive Engineer (Maintenance), Maneri Bhal Stage-II, Chinyalasar (Uttarkashi) invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tenders is given below:

Tender No: NIT- 06/EE(M)/MB-II/2026-27, 07/EE(M)/MB-II/2026-27, 08/EE(M)/MB-II/2026-27

Name of work / Supply/Services:

1. Servicing of 02 Alfa Laval Centrifuging Machines at Dharasu Power House, MB-II, Uttarkashi.
2. Repair of different T&P items at Dharasu Power House, Uttarkashi.
3. Annual Cleaning of Grass, bushes and rearrangement of materials in central store area at Dharasu Power house.

Estimated cost : Rs.07,85,642/- Only (Taxes extra), Rs 04,83,000.00 (Taxes Extra), Rs 04,44,474.00 (Taxes Extra)

Date of availability of bid document on website : 13.04.2026
Last date for submission of tender : 04.05.2026 up to 11:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvnl.com"

Executive Engineer (Maintenance)

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

CORPORATE MERCHANT BANKERS LIMITED

CIN: L74890DL1994PLC061107

Registered Address: A-19, Ground Floor, Okhla Phase-2, FIEE Complex, Kartar Tower, Okhla Industrial Estate, South Delhi, Delhi-110020 • E-mail: cmdbdelhi@gmail.com
Website: corporatemerchantsbankerslimited.com • Contact no: +919662903969

NOTICE OF POSTAL BALLOT

The Members of M/s. Corporate Merchant Bankers Limited ("the Company") are hereby informed that pursuant to Section 109 and 110 and other applicable provisions, if any, of the Companies Act, 2013 ("the Act") read together with Rules 20 and 22 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014 ("the Rules") (as amended from time to time), including any statutory modification(s) or re-enactment(s) thereof for the time being in force, Regulation 44 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (as amended from time to time) ("SEBI (LODR) Regulations"), Secretarial Standard-2 ("SS-2") issued by the Institute of Company Secretaries of India on General Meetings ("SS-2") and the clarifications issued by Ministry of Corporate Affairs vide General Circular No. 14/2020 dated 8th April, 2020, 17/2020 dated 13th April, 2020 read after other relevant circulars, including Latest General Circular No. 03/2025 dated September 22, 2025 issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs ("MCA") (hereinafter collectively referred to as "MCA Circulars"), and subject to other applicable laws, rules and regulations, if any, Corporate Merchant Bankers Limited ("the Company") seeks approval of the members for the Special Businesses as set out in the postal ballot notice dated 10th April, 2026 along with the explanatory by only way of voting through electronic means ("remote e-voting").

The electronic copies of Postal Ballot Notice ("Notice") along with the Explanatory Statement has been dispatched on Friday, 10th April, 2026, to those Members whose names appear on the Register of Members/List of Beneficial Owners as received from the National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL) and Central Depository Services (India) Limited ("CDSL") as on Friday, 3rd April, 2026 and who have registered their e-mail addresses with the company/depositories. In accordance with the MCA Circulars, Physical copies of the Postal Ballot Notice along with Postal Ballot forms and pre-paid business reply envelopes are not being sent to Members for this Postal Ballot.

Notice is available on the Company's website i.e. corporatemerchantsbankerslimited.com and on the website of stock exchange i.e. the BSE at www.bseindia.com and Metropolitan Stock Exchange (MSEI) at www.mseil.in and on website of NSDL at www.evoting.nsdl.com Detailed process to register e-mail addresses for members who have not registered their email addresses is provided in the Notice. The Company has engaged the services of National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL) to provide remote e-voting facility to the Members of the Company. The detailed instructions for E-voting have been provided in Notice.

The remote E-voting facility is available during the following period:

Commencement of E-voting :	09:00 A.M. on Saturday, 11th April, 2026
Ends of E-voting :	05:00 P.M. on Sunday, 10th May, 2026

The remote e-voting module shall be disabled by NSDL for voting thereafter.

During this period, Members holding shares either in physical form or in dematerialized form as on Friday, 3rd April, 2026 (Cut-Off date) may cast their vote by e-voting. Once the vote on a resolution is cast by the Member, he/she is not allowed to change it subsequently. The voting rights of the Members shall be in proportion to their share of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company as on the Cut-off date. A person who is not a member as on the cut-off date should treat this Notice for information purpose only.

The Board of Directors of the Company had appointed Mr. Jay Pandya, M/s. Jay Pandya & Associates, Company Secretaries Ahmedabad (Membership No. ACS 63213 and Certificate of Practice No. 24319), to act as the Scrutinizer, to conduct the Postal Ballot through remote e-voting process in a fair and transparent manner.

The Scrutinizer shall submit his report to the authorized Director of the Company, or any other person authorized by him upon completion of the scrutiny of the votes cast through remote e-voting. The results of the Postal Ballot e-voting will be announced within Two working days from the conclusion of the e-voting and the same shall be displayed on the working days from the conclusion of the e-voting and the same shall be displayed on the website of the Company at corporatemerchantsbankerslimited.com, and on website of NSDL and the same will be communicated to BSE Limited (BSE) and Metropolitan Stock Exchange (MSEI), being the stock exchange where the equity shares of the Company are listed.

In case of any queries regarding e-voting, you may refer the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) for Shareholders and e-voting user manual for Shareholders available at the download section of www.evoting.nsdl.com or call on: 022-4886 7000 or send a request at evoting@nsdl.com.

Place : Ahmedabad For, **CORPORATE MERCHANT BANKERS LIMITED.**
Date : 10th April, 2026 SD/- Vishal Jethalal Nayak - Managing Director
DIN: 11048209

UJVN Ltd.

(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)

H.O. "UJJWAL" Maharani Bagh, GMS Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone-0135-2763808 Fax 0135-2763808
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

RO No. 300 **e-Tender Notice** **Date: 10.04.2026**

Office of the Executive Engineer (Generation), Khodri Power Station, Dakpathar (Dehradun), invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:

e-Tender No: 01/EE(Gen)/Khodri/2026-27: Procurement of Consumable items for Light & Auxiliary Section at Khodri Power Station.

Estimated cost : Rs. 9,89,582/- G.S.T. extra .

Date of availability of bid document on portal: 13.04.2026, 10:00 hrs.

Last date for submission of tender on portal: 04.05.2026 up to 16:00 hrs.

For downloading tender documents and other details, kindly visit e-procurement portal "<https://uktenders.gov.in>". For further details, kindly visit our website www.ujvnl.com.

Executive Engineer (Generation)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Aadesh @ Rahul S/o Ram Kumar R/o Near Murgi Farm Shyam Vihar, Bharat Vihar, Sector-15, Dwarka North, Delhi, Ph. Add.: Village Kachiya Purva, Post-Shuklapur Bhagat, P.S. Madhavganj, Hardoi (U.P.),** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 20/2022, U/S 380/411/34 IPC, PS Dwarka North, Dwarka Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Aadesh @ Rahul** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Aadesh @ Rahul** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Aadesh @ Rahul** the said accused of **FIR No. 20/2022, U/S 380/411/34 IPC, PS Dwarka North, Dwarka Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **28.05.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Rahul Katare
Judicial Magistrate First Class-06,
South-West Distt., Court No. 514,
Dwarka Courts, New Delhi

DP/4676/DW/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person Namely **Elivs, S/o Friday R/o 100A, 3rd Floor Khasra No. 10/22/2 Nihal Vihar - Ph-02 Chander Vihar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 1127/2024, U/s 14/14C Foreg Act PS: Nihal Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Elivs**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Elivs**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Elivs**, accused of **FIR No. 1127/2024, U/s 14/14C Foreg Act PS: Nihal Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **12.05.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Komal Garg
JMFC-03, Room No. 2

Stock mkts rebound over 1% on buying in banking stocks

Rupee depreciates by 32 paise to 92.83 against US dollar

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Stock market benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty surged over 1 per cent on Friday, propelled by buying in banking counters and a positive trend in global equities. Investor sentiment improved amid hopes of further easing in the West Asia crisis ahead of US-Iran negotiations and lower crude prices, analysts said.

After staying in the positive territory throughout the day, the 30-share BSE Sensex later jumped 918.60 points or 1.20 per cent to settle at 77,550.25. During the day, it surged 990.85 points or 1.29 per cent to 77,622.50.

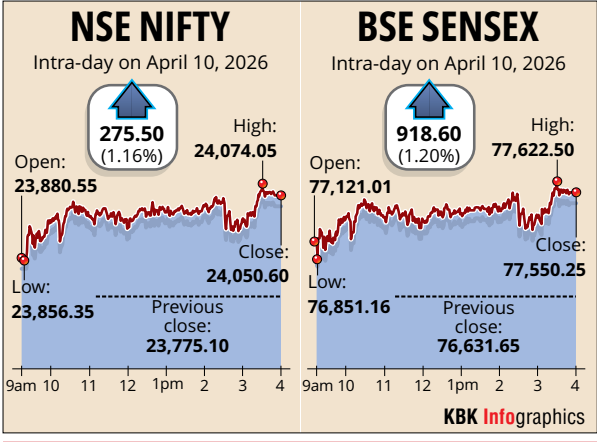
A total of 3,360 stocks advanced while 945 declined and 144 remained unchanged on the BSE.

The 50-share NSE Nifty climbed 275.50 points or 1.16 per cent to end at 24,050.60.

On the weekly front, the BSE benchmark jumped 4,230.7 points or 5.77 per cent, and the Nifty surged 1,337.5 points or 5.88 per cent.

From the 30-Sensex firms, Asian Paints, ICIICI Bank, Mahindra & Mahindra, InterGlobe Aviation, Axis Bank and State Bank of India were the major gainers.

On the other hand, Sun



Auto rose 2.75%, Capital Goods (2.27%), Consumer Durables (2.20%), Industrials (2.19%), Consumer Discretionary (2.18%), Bankex (2.06%), and Realty (2.02%)

Pharma, Infosys, Tata Consultancy Services, Tech Mahindra and HCL Tech were the laggards.

The BSE Small Cap Select index jumped 1.64 per cent, and the MidCap Select index climbed 1.50 per cent.

Auto jumped 2.75 per cent, Capital Goods (2.27 per cent), Consumer Durables (2.20 per cent), Industrials (2.19 per cent), Consumer Discretionary (2.18 per cent), Bankex (2.06 per cent), and Realty (2.02 per cent). In contrast, BSE

IT and Focused IT were the laggards.

The positive trend was led by buying in banking, auto and financial stocks, while IT counters saw some profit booking after TCS' financial results.

The rupee pared initial gains and settled for the day 32 paise lower at 92.83 against the US dollar on Friday, weighed down by risks from rising global tensions, especially the US-Iran conflict.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, climbed 0.57 per

Highlights

» A total of 3,360 stocks advanced while 945 declined and 144 remained unchanged on the BSE

» On the weekly front, the BSE benchmark jumped 4,230.7 points or 5.77 per cent, and the Nifty surged 1,337.5 points or 5.88 per cent

» From the 30-Sensex firms, Asian Paints, ICIICI Bank, Mahindra & Mahindra, InterGlobe Aviation, Axis Bank and State Bank of India were the major gainers

cent to \$96.47 per barrel.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth Rs 1,711.19 crore on Thursday, according to exchange data.

Domestic Institutional Investors (DIIs), however, bought stocks worth Rs 955.90 crore.

On Thursday, the Sensex dropped 931.25 points, or 1.20 per cent, to settle at 76,631.65. The Nifty declined 222.25 points or 0.93 per cent to end at 23,775.10.

Inflow in equity mutual funds surges 56% to ₹40,450 cr in March despite market volatility

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Equity mutual funds witnessed a net inflow of Rs 40,450 crore in March, marking an increase of 56 per cent from the preceding month, reflecting sustained investor confidence despite market volatility and heightened geopolitical tensions.

This was the highest monthly net inflow after July 2025, when the equity-oriented mutual funds received a net inflow of Rs 42,702 crore.

"The surge in inflows reflects sustained retail engagement through SIP contributions, year-end portfolio allocations, and investors using recent market corrections as an opportunity to deploy incremental capital into equities," Himanshu Srivastava, Principal Research, Morningstar Investment Research India, said.

Umesh Sharma, CIO-Debt, The Wealth Company Mutual, said the inflow rose sharply following the post-correction phase in equity markets after the onset of the West Asia conflict created more attractive investment opportunities.

Moreover, monthly contributions through SIPs (Systematic Investment Plans) rose to an all-time high of Rs 32,087 crore from Rs 29,845 crore in the preceding month, highlighting the growing preference for disciplined, systematic investing, according to the data released by the Association of Mutual Funds in India (AMFI).

Venkat Chalasani, Chief Executive at AMFI, said the

Moreover, monthly contributions through SIPs (Systematic Investment Plans) rose to an all-time high of Rs 32,087 crore from Rs 29,845 crore in the preceding month

inflow reflects sustained investor confidence in long-term wealth creation through mutual funds. "India's structural growth story remains strong, and investors continue to align their investments with long-term financial goals."

Overall, the mutual fund industry recorded a net withdrawal of Rs 2.4 lakh crore in March after witnessing an inflow of Rs 94,530 crore in February. This was largely driven by a huge outflow of Rs 2.95 lakh crore in debt funds.

March typically witnesses a surge in outflows due to higher redemptions, particularly from debt mutual funds, as companies redeem money from liquid funds to meet year-end commitments.

"However, this is just a temporary blip, and industry is likely to witness a surge in inflows in the coming months backed by India's strong macroeconomic fundamentals and valuations of domestic equities looking favourable," Ankur Punj, MD & Business Head, Equirus Wealth.

The outflow has pulled the industry's assets under management to Rs 73.73 lakh crore in March-end from Rs 82.03 lakh crore in February-end.

"The AUM decline is a mark-to-market story driven by a sharp equity market correction during the month, not a confidence story. The net outflow is almost entirely driven by debt fund redemptions, which is a well-established quarter-end phenomenon in March," said Nitin Agrawal, CEO, Mutual Funds, InCred Money.

According to data, equity inflows rose to Rs 40,450 crore in March from Rs 25,978 crore in February. This was also the 61st consecutive month of positive net inflows.

The positive flows were largely driven by strong participation in Flexi Cap, Mid Cap and Small Cap funds, which together accounted for a significant share of the total net additions.

Within the equity segment, Flexi Cap funds led the category with net inflows of over Rs 10,000 crore, followed by Small Cap funds at Rs 6,263 crore and Mid Cap funds at Rs 6,063 crore.

While most categories recorded positive flows, Dividend Yield and Equity Linked Savings Scheme (ELSS) funds saw marginal outflows due to some profit booking or portfolio rebalancing.

Apart from equities, hybrid schemes reported net outflows of nearly Rs 16,500 crore, largely driven by Arbitrage Funds, which alone saw outflows of Rs 21,000 crore. In contrast,

Multi-Asset Allocation Funds registered inflows of over Rs 5,000 crore, suggesting a preference for diversified asset allocation strategies amid heightened global uncertainty.

Meanwhile, gold exchange-traded funds saw inflows of Rs 2,266 crore in March, which was much lower than the Rs 5,255 crore seen in February and Rs 24,040 crore in January. While the pace of inflows has moderated sequentially, investor interest in gold-backed products remained positive.

"The slower inflows in March likely reflect a combination of normalization after a very strong start to the year and some moderation in fresh allocations. January had seen unusually elevated inflows, likely supported by strong risk aversion, portfolio rebalancing, and momentum in gold prices, making subsequent monthly numbers look softer by comparison," said Nehal Meshram, Senior Analyst, Morningstar Investment Research India.

On the other hand, debt funds saw an outflow of Rs 2.95 lakh crore in March as compared to Rs 42,106 crore inflow in February.

The sharp reversal in debt fund flows in March was driven largely by heavy redemptions from short-term and liquidity-oriented categories. Liquid Funds saw the biggest outflows at Rs 1.35 lakh crore, followed by Overnight Funds at Rs 40,228 crore, Money Market Funds at Rs 29,207 crore, and Low Duration Funds at Rs 25,227 crore.

RBI aims to cut auction turnaround time, boost g-sec price transparency

MUMBAI: The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Friday announced its plan to reduce turnaround time for auctions, strengthen price transparency in the government securities market and enhance retail participation under its 'Utkarsh 2029' strategy.

The central bank said it aims to enhance the competitiveness of markets under its ambit and bolster infrastructure by automating processes, increasing central clearing for improved operational efficiency, reducing risk, and enhancing market access. Utkarsh 2029 is the strategy framework of the RBI for the period between April 2026 and March 2029, to transform the institutional purpose into actionable excellence.

Under this framework, the central bank also aims to minimise procedural redundan-



The RBI said it aims to enhance the competitiveness of markets under its ambit

cies, empower regulated entities with greater operational flexibility, and encourage responsible innovation in present and emerging realms of the financial system.

The RBI has outlined to assess customer service in

scheduled commercial banks and to cover grievance escalation across all regulated entities to accelerate grievance redressal and empower customers, according to a release.

By scaling up Unified Lending Interface (ULI), the RBI attempts to enhance access to the financial system, reduce lending costs, and promote inclusive credit delivery, it added.

Underscoring the interconnectedness in the financial system, the central bank intends to review and enhance the system-wide contagion risk assessment. By reviewing the delivery of services under the Citizens' Charter and publishing periodic metrics on the same, RBI affirms its commitment to continuous self-appraisal and public service, according to the release.

I-T department disposed of 2.22 lakh appeals during last financial year: CBDT Chairman

NEW DELHI: The Income Tax Department disposed of 2.22 lakh appeals in 2025-26, recording a nearly 29 per cent increase over the previous fiscal, as part of efforts to reduce litigation and enhance taxpayer services, according to official data.

In a year-end communication, Ravi Agrawal, Chairman of the Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT), praised officials for their performance and emphasised that actions in FY27 should be guided by data, proportionate enforcement and the goal of building a "fair and efficient" tax system.

Agrawal noted that the department has significantly strengthened its use of data analytics and intelligence-driven methods to identify risks and guide enforcement. It also undertook "theme-based"



CBDT Chairman Ravi Agrawal

investigations to address issues such as incorrect deduction claims and systemic suppression of business receipts.

During FY26, the department disposed of 2,22,540 appeals, compared with 1,72,361 in FY25, reflecting a growth of 29.11 per cent. Of the 1,51,239 legacy appeals pending at the beginning of the year, 50,654 cases were cleared through a special drive aimed at bringing greater certainty to the tax sys-

The dept also resolved 72,933 grievances during the year, with an average resolution time of 47 days

tem. This resulted in a 33.49 per cent reduction in carry-forward pendency of legacy appeals.

The department also resolved 72,933 grievances during the year, with an average resolution time of 47 days. Additionally, 1,32,125 rectification applications were processed and 5,68,621 orders giving effect (OGEs) were issued.

Overall, more than 10.26 lakh cases—covering rectifications, OGEs and grievance

redressal—were disposed of, leading to a reduction of Rs 12.33 lakh crore in outstanding tax demand.

The CBDT also granted registrations or re-registrations to about 1.56 lakh trusts under the charitable institutions category, with many legacy records digitised. Further, the department signed 219 advance pricing agreements (APAs), up 25.86 per cent from 174 in the previous fiscal, providing greater certainty to taxpayers in transfer pricing matters.

Agrawal highlighted that 2026 holds "special significance" with the rollout of the Income Tax Act, 2025 and Income Tax Rules, 2026. These reforms are aimed at simplifying compliance while strengthening a non-intrusive, technology-driven tax administration.

AGENCIES

Forex stocks rise \$9.063 bn to \$697.121 bn



MUMBAI: India's forex reserves jumped by \$9.063 billion to \$697.121 billion for the week ended April 3, 2026, the RBI said on Friday. In the previous week, which ended on March 27, the overall reserves had dropped by \$10.288 billion to \$688.058 billion.

The forex kitty had expanded to an all-time high of \$728.494 billion during the week ended February 27 this year, before the onset of the West Asia crisis, which led to several weeks of depletion.

For the week ended April 3, foreign currency assets, a major component of the reserves, increased by \$1.784 billion to \$552.856 billion, the central bank's data showed.

The foreign currency assets include the effects of appreciation or depreciation of non-US units, such as the euro, pound, and yen, held in the foreign exchange reserves.

Value of gold reserves increased by \$7.221 billion to \$120.742 billion during the week, the RBI said.

The Special Drawing Rights (SDRs) were up \$58 million to \$18.707 billion, the apex bank said.

India's reserve position with the IMF was unchanged at \$4.816 billion at the end of the reporting week, according to the RBI data.

PTI

NSE deploys its Immediate Acknowledgement feature across derivatives segments from April 11

MUMBAI: The National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) has rolled out its Immediate Acknowledgement feature across Currency Derivatives, Commodity Derivatives, Cash (Capital Market) and Equity Derivatives from April 11, 2026, enabling order acknowledgements in nanoseconds for median and mean observations—sharply improving on the earlier 100 microseconds response time.

The upgrade marks a major leap in NSE's trading infrastructure, reinforcing India's standing in global exchange technology and advancing a more transparent and efficient capital markets ecosystem.

The Technological Leap



Under the new system, every order sent to NSE is acknowledged almost instantly in nanoseconds (1 second = 10⁹ microseconds = 10⁹ nanoseconds).

This immediate confirmation is followed by the usual processing message—confirmation or rejection—allowing market participants to track order receipt in real time with

far greater certainty. NSE said no other exchange globally currently claims such nanosecond-level response times.

Phased Rollout

The feature, enabled through a new encryption mechanism, was introduced in stages:

- (1) Currency Derivatives – July 12, 2025
- (2) Commodity Derivatives – December 13, 2025
- (3) Capital Market/Equities – April 11, 2026
- (4) Equity Derivatives – April 11, 2026

For cash and equity derivatives, a phased coexistence period has been provided to ensure a smooth transition from the existing system.

Why This Matters

Enhanced Transparency: Instant acknowledgements eliminate uncertainty in order processing.

Operational Confidence: Real-time tracking supports faster decisions and improved risk management.

Global Leadership:

The speed enhancement underscores NSE's commitment to maintaining infrastructure that rivals, and leads, the world's most advanced exchanges.

Seamless Transition:

The phased coexistence model ensures zero disruption to ongoing trading operations while transitioning to the new framework.

MP05T

MUMBAI: On World Health Day, findings from Aditya Birla Sun Life Insurance's A-Nishchit Index 2.0 show a shift in how Indians perceive health—from an occasional concern to a continuous financial risk driven by climate change and daily stress. Environmental factors are now the second-largest source of anxiety, contributing to India's uncertainty score of 79. Health risks are no longer viewed as distant. About 81 per cent expect worsening pollution, while 82 per cent are concerned about rising healthcare costs, highlighting the growing link between environmental conditions, physical wellbeing and household finances.

The impact varies regionally. In the North, respondents report climate-linked illnesses and disrupted routines, while the East shows heightened concern around elderly care. The South points to rising temperatures and vector-borne diseases, and western metros like Mumbai cite pollution and heat affecting productivity—indicating that while climate risk is widespread, its financial impact is localised.

Frequent illnesses linked to pollution, extreme heat and seasonal outbreaks are placing repeated financial strain on families. Concerns include respiratory issues, fatigue, cancer risks and recurring medical

expenses. Events such as heatwaves, floods and seasonal diseases are increasingly seen as recurring disruptions.

Despite rising awareness, preparedness remains low. Nearly 79 per cent are unsure if their insurance covers serious illness, and 80 per cent doubt they have adequate savings for emergencies. Mental health is also a growing concern, with 81 per cent reporting issues, though most hesitate to seek professional help.

The report underscores the need for stronger financial planning, better insurance coverage and greater focus on mental wellbeing as climate-linked risks intensify.

MP05T

RBI to conduct ₹2L cr 7-day VRRR auction on April 17

MUMBAI: The RBI will conduct Rs 2 lakh crore Variable Rate Reverse Repo (VRRR) seven days later on Friday.

"In view of the surplus transient liquidity conditions prevailing now, it has been decided to conduct a VRRR auction on Friday," the central bank said in a release.

The auction will take place between 2 pm and 2:30 pm, and the reversal of these funds will take place on April 17.

The liquidity in the banking system turned huge surplus on the back of maturity of government securities (G-Secs).

G-Secs worth Rs 31,329 crore have matured on April 8.

Further, maturities scheduled on April 12 and April 17, are worth Rs 86,403 crore and Rs 34,791 crore, respectively.

Currently, the liquidity in the banking system is expected to be in surplus of around Rs 4.55 lakh crore as on April 9, RBI data showed.

"Going ahead, we will continue to be proactive and pre-emptive in liquidity management and ensure sufficient liquidity in the banking system to meet the productive requirements of the economy," Reserve Bank of India Governor Sanjay Malhotra said after the monetary policy review earlier this week.

PTI

Illicit trade undermines consumer trust, economic integrity: Joshi

‘Such activities expose consumers to unsafe and substandard products and undermine public welfare’

NEW DELHI: Union Minister of Consumer Affairs, Food & Public Distribution Pralhad Joshi termed smuggling and counterfeiting a "shadow economy" that harms consumers, businesses and government revenues, calling for a collective response to curb the threat.

Addressing a FICCI CASCADE seminar, he said such activities expose consumers to unsafe and substandard products and undermine public welfare. "The objective is not just consumer protection, but consumer prosperity," he said, adding that initiatives like the Central Consumer Protection



Authority and "Jago Grahak Jago" are key to empowering citizens. "When a product is fake...it is a betrayal of con-

sumer trust," he added.

Nidhi Khare, Secretary, Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution,

CLOSER LOOK

» 'Initiatives like Central Consumer Protection Authority & Jago Grahak Jago are key to empowering citizens'

» 'Counterfeiting and smuggling are profit-driven crimes requiring disruption of financial flows, not just seizure'

GoI, said, "we are living in a time when India has emerged as the world's fourth-largest economy." Highlighting reforms,

she said, "From 'Jago Grahak Jago' to AI-driven grievance redressal, we are building a system that is faster, more efficient, and transparent," noting resolution timelines have fallen from 63 days to about 21 days, and even 72 hours in some cases. On e-commerce, she said platforms are stepping up through delisting & monitoring, but "the challenge extends beyond digital marketplaces into physical supply chains," calling for stronger standards, MSME support and enforcement.

Anil Rajput, Chairman, FICCI CASCADE, said, "advancing consumer pro-

tection today requires a decisive shift... We need better intelligence-sharing, stronger enforcement mechanisms, & greater use of technology," alongside a whole-of-society approach.

P C Jha, Advisor, FICCI CASCADE and former CBIC Chairman, said smuggling and counterfeiting are profit-driven crimes requiring disruption of financial flows, not just seizure of consignments.

The seminar underscored the need for coordinated, technology-driven action & stronger consumer-centric frameworks to combat illicit trade.

MP05T

ONGC warns against overreliance on Middle East energy supplies

India must invest in building strategic storages as insurance against price & supply disruptions, ONGC Chairman Arun Kumar Singh said

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: As the world scrambles to recover from the biggest energy shock in decades triggered by the West Asia conflict, India should be cautious about relying on traditional supply assumptions, particularly its proximity to the Middle East for sourcing oil and gas, ONGC Chairman and CEO Arun Kumar Singh said on Friday.

India, which relied on the Middle East to meet nearly half of its crude oil imports, 30 per cent of its gas and 85-90 per cent of LPG, must invest in building strategic storages as an insurance against price and supply disruptions, he said.

The six-week long conflict shut the only shipping lane that was used by the Gulf countries to export crude oil (raw material for making petrol and diesel), natural gas (used to make fertilizer, generate electricity, turn into CNG to power automobiles and piped to household kitchens for cooking) and cooking gas LPG.

This led to an energy crisis in several importing countries, including India which had to prioritise supply of gas.

"Thinking that the Middle East is nearest to us and there-



The six-week long conflict shut the only shipping lane that was used by the Gulf countries to export crude oil, natural gas and cooking gas LPG

fore all their resources (can be accessed easily), we should take it with a pinch of salt," Singh said at the Energy Security conclave organised by oil regulator PNGRB.

He warned that a shifting global order and rising geopolitical tensions are undermining long-held assumptions about energy security.

"A paradigm shift has happened," he said. "If the world gets more and more de-glo-

balised, we will have more and more problems."

Singh said India's high energy import dependence makes it especially vulnerable in an increasingly fragmented world.

"For the next 30-40 years... if you have multiple (powers), then you have everyday... war of supremacy," he said.

He stressed that boosting domestic production is now critical. "We have been doing

Highlights

» 'Thinking that the Middle East is nearest to us and therefore all their resources (can be accessed easily), we should take it with a pinch of salt,' Singh said

» 'A shifting global order and rising geopolitical tensions are undermining long-held assumptions about energy security'

» Singh said India's high energy import dependence makes it especially vulnerable in an increasingly fragmented world

it very intensely except for deep water," he said, adding that increasing output is an "existential necessity".

Calling for a strategic reset, Singh urged India to aggressively pursue domestic exploration and build resilience.

"We should chase wherever oil or gas is in our country at any cost, because in a crisis nobody (will help)," he said. He also emphasised the need to expand storage capacity. "We

must now address this storage... whatever it takes," Singh said.

Highlighting growing volatility in global markets, he said refining economies have become increasingly unpredictable.

"We should be prepared to see more and more of this," he said, citing unprecedented instances where product margins exceeded crude costs. "Nobody had ever imagined... at least I, in this industry for last 40 years." Singh also pointed to rising resource nationalism among producer nations.

"No country wants you to take away his oil. He wants you to take away his money, not the oil," he said. He called for diversification across fuels and supply chains. "We must diversify energy types... we must diversify our energy storage," he said.

On liquefied petroleum gas (LPG), Singh said India has boosted domestic supply significantly.

"Earlier 30 per cent, now 60 per cent," he said, adding that refiners reconfigured operations to support the shift, though "it has come at a cost." He also suggested prioritising piped natural gas for households. "Instead of CNG... directive should be towards piped natural gas (PNG)," he said.

ADB ups India's FY27 GDP growth projections to 6.9%

It projected inflation to more than double from 2.1 per cent in 2025-26 to 4.5 per cent in the current fiscal

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Asian Development Bank (ADB) on Friday projected India's GDP growth to remain "robust" at 6.9 per cent in the current fiscal, and rise to 7.3 per cent in next fiscal driven by strong domestic demand, and supported by easing financing conditions and lower US tariffs on Indian goods.

In its Asian Development Outlook April 2026 report, the ADB said a prolonged conflict in the Middle East could undermine India's macroeconomic performance through multiple channels, including higher energy prices, trade flow disruptions, and weaker remittance inflows.

It projected inflation to more than double from 2.1 per cent in 2025-26 to 4.5 per cent in the current fiscal due to a rebound in food prices from earlier declines, higher global oil prices, currency weakness, and rising precious metal prices. It projected inflation to ease to 4 per cent in the 2027-28 fiscal on account of lower oil prices and moderating food prices.

"A prolonged conflict in the Middle East is the single biggest risk to the (developing Asia and Pacific) region's outlook, as it could lead to persistently high energy and food prices and



tighter financial conditions," said ADB Chief Economist Albert Park. "With renewed trade policy uncertainty posing additional risks, it is essential that governments implement sound macroeconomic policies to sustain growth and contain inflation, with targeted support measures to protect vulnerable households."

ADB expects economic growth in developing Asia and the Pacific to slow to 5.1 per cent in both 2026 and 2027, from 5.4 per cent last year, weighed down by the conflict in the Middle East and continuing trade uncertainty.

The recent surge in energy prices and potential disruptions to fertiliser markets linked to the conflict in the Middle East could lead to inflationary pressure on global food prices, it said.

With regard to India, ADB said GDP growth is projected to decline to 6.9 per cent in current fiscal (April-March), from 7.6 per cent in 2025-26 primarily due to external chal-

lenges, and expand to 7.3 per cent in FY2027 as consumption and investment benefit from favourable policies and the external environment improves.

A key policy challenge of India is to rationalise subsidies and transfers to protect vulnerable groups while preserving fiscal space for growth-enhancing public investment, it said.

"Despite a worsening global economic and geopolitical environment, growth in India is forecast to remain robust at 6.9 per cent in fiscal year 2026 (2026-27).

Activity will be underpinned by strong domestic demand, supported by easing financing conditions, and lower US tariffs on Indian goods," it said.

ADB's growth projections compare with 6.9 per cent estimated by the RBI, 6.6 per cent by the World Bank, 6.1 per cent by the OECD and 6 per cent by Moody's Ratings.

Growth is projected to rise to 7.3 per cent in FY 2027-28, driven by domestic reforms, the effects of trade agreements with the European Union, and expected government salary increases, ADB added.

In the Asia Development Outlook report released in December, 2025, ADB had projected India's GDP growth at 6.5 per cent for 2026-27 fiscal.

Nitin Gadkari bats for 100% land acquisition before approving national highway projects

NEW DELHI: Union Road Transport and Highways Minister Nitin Gadkari on Friday opined that no new national highway project should be approved without a 100 per cent land acquisition, as it is a major hurdle in road construction.

Addressing the 17th CIDC Vishwakarma Awards & Exhibitions on Viksit Bharat 2047, Gadkari further said the highways ministry has highway assets worth Rs 15 lakh crore that can be monetised.

"Land acquisition, forest and environment clearance are major problems in highways projects. We had made it mandatory that without acquiring 90 per cent of the land no new national highway projects will be started. Now I think that without acquiring 100 per cent of the land, we should not



Union Road Transport and Highways Minister Nitin Gadkari

give an appointed date for the new national highway projects," he said. Appointed date is the formal start date for highway projects, signalling that land acquisition and clearances are sufficiently in place for construction to begin.

Gadkari reiterated that consultants responsible for preparing detailed project reports (DPRs) for highway construction are the real culprits behind

the poor quality of highways.

He suggested that retired NHAI officials should use their skills and start firms to prepare DPRs. A DPR is a comprehensive blueprint for a road construction project, outlining all technical, financial and logistics details necessary for its execution. The minister said the construction industry has potential, it should work to decrease cost of construction without compromising on the quality.

Gadkari also emphasised the importance of innovation, technology and sustainable practices in the construction sector while underlining the need to promote alternative fuels and new technologies for the future of infrastructure development.

He also underlined the need to ensure quality-based evaluation in project implementation,

stating that quality and performance must receive higher priority, along with cost considerations. Emphasising sustainable solutions, he urged stakeholders to explore the use of biofuels, biomass-based fuels and other alternative fuels, stating that such technologies can help reduce dependence on conventional fuels and lower operational costs. He also called for greater use of waste-to-wealth technologies, including recycling of plastic waste and used tyres in road construction.

Gadkari further highlighted the importance of adopting futuristic technologies and research-based solutions and encouraged stronger collaboration between industry, research institutions and academia for developing innovative construction technologies. PFI

NEW DELHI: Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal on Friday held separate discussions with his Kuwaiti and UAE counterparts on containing disruptions in energy supplies and restoring trade flows at the earliest. India's trade with West Asia has been disrupted severely because of the attack by the US and Israel on Iran.

In his virtual interaction with his Kuwaiti counterpart, Osama Khaled Boodai, Goyal conveyed that India is willing to extend assistance to address any supply chain issues, particularly related to the food security of Kuwait.

"Both ministers agreed that dialogue and diplomacy should be given primacy and disruptions to energy supplies and trade flows should be restored at the earliest," the Commerce



Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal

Ministry said in a statement.

Goyal also held a virtual call with Thani bin Ahmed Al Zeyoudi, Minister of Foreign Trade, UAE, and discussed ways to restore supply chain continuity.

"Both sides noted the strain on regional supply chains and emphasised coordinated efforts to ensure smooth trade flows," it said. Goyal appreciated the UAE's proactive logistics measures, including the opening

of alternate routes and multimodal transport, while highlighting India's renewed steps to support exporters and ensure continuity of essential supplies to the country.

Further, Goyal held a bilateral meeting with Jaseem Mohamed Al Budaiwi, GCC Secretary General.

During the meeting with Budaiwi, Goyal expressed hope that the ceasefire announced in the region would be enduring and pave the way for lasting peace and stability.

The minister recalled strong people-to-people ties between India and GCC, which form the core of strong economic and commercial relations with countries of the region.

"Both sides emphasised the need for coordinated efforts to ensure smooth trade flows," the

ministry said.

With Abdulla bin Adel Fakhro, Minister of Industry and Commerce, Bahrain, the Indian minister stressed the need to ensure predictable trade flows through maritime and other modes in the region.

These deliberations are important as the Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) members are key trading partners of India.

The joint attack launched by the US and Israel on Iran had led to severe disruptions in the movement of ships in international waters, particularly to the West Asian nations. The conflict has posed challenges for exporters to ship goods to the Gulf region, with which India had a bilateral trade of \$178 billion in FY25 (\$56.87 billion exports and \$121.67 billion imports). PFI

Silver rebounds ₹3,800 to ₹2.47 lakh/kg, gold jumps to ₹1.55 lakh per 10 grams

NEW DELHI: Silver prices rebounded by Rs 3,800 to Rs 2.47 lakh per kilogram in the national capital on Friday, and gold edged higher to Rs 1.55 lakh per 10 grams as investors weighed fragile geopolitical developments and a weak US dollar.

According to the All India Sarafa Association, the white metal climbed by Rs 3,800, or 1.6 per cent, to Rs 2,47,000 per kg (inclusive of all taxes), reversing Thursday's decline of Rs 2,43,200 per kg.

Gold of 99.9 per cent purity also went up by Rs 400

to Rs 1,55,300 per 10 grams (inclusive of all taxes). The yellow metal had settled at Rs 1,54,900 per 10 grams in the previous market session.

The gains capped a strong week for precious metals, with silver advancing by Rs 10,000, or 4.2 per cent, and gold gaining 3,800, or 2.51 per cent.

Global bullion prices also moved higher, with spot gold gaining \$11.52, or 0.24 per cent, to \$4,777.17 per ounce, and silver was trading nearly 1 per cent higher at \$75.91 per ounce. PFI

Tata Sons listing in public interest, have faith in govt & RBI to act decisively: SP Group Chairman

NEW DELHI: Shapoorji Pallonji Mistry on Friday renewed his call for listing Tata Sons, describing it as a necessary step in the public interest and expressing confidence that the government and the Reserve Bank of India will act decisively.

In a statement, the SP Group Chairman said a timely listing is "not merely a regulatory compliance but a necessary evolution" that would strengthen corporate governance, transparency and accountability—core principles of the Tata Group.

He asserted that no evidence-based case has been made to show how a public listing would harm the interests of the Tata Trusts or weaken



their ability to serve beneficiaries. "A publicly listed holding company strengthens board accountability, broadens the investor base, and secures long-term value for all stakeholders," he said.

Mistry added that listing Tata Sons would unlock value for retail shareholders, create

Shapoorji Pallonji family holds about 18.37% in Tata Sons and has been seeking to leverage this stake to raise funds & cut debt

a more predictable dividend stream for the Tata Trusts, and expand the group's philanthropic reach. He emphasised that compliance with the RBI-mandated listing would ultimately reinforce the group's legacy of trust and public purpose.

The remarks come amid

differing views within the trusts. Reports suggest trustees Venu Srinivasan and Vijay Singh have supported a listing, while Chairman Noel Tata has opposed the move.

Mistry said the SP Group remains in "constructive engagement" with Tata Sons leadership to reach an amicable resolution but is also looking to the RBI for clear direction.

The Shapoorji Pallonji family holds about 18.37 per cent in Tata Sons and has been seeking to leverage this stake to raise funds and reduce debt. The Tata Trusts, which own around 66 per cent, remain central to the decision on listing. AGENCIES

Jio-bp not planning to hike petrol, diesel prices

NEW DELHI: Jio-BP, the fuel joint venture of Reliance Industries Ltd and BP Plc, does not plan to raise fuel prices immediately despite a spike in international oil prices, its chief executive Akshay Wadhwa said on Friday.

The country's second-largest private fuel retailer has kept retail petrol and diesel rates steady, just like public sector firms, which have not passed on the surge in raw material (crude oil) cost to consumers for fear of spiking inflation.

"We are in this with the country," Wadhwa said on the sidelines of an industry

event here.

The war in West Asia has driven global oil prices above \$100 per barrel, but domestic consumers have been insulated by the oil companies and the government, which cut excise duty on petrol and diesel to obviate the need for raising prices to some extent.

Nayara Energy, in which Russian oil giant Rosneft hold the largest shareholding, has increased petrol price by Rs 5 a litre and diesel by Rs 3. Nayara is the country's largest private fuel retailer with 6,967 outlets. Shell India has also reportedly raised fuel prices at its 343 outlets. PFI

Critical minerals processing scheme at advanced stage, says Mines Secy

NEW DELHI: A key government scheme for processing of critical minerals is at an advanced stage of finalisation, Mines Secretary Piyush Goyal said on Friday, as India races to secure its supply chain amid global competition for lithium and other vital resources needed for clean energy and defence technologies.

Speaking to reporters here, Goyal said India is unable to import lithium available abroad due to the absence of a domestic processing value chain.

"The scheme for processing of critical mineral value chain is at an advanced stage," he said. This is expected to signifi-

cantly enhance the resilience of EV batteries in the country. Details of the same will be shared once it is approved, Goyal said.

He further said India is eyeing critical mineral blocks in Canada and is exploring opportunities for investment in lithium projects in Brazil, Argentina, and Australia. He also said production from five blocks of lithium in Argentina is likely to start in 2029.

The secretary also said Coal India, NTPC Mining, along with Hindustan Copper, are in talks with Codeco for acquisition of four blocks in Chile. He also exudes confidence

that India will be a net exporter of copper from next year.

Globally, critical minerals include lithium, cobalt, rare earth elements, nickel, graphite, and several others whose supply is vulnerable to geopolitical or trade disruptions.

India is heavily dependent on imports for key minerals such as lithium and cobalt.

The government had last year approved a Rs 16,300-crore National Critical Mineral Mission, envisaging a total outlay of Rs 34,300 crore spread over seven years, with an aim to achieve self-reliance and accelerate India's journey towards green energy transition. PFI

NEW DELHI: The Vedanta Group has challenged the evaluation criteria used by lenders of Jaiprakash Associates Ltd (JAL), alleging irregularities in the selection of Adani Enterprises as the successful bidder.

During proceedings before the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT), Vedanta's counsel argued that the valuation framework adopted by the committee of creditors (CoC) undermined the principle of value maximisation under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC).

Senior advocate Abhijeet Sinha questioned whether the

CLOSER LOOK

- » Vedanta claimed its bid was Rs 3,400 crore higher in gross value and Rs 500 crore higher in net present value (NPV) than Adani's offer, yet was overlooked
- » According to Vedanta, Adani scored 29.30 out of 35, while Vedanta received 18.51, a disparity it termed unjustified
- » It added that it secured full marks on NPV but scored lower on equity infusion parameters

evaluation matrix was being used to maximise value or serve other purposes. He contended that tools such as the request for resolution plan (RFRP) and process notes are only guiding

mechanisms and cannot override the core objective of maximising returns.

Vedanta claimed its bid was Rs 3,400 crore higher in gross value and Rs 500 crore

higher in net present value (NPV) than Adani's offer, yet was overlooked without adequate discussion. The CoC had appointed BTO India LLC to assess bids, assigning scores based on various parameters. According to Vedanta, Adani scored 29.30 out of 35, while Vedanta received 18.51, a disparity it termed unjustified. It added that it secured full marks on NPV but scored lower on equity infusion parameters.

Vedanta also alleged lack of transparency and fairness, stating that bidders were only shown the highest NPV during the challenge process despite

submitting both upfront and deferred payment components.

Earlier, the NCLAT had refused to stay the insolvency resolution process but made it subject to the outcome of appeals. The Supreme Court of India also declined to intervene, directing that any major decisions by the monitoring committee require tribunal approval.

The CoC defended its decision, maintaining that the process complied with IBC norms and that bids were evaluated on multiple factors beyond headline value, including feasibility and execution. AGENCIES

Sleepless Knights

KKR in free fall as captain Rahane struggles to hold team together

S KANNAN

NEW DELHI: The plight of the Kolkata Knight Riders (KKR) in the 2026 edition of the Indian Premier League is hard to ignore. A side that once showcased class and won multiple IPL titles now appears a pale shadow of itself. Results in four matches this season have been disappointing, with three losses and one washout hurting fans. Worse, empty seats at Eden Gardens on Thursday told their own story, as the home side lost to Lucknow Super Giants in a cliff-hanger.

So, what has led to KKR collapsing like a house of cards? This is the second successive year that KKR, under the captaincy of Ajinkya Rahane, have failed to deliver. Blaming 'Jinx' would be the easiest option. However, with the bat, Rahane has done his bit. The problem lies in the pieces of the jigsaw not falling into place, largely due to questionable auction picks.

Social media already suggests that KKR fans have written off their side this season. When momentum is lost early, a comeback is never easy. Calls to "bring back Gautam Gambhir" as coach sound unrealistic, with him focused on his role with India. Even Lalit Modi's



This is the second successive year that KKR, under the captaincy of Ajinkya Rahane, have failed to deliver

suggestion on social media appears bizarre.

KKR's management faltered after the 2024 IPL triumph under Shreyas Iyer. His decision to enter the auction pool before the 2025 season highlighted poor decision-making. Two underwhelming seasons since only underline that failure, while Iyer thrives as skipper of Punjab Kings.

Those judging Rahane

Social media is an indicator that KKR fans have already written off their side this season

harshly are being unfair. He continues to apply himself and bat with intent. It is disappointing that players like Cameron

Green have not shown similar hunger. The hefty Rs 25.20 crore price tag now looks unjustified.

Looking ahead, what KKR can produce in the remaining matches remains uncertain. The IPL is a long tournament, but if Rahane can turn things around as batter and captain, it would be remarkable—something he has achieved before for India in Virat Kohli's absence.

All eyes on Samson & Gaikwad

CHENNAI: The seasoned opening duo of Sanju Samson and Ruturaj Gaikwad will be under immense pressure to perform as Chennai Super Kings extend search for their first win of the season against Delhi Capitals in the IPL here on Saturday.

With three losses at three different venues, CSK have begun the season on an uninspiring note. Whether in batting or bowling, significant improvement is needed if they are to compete with rival teams. The absence of Dewald Brevis has also impacted the balance of the side. The explosive South African batter is expected to make a comeback from injury against Delhi Capitals. However, there is no clarity over the return of M S Dhoni, who is yet to play this season due to a calf strain.

The opening combination of Samson and Gaikwad needs to come good. AGENCIES

BADMINTON ASIA CHAMPIONSHIPS

Shetty's giant-killing act: Ayush stomps Christie, enters semis

NINGBO: India's Ayush Shetty produced the biggest win of his career, stunning world No. 4 Jonatan Christie of Indonesia to enter the men's singles semi-finals of the Badminton Asia Championships here on Friday.

The world No. 25 Indian kept his higher-ranked opponent under constant pressure with relentless retrieving and thunderous smashes to script a 23-21 21-17 victory in a fiercely contested quarterfinal.

Shetty, the reigning US Open Super 300 champion, will next face top seed Kunlavut Vitidsarn of Thailand, the Paris Olympics silver medalist and 2023 world champion.

In their first meeting, Shetty appeared tactically prepared with coach Irwansyah Adi Pratama, who had earlier guided Christie in his corner.

The Indian matched his opponent shot for shot, unsettling him with sharp angles and disciplined defence. Shetty led 2-0 and 5-3 early on before Christie wrested control, pinning him to the backline and engaging in flat exchanges to turn it around at 6-5.

The Indonesian continued to vary pace and angles, putting pressure on the tall Indian to move ahead 9-6 and carry a three-point lead into the inter-



Ayush Shetty shocked the world with a straight-game win

ANI

val. The 6ft 4 inch Mangalorean responded well, quickly erasing the deficit. However, a string of unforced errors saw Christie surge ahead again at 14-11 and 16-13.

Shetty then forced errors from his opponent, who misjudged lengths and went wide while attempting to play to the lines, though Christie still held a slender 18-16 lead.

Shetty clawed back to 18-18 after a net error and a wide return from Christie.

The Indonesian earned two game points when Shetty hit long, but the Indian responded with a thunderous down-the-line smash and a sharp net winner to level and then earn a game point. Christie saved one with a cross-court smash but

netted the next and then went wide to hand over the game.

After the change of ends, Shetty came out more aggressive, using a variety of smashes to lead 5-2. Christie fought back to 5-5 and 6-6, but a service error handed Shetty the advantage. He moved into a two-point lead at the interval after another error from Christie and extended it to 13-9.

With Christie struggling for timing, Shetty surged ahead to 17-13. A brief dip allowed the Indonesian to close in at 16-17, but the Indian regained control with a powerful smash.

Christie reduced the gap to 17-18, but another steep smash and a long return gave Shetty three match points, and he sealed the match. AGENCIES

INSPIRED BY DHONI

Thala effect? Mukul's finishing act turns heads

KOLKATA: Mukul Choudhary grew up watching MS Dhoni finish games, dreaming of doing the same one day.

At Eden Gardens on Thursday night, the 21-year-old rookie batter from Rajasthan turned that dream into reality with a stunning six-hitting display, helping Lucknow Super Giants secure a three-wicket win over Kolkata Knight Riders in a last-ball thriller.

"I dedicate this to my father. Even before he got married, he always dreamt of making his son a cricketer. I also always watch MS (Dhoni) sir, the way he finishes. I also play at the same number, so I dedicate this to him," Mukul said after his heroics (54 not out from 27 balls).

Behind that composure lies relentless preparation of hitting close to 150 sixes everyday.

"My genes are such and I am naturally built in a way that there is power in my shots, and also I do practice a lot. Everyday I hit around 100-150 sixes. For the last five-six months, I've been practising a lot and that has come into me," he revealed.

He also spoke about his Dhoni-like 'helicopter shot', which he used to hit Vaibhav Arora for a six in the 17th over.

"I have practised that shot

“Everyday I hit around 100-150 sixes. For the last five-six months, I've been practising a lot

Mukul Choudhary

since childhood... I always liked that, and the way Dhoni finished (an inning). He used to hit a six even off a yorker. If you even hit that kind of a delivery for six, the bowler thinks about doing something different." That six-hitting ability, combined with belief, has already caught the eye of LSG coach Justin Langer who had famously earlier said he could turn Mukul into one of India's "scariest" middle-order batters.

It was on display against a depleted KKR bowling attack on Thursday, when he turned the match around, taking the score from 128/7 in 16 overs to 54 runs off the last four overs.

"If such a great coach says something about you, he must have seen something in you. He showed me his belief and I wanted to do it." AGENCIES

Women rule roost as India cap golden Asian Boxing campaign

ULAANBAATAR: India capped off a memorable Asian Boxing Championships campaign with Vishvanath Suresh clinching the medal gold in the men's 50kg category here on Friday.

Vishvanath defeated Japan's Daichi Iwai by a dominant 5-0 margin in the final. Sachin (60kg) added to the tally with a hard-fought silver medal, rounding off a strong showing for the men's contingent.

India finished second on the table with five gold, one fewer than Kazakhstan, but claimed the most medals (16) overall. The performance was headlined by a historic outing from the Indian women's team, which topped the medal charts with 10 podium finishes, including four gold, two silver and four bronze, marking one of their finest showings at the continental level.

Vishvanath's gold marks a significant milestone in his

The Indian women's team topped the medal charts with 10 podium finishes

rapid rise through the ranks. Having emerged through the national circuit with consistent performances, he has quickly established himself on the international stage.

His campaign in Ulaanbaatar was particularly impressive, highlighted by his victory over a world No. 1 en route to the final. Speaking on the performance, Boxing Federation of India president Ajay Singh said, "This has been a remarkable campaign for Indian boxing and for our women who have topped the medal charts with four gold medals. Our men's team was impressive again, especially young Vishva with his gold." AGENCIES

BJKC: India sail to 3-0 win over Mongolia

NEW DELHI: India enjoyed a dominant outing, blanking Mongolia 3-0 while dropping just one game, as Zeel Desai secured a straight-set win on her Billie Jean King Cup singles debut against 15-year-old Anuvjin Gantor, before Sahaja Yamalapalli followed suit in the Asia/Oceania Group I tie on Friday.

Zeel drubbed her rival 6-0 6-0 in mere 37 minutes before Sahaja trounced 32-year-old Jargal Altansarnai by an identical scoreline in 42 minutes at DLTA Complex.

Later, Vaishnavi Adkar and Rutuja Bhosale hammered Khongorzul Aldarkhishig and Jargal Altansarnai 6-1 6-0 to complete the rout. It was not more than a casual hitting session for the home players as unranked rival players did not have the game to hurt them.

India will take on Korea on Saturday, the final day of the competition, in their last outing of the tournament. AGENCIES

Pragg out of picture, spotlight sole leader Vaishali at Candidates

PAPHOS: With R Praggnanandhaa out of contention, focus has shifted to his sister R Vaishali, who enters Round 11 of the Women's Candidates tournament as the sole leader, boosting her chances of sealing the title when play resumes on Saturday after the rest day.

Vaishali, on six points, faces Russia's Aleksandra Goryachkina in the next round, aiming to extend her lead and strengthen her bid for the title, which would earn her a shot at reigning world champion Ju Wenjun later this year.

With four rounds remaining, Vaishali has been the standout among the three Indian players, ahead of her younger brother R. Praggnanandhaa, who is competing in the Open section, and Diya Deshmukh.

She holds a half-point lead over Ukraine's Anna Muzychuk and China's Zhu Jiner. The trio of Kateryna Lagno, Aleksandra Goryachkina, and Kazakhstan's Bibisara Assaubayeva are tied for fourth on five points, while Diya Deshmukh is another half-point behind.

Former women's world champion Tan Zhongyi sits in last place with 3.5 points.

Vaishali has been in the spotlight for her bold, attack-



R Vaishali takes on Russia's Aleksandra Goryachkina

FILE

With four rounds remaining, Vaishali has been the standout among the 3 Indian players

ing play, with three wins and just one loss so far. The Indian has shown strong intent, balancing ambition with calculated risk-taking.

After her clash with Goryachkina, she still has games against two Chinese players and Kateryna. With four rounds left, the tournament remains wide open, and a strong finish could still secure the title and a shot at world champion Wenjun later this year.

The 'Open' section has turned into a one-sided race, with Sindarov in commanding form on eight points out of 10. The Uzbek has been relentless, scoring six wins alongside four draws, and is now well placed to secure a shot at India's D. Gukesh in this year's World Championship match, barring a dramatic collapse in the final rounds.

Sindarov remains firmly in control, with the closest challenger Anish Giri trailing by two points and needing a near-miracle to stay in contention for the title.

Such has been Sindarov's dominance that third-placed Fabiano Caruana is a further point behind Giri and effectively out of the race. AGENCIES

Asian Wrestling: Meenakshi bags silver

BISHKEK: Meenakshi Goyat added a third silver to India's tally in the women's 53kg category, while three men's freestyle wrestlers advanced to the gold medal bouts in their respective weight classes at the Senior Asian Wrestling Championships here on Friday.

Monika (women's 65kg) and Harshita (women's 72kg) then signed off with bronze medals to take India's overall medals tally into double figures -- three silver and seven bronze.

India's sole gold medal hope on Friday rested on Meenakshi, who had fought back from the brink in the semi-finals to reach this

far. However, the 25-year-old was not at her best and went down 0-10 against China's Jin Zhang.

Monika and Harshita lifted their spirits with clinical performances to clinch the bronze medals. Monika defeated Hanbit Lee of South Korea 9-0 to in the women's 65kg category, while Harshita got the better of Sevinchov Polvonova 5-0 in the women's 72kg bronze medal bout. Earlier, India's men's freestyle wrestlers showcased their growing stature on the continental stage Sujeet (65kg), Abhimanyou (70kg) and Sandeep Mann (79kg) sealed their final berth. AGENCIES



LSG's Mukul Choudhary starred against KKR in a thrilling match

PTI

Liverpool boss Slot says club support strong as fans prepare protest

LONDON: Under-fire Liverpool boss Arne Slot said he feels "complete support" from the club and the fans on Friday, even as his team endures a torrid run of form and supporters plan protests over rising ticket prices.

The Dutchman's side have lost their last three matches across all competitions, crashing out of the FA Cup to Manchester City while they trail Paris St Germain 2-0 in their Champions League quarter-finals.

With Liverpool clinging to fifth place in the Premier League -- the final Champions League qualification spot -- and Chelsea breathing down their necks one point behind, Saturday's home clash with Fulham takes on added significance.

Asked if he feels support from the Liverpool hier-



Liverpool coach Arne Slot, Andy Robertson and Virgil Van Dijk

AP

archy, Slot told reporters the club's sporting director Richard Hughes and chief executive Michael Edwards are behind him.

"I'm repeating myself a lot but I feel a lot of support. Not only from the owners but from Richard and Michael... But as weird as it might sound, I also

feel the support from the fans," Slot told reporters.

"We were going out in Paris when the players went out for the warm-up and after the 4-0

“I've always felt support in good and bad times. I hope even in protest that they can be as helpful as always been for us.

Arne Slot, Liverpool coach

loss (against City) the fans immediately started singing, 'We love Liverpool'.

Yet, a group of fans are planning protests against the owners at Anfield due to the proposed hikes in ticket prices.

In 2016, around 10,000 supporters headed for the exits during a Premier League game in protest against a proposal to increase ticket prices significantly, after which the American owners bowed to pressure and backed down.

But Slot hopes Anfield's famous atmosphere will not be affected. "Not only when we go through tough times but I think Anfield has shown in history and since I'm here how important these fans are for us, especially when we play a home game," Slot said. "I've always felt support in good and bad times." AGENCIES

CENTRAL RAILWAY
CONSTRUCTION ORGANISATION

E-Tender Notice No:
PA.LD.C.T.2025.18
Date: 09-04-2026.

Divisional Electrical Engineer (Construction Organisation.) Central Railway, Private Road, Pune-411001 (Phone No. 020-26105192) for and on behalf of President of India invites open tenders on line through web site **www.ireps.gov.in** in the prescribed form, from reputed Contractors for the following work:- **Name of work:** Design, supply, erection, testing and commissioning of 2x 25 kV AC OHE in Tuljapur- Osmanabad section (42 TKM) and Design, manufacture, supply of associated equipments, erection, testing and commissioning of 1 No. 220/132kV/55kV (2x25kV System) Scott Connected transformer along with 1 nos. Sectioning & Paralleling post (SP) and 1 nos. Sub-Sectioning & Paralleling post (SSP) in connection with Solapur-Osmanabad New Line project of Central Railway. **Estimated Cost :** ₹ 64,89,81,495.82 (Rupees Sixty-Four Crores Eighty-Nine Lakhs Eighty-One Thousand Four Hundred Ninety-Five and paise Eighty-Two Only). **Bid Security:** ₹ 1,29,79,600.00 (Rupees One Crore Twenty-Nine Lakhs Seventy-Nine Thousand Six Hundred Only). Payment of Bid security shall be made either in cash through e payment gateway or submitted as Bank Guarantee bond from a scheduled commercial bank of India or as mentioned in tender documents. The Bank Guarantee bond shall be as per Annexure-VIA and shall be valid for a period of 90days beyond the bid validity period. **Cost of tender forms:** NIL **Completion period:** 12 months (Twelve) months including monsoon period. **Validity of offer:** 90 days from date of opening of Tender. **Date & Time for submission of tender and opening of tender:** The tender document should be uploaded on or before **30.04.2026 upto 15.00 hours**. The tender will be opened at **15.00 hours** on the same day in this office. **Website Notice Board location for complete information:** The tender Notice & Tender Document can be seen from the CRIS website address **www.ireps.gov.in** **System of Tendering:** The tender documents shall be submitted ON LINE only by following the guide line on the CRIS website given above.

AK-26 ADEE (Construction), Pune
Travel safely, Avoid footboard travelling

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

Open E-Tender notice
NER-LJN-2026-58

On behalf of the President of India, Divisional Railway Manager/Engineering, North Eastern Railway, Lucknow, invites online tender for the following work, detail of which is as given below:

E-Tender no: NER-LJN-2026-58, **Name of Work:** NER-LJN Division- Construction of LHS by air pushing technique in lieu of LC No. 253/C, 267/C, 283/C, 284/C, 306/C & 313/C GD-BBK section in LJN division. Total 06 nos, Estimated Cost: (Rs): ₹ 434932029.42, Earnest Money(Rs): ₹ 8698700.00, Completion Period: 18 Months.

1-The tender, for the above tender number NER-LJN-2026-58, can be uploaded up to 15:00 hrs. on 30/04/2026 and this tender will be opened after 15:00 hrs. on the same day. 2-All the information related minimum qualification, complete details of terms and conditions of the above tender is available on North Eastern Railway website **www.ireps.gov.in**. Tenderer should read the corrigendum (if any) available on the website related to this tender information before uploading the tender form and be sure to take into consideration as well.

Div. Railway Manager (Engg.) CPROM-17 Lucknow
Never travel on roof and foot boards.

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
(SUCCESSION CASE)
IN THE COURT OF
Sh. Sandeep Kumar
Addl. Civil Judge Sr. Divin.
Narwana

1. Sunita W/o Shyam Lal, R/o Patel Nagar, Hisar
2. Seema Rani W/o Sunny, R/o Vill. Budain.
3. Pinki W/o Ram Parsad, Vill. Kailwan, Tehsil Narwana (all D/o Indero Devi @ Dholi) &
4. Hariya @ Hari Ram husband of Indero Devi @ Dholi, R/o Vill. Dhanauri, Distt. Kaithal.

Vs.

1.General Public
2.State Bank of India, Old Court Road, Narwana
3. Babli widow
4. Sehil
5. Vishal &
6. Lakshay (minor) sons of Naib S/o Hariya @ Hari Ram, R/o Vill. Dhanauri, Distt. Kaithal.

SUCC/5/2026
CNR No.HR.JNJA1-000301-2026
Next Date 01-07-2026

NOTICE TO:
General Public
In above titled case, the defendant(s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **01-07-2026 at 10.00 a.m.**
For details logon to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/7hrs> = district Notice&district=Jind
SD/- Sh. Sandeep Kumar
Addl. Civil Judge Sr. Divin.
Dated 10.04.2026 Narwana

PHYSICAL POSSESSION NOTICE

ICICI Bank Branch office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi-110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Physical Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs.)	Name of Branch
1.	Vikaram Singh Kardam/ Rekha Kardam/ LBFD800002270218/ LBFD800002278699	H.No 483, Lig Ground Floor, Housing Board Colony, Sector 21d, Faridabad- 121002/ April 08, 2026	May 17 2016 Rs. 17,58,735/-	Faridabad (Haryana)

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantors(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: April 11, 2026 Place: Faridabad (Haryana)

Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

ICICI Bank Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited, 3rd Floor Shal Tower, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi- 110005

PUBLIC NOTICE-TENDER CUM E-AUCTION FOR SALE OF SECURED ASSET
(See proviso to Rule 8(6))
Notice for sale of immovable asset(s)

E-Auction Sale Notice for the sale of immovable asset(s) under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8 (6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

This notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged/ charged to the Secured Creditor, the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of ICICI Bank Limited will be sold on 'As is where is', 'As is what is' and 'Whatever there is' as per the brief particulars given hereunder:

Sr. No.	Name of Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrowers/ Guarantors/ Loan Account No.	Details of the Secured asset(s) with known encumbrances, if any	Amount Outstanding	Reserve Price Earnest Money Deposit	Date and Time of Property Inspection	Date & Time of E-Auction
(A)	(B)	(C)	(D)	(E)	(F)	(G)
1.	Umesh Kumar Sharma (Applicant), Preeti Sharma (Co Applicant) Lan No. LBDEL00001218560	Mig Flat No S-4, With Roof Rights 2nd Floor, At Plot No C-84, Block C, Shalimar Garden Ext-2, Village Possonda, Ghaziabad-201010 (Admeasuring An Area of 650 Sq Ft	Rs. 75,40,621/- As on April 04, 2026	Rs. 28,90,000/- Rs. 2,89,000/-	April 24, 2026 From 04:00 PM To 05:00 PM	May 20, 2026 From 11:00 AM To 12:00 Noon

The online auction will be conducted on the website (URL Link-<https://disposallhub.com>) of our auction agency M/s. NexXen Solutions Private Limited. The Mortgagors/ Notices are given a last chance to pay the total dues with further interest by May 19, 2026 before 05:00 P.M else the secured asset(s) will be sold as per schedule.

The prospective bidder(s) must submit the Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) Demand Draft (DD) (Refer Column E) at ICICI Bank Limited, 3rd Floor Shal Tower, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi- 110005 on or before May 19, 2026 before 05:00 P.M. Thereafter, they have to submit their offer through the website mentioned above on or before May 19, 2026 before 05:00 P.M. along with the scanned image of the Bank acknowledged DD towards proof of payment of EMD. In case the prospective bidder(s) is/ are unable to submit his/ her/ their offer through the website, then the signed copy of tender documents may be submitted at ICICI Bank Limited, 3rd Floor Shal Tower, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi- 110005 on or before May 19, 2026 before 05:00 P.M. Earnest Money Deposit DD/PO should be from a Nationalised/ Scheduled Bank in favour of 'ICICI Bank Limited' payable at "Delhi".

For any further clarifications in terms of inspection, Terms and Conditions of the E-Auction or submission of tenders, contact ICICI Bank Employee Phone No. 8928935040/ 8584874809

Please note that Marketing Agency 1. M/s NexXen Solutions Private Limited, 2. Augoe Assets Management Private Limited 3. Matex Net Pvt. Ltd. 4. Finvin Estate Deal Technologies Pvt Ltd 5. Girsarsoft Pvt Ltd 6. Hecta Prop Tech Pvt Ltd 7. Arca Emart Pvt Ltd 8. Novel Asset Service Pvt Ltd 9. Nobroker Technologies Solutions Pvt Ltd 10. Value Trust Capital Services Private Limited, have also been engaged for facilitating the sale of this property. The Authorised Officer reserves the right to reject any or all the bids without furnishing any further reasons. For detailed Terms and Conditions of the sale, please visit www.icicibank.com/n4p4

Date : April 11, 2026 Place: Delhi & Ghaziabad Authorized Officer, ICICI Bank Limited

ICICI Bank Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited, 3rd Floor Shal Tower, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi- 110005

PUBLIC NOTICE-TENDER CUM E-AUCTION FOR SALE OF SECURED ASSET
(See proviso to Rule 8(6))
Notice for sale of immovable asset(s)

E-Auction Sale Notice for the sale of immovable asset(s) under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8 (6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

This notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged/ charged to the Secured Creditor, the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of ICICI Bank Limited will be sold on 'As is where is', 'As is what is' and 'Whatever there is' as per the brief particulars given hereunder:

Sr. No.	Name of Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrowers/ Guarantors/ Loan Account No.	Details of the Secured asset(s) with known encumbrances, if any	Amount Outstanding	Reserve Price Earnest Money Deposit	Date and Time of Property Inspection	Date & Time of E-Auction
(A)	(B)	(C)	(D)	(E)	(F)	(G)
1.	Shubir Walter Abraham (Applicant), Shumir Oliver Abraham (Co Applicant) Edna Abraham (Co Applicant) Lan No. LBDEL00005394144 and LBDEL00005394146	DDA Free hold Flat No 1136 3rd Floor, Third floor, Sector D Pocket 1 With Scooter Garage Sfs- Cat II, Vasant Kunj New Delhi Area- 92 Sq Mtr	Rs 1.39, 72,67,00/- As April 04, 2026	Rs. 2,61,75,000/- Rs. 26,17,500/-	May 04, 2026 From 12:00 Noon- 01:00 PM	May 20, 2026 From 11:00 AM- 12:00 Noon

The online auction will be conducted on the website (URL Link- <https://disposallhub.com>) of our auction agency M/s NexXen Solutions Private Limited. The Mortgagors/ Notices are given a last chance to pay the total dues with further interest by May 19, 2026 before 05:00 PM else the secured asset(s) will be sold as per schedule.

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Please note that Marketing agencies 1. M/s NexXen Solutions Private Limited, 2. Augoe Assets Management Private Limited 3. Matex Net Pvt. Ltd. 4. Finvin Estate Deal Technologies Pvt Ltd 5. Girsarsoft Pvt. Ltd. 6. Hecta Prop Tech Pvt Ltd 7. Arca Emart Pvt Ltd 8. Novel Asset Service Pvt Ltd 9. Nobroker Technologies Solutions Pvt Ltd 10. Value Trust Capital Services Private Limited, have also been engaged for facilitating the sale of this property. The Authorised Officer reserves the right to reject any or all the bids without furnishing any further reasons. For detailed Terms and Conditions of the sale, please visit www.icicibank.com/n4p4s

Date : April 11, 2026 Place: Delhi & Gurugram Authorized Officer, ICICI Bank Limited

ICICI Bank Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited, 3rd Floor Shal Tower, Plot No. 23, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi- 110005

PUBLIC NOTICE - TENDER CUM E-AUCTION FOR SALE OF SECURED ASSET
(See proviso to Rule 8 (6))
Notice for Sale of Immovable Asset(s)

This E-Auction Notice for Sale of Immovable Asset/ Assets is being issued by ICICI Bank Ltd. (on underlying pool assigned to ICICI Bank by Dewan Housing Finance Ltd. (DHFL)) in relation to the enforcement of security with respect to a Housing Loan facility granted pursuant to a Loan Agreement entered into between DHFL and the following Borrower/ Borrowers/ Co-Borrower/ Co-Borrowers/ Guarantor/ Guarantors under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8 (6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

The Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower/ Borrowers/ Co-Borrower/ Co-Borrowers/ Guarantor/ Guarantors that the below described immovable property mortgaged/ charged to the Secured Creditor, the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of ICICI Bank Ltd. will be sold on 'As is where is', 'As is what is' and 'Whatever there is' basis as per the brief particulars given below:

Sr. No.	Name of Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Guarantor(s)/ Loan Account No.	Details of the Secured Asset/ Assets with known encumbrances, if any	Outstanding amount	Reserve price Earnest Money Deposit	Date and time of property inspection	Date and time of E-Auction
(A)	(B)	(C)	(D)	(E)	(F)	(G)
1.	Gaurav Garg (Borrower), Santosh Garg (Co-Applicant) Lan No. QZPTU00005041323	Property Address-Back Side Built Up First Floor Without Roof Rights, Area Measuring 58 Sq Yard i.e 48.4938 Sq Mtr, Forming Part of Property Bearing Rz-5-B on Plot No-5-B & 5-C Out of Khasara No 619, Situated In Revenue Estate of Village Nasirpur, Delhi State Delhi, Colony Known As Kailash Puri Gali No-8, Palam Colony, New Delhi Area 58 Sq Yard i.e 48.4938 Sq. Mtr.	Rs. 21,93,471/- as on April 04, 2026	Rs. 17,50,000/- Rs. 1,75,000/-	April 17, 2026 From 12:00 Noon to 01:00 PM	May 20, 2026 From 11:00 AM to 12:00 Noon

The online auction will take place on the website (URL Link- <https://disposallhub.com>) of the E-Auction agency M/s NexXen Solutions Private Limited. The recipients of this Notice are given a last chance to pay the total dues with further interest till May 19, 2026 before 05:00 PM failing which, the Secured Asset/ Assets will be sold as per schedule.

The prospective Bidder/ Bidders must submit the Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) Demand Draft (DD) (Refer to column E) at ICICI Bank Limited, 3rd Floor Shal Tower, Plot No. 23, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi- 110005 on or before May 19, 2026 before 05:00 PM. Thereafter, he/ she/ they need to submit the offer/ offers through the website mentioned above on or before May 19, 2026 before 05:00 PM along with a scanned copy of the Bank acknowledged DD as a proof of payment of the EMD. In case, the prospective Bidder/ Bidders is/ are unable to submit the offer/ offers through the website then a signed copy of the tender documents may be submitted at ICICI Bank Limited, 3rd Floor Shal Tower, Plot No. 23, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi- 110005 on or before May 19, 2026 before 05:00 PM. The Earnest Money Deposit DD/ PO should be from a Nationalised/ Scheduled Bank in favour of 'ICICI Bank Limited' payable at "Delhi".

For any further clarifications regarding the inspection, Terms and Conditions of the E-Auction or submission of tenders, contact ICICI Bank Employee Phone No. 8928935040, 8584874809.

Please note that Marketing agencies 1. M/s NexXen Solutions Private Limited, 2. Augoe Assets Management Private Limited, 3. Matex Net Pvt. Ltd., 4. Finvin Estate Deal Technologies Pvt. Ltd., 5. Girsarsoft Pvt. Ltd., 6. Hecta Prop Tech Pvt. Ltd., 7. Arca Emart Pvt. Ltd., 8. Novel Asset Service Pvt. Ltd., 9. Nobroker Technologies Solutions Pvt. Ltd., 10. Value Trust Capital Services Private Limited have also been engaged for facilitating the sale of this property.

The Authorised Officer reserves the right to reject any or all of the bids without furnishing any further reasons. For detailed Terms and Conditions of the sale, please visit www.icicibank.com/n4p4s

Date: April 11, 2026 Place: Delhi Authorized Officer, ICICI Bank Limited

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
Letter No.:-DRM/C/AGRA/ATM/E-AUCTION/2026 Dated :- 07.04.2026

E-Auction Notice

On Behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager-North Central Railway-Agra invites E-Auction as per categories given as under :-

Category : ATM	Auction Catalogue No. ATM-AGRA-26-01
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Asset Details

Installation, Operations and Maintenance of ATM at Achhnera Jn. Circulating Area.
Installation, Operations and Maintenance of ATM at Bichpuri Circulating Area.

E-Auction Start Date and Time : Date :- 23.04.2026 Time :-12:30
E-Auction End Date and Time : Date :-23.04.2026 Time :- 13:10

Note :- Prospective bidders are requested to visit E-Auction Leasing module on IREPS website (www.ireps.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. **762/26 (D)**

North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Cancellation of TENDER NOTICE
(Through e-tendering)

Name of work with its location	Provision of Telecom equipment for GM Conference hall at Baroda House, New Delhi.
App. Cost of the work (Rs.)	Rs. 2,24,63,966.39/-only
Earnest Money Deposit (Rs.)	Rs. 4,49,300.00/-only.
Reason for Cancellation of NIT	Tender is cancelled due to administrative reasons.
Tender No. 558-Sig-16-Tele-OT-1025 Dated: 10/04/2026	

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 1208/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
(See Section 82 Cr. PC/
(84-Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita,2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Shehzad Ansari S/o Faiyaz Ansari R/o H.No. 363, Hotel Wali Gali Kabir Basti Malka Ganj, Delhi-07** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.160/2021 U/s 188 IPC at P.S. Subzi Mandi, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Shehzad Ansari** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Shehzad Ansari** have absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Shehzad Ansari** of **FIR No. 160/2021 U/s 188 IPC at P.S.: Subzi Mandi, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.06.2026**. By order

Preeti Rajoria
Judicial Magistrate First Class - 07
(Central Distt) Room No. 32,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/4373/N/2026

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tendering Notice No. 2026-April-03 dated 09.04.2026

E-Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering), N. C. Rly Agra for and on behalf of the President of India invites "Open Tender" through on Line only (E-Tendering) for the following works. The details of the tender are as under :

SN : 1 Tender No.: 2026-April-03-01 Approx Cost Rs.: 33469993.25
Description of Work : Construction of relay huts for gate signaling at all non-interlocked level crossing (16 nos.) having TVU>10000 at remaining LC gates of Agra Division.

SN : 2 Tender No.: 2026-April-03-02 Approx Cost Rs.: 52074897.50
Description of Work : Raising of platform, no 1 & 2/3 to high level for recruitment of shortfall in Minimum Essential Amenities (MEA) at Udi More station.

SN : 3 Tender No.: 2026-April-03-03 Approx Cost Rs.: 16998274.00
Description of Work : Provision of Side Sheet, grouting to prevent seepage of water at Various LHS in AGC-DHO section.

For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **"www.ireps.gov.in"** Tenders can only be submitted through web portal **"www.ireps.gov.in"** up to 15:00 hrs on 30.04.2026. **778/26 (D)**

North central railways @ CPRONCR @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Works) (N. C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.: JHS-ENGG-C-2026-70
Description of Work: Improvement to staff quarters in jhuli railway colony & provision of water supply arrangements under ADEN/CNB jurisdiction.

Approx Cost (Rs.): ₹ 45950451.68 Earnest Money (Rs.): ₹ 9190000.00

Date of Closing Tender: 04.05.2026 at 15:00 hrs.
Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 12 Months

E-Tender No.: JHS-ENGG-C-2026-71
Description of Work: Bina Jhansi: Construction of 8 units Type III new quarters for supervisors at BPW, MXZ, KOA & AGD station under ADEN/Lalitpur jurisdiction.

Approx Cost (Rs.): ₹ 25256974.65 Earnest Money (Rs.): ₹ 505100.00

Date of Closing Tender: 04.05.2026 at 15:00 hrs.
Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 12 Months

● Tender on line can be submitted upto to 15:00 hrs. on 04.05.2026.
● For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in**. **767/26 (A)**

North central railways @ CPRONCR @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE No. : T-02-N-2026-27 Date : 08.04.2026

E-Tender Notice

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (General) (N. C. Railway, Agra on behalf of President of India invites "Open Tender" through on line only (E-Tendering) for the following works.

Tender No. : T-02-N-2026-27 Approx. Cost of the work : Rs. 4178637.17

Name of work with its location & Completion Period : Electrification work in connection with Provision of OHT at various station (DHO-225KL & 50KL, BHA-110KL, JJ-225KL, SSDT-110KL, HAB-110KL) in colony premises with pipeline arrangements.

Completion period : 08 months.

For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in** Tenders can only be submitted through web portal **www.ireps.gov.in** up to 15:00 hrs on 30.04.2026 **777/26 (C)**

North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
(See Section 82 Cr. PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Abhishek Thompson R/o DSP Merili Lynch Upper Ground Floor Gopal Das Bhawan Connaught Place New Delhi Also at C-302, Ashiana Apartment Mayur Vihar Delhi & Also at Flat No.1701, Type-3 Floor 16, Elite Golf Green Tower F Plot SC-01/D4, Sector 09 Noida U.P.** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CC No. 292/2021 U/s 138 NI Act at PS: Punjabi Bagh, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Abhishek Thompson** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Abhishek Thompson** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Abhishek Thompson** of **CC No. 292/2021 U/s 138 NI Act of PS: Punjabi Bagh, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **20.05.2026**. By order

Gaurav Singal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-06
West Distt Room No. 355,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/4458/WD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Prakash, S/o: Subhash, R/o: Present Address: Footpath Nanak Pyau Gurudwara, Delhi; Permanent Address: Jhuggi Som Bazar, Haiderpur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 000668/2021 U/s 411/34 IPC, P.S.: Roop Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Prakash** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Prakash** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Prakash** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 000668/2021 U/s 411/34 IPC, P.S.: Roop Nagar, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.05.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Rashi Raheja
Judicial Magistrate First Class-13 (Central)
Room No. 33, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/4560/N/2026
(Court Matter)

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
SH. BAWANDEEP SINGH
Civil Judge (Junior Division)
Samalkha
maya
Vs.
General Public
CS 115/2025
CNR No. HRPAA-000147-2025
Next Date 20-05-2026

PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
1. General Public, Panipat
2. Somdutt s/o kishan chand previously resident of village shilma gujan Tehsil Bapoli Panipat (present whereabouts not known since not heard for the last more than 9 years)
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **20-05-2026 at 10:00 am.**
For details logon to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=district> notice & district = Panipat

Sd/- SH. BAWANDEEP SINGH
Civil Judge (Junior Division)
Dated 09.04-2026 Samalkha

Before Debts Recovery Tribunal-II, Delhi
4th Floor, Jeevan Tara Building, Parliament Street, New Delhi-110001

Notice under section 19(4) of the Recovery of Debts Due to Bank and Financial Institutions Act, 1993 read with Rule 12 & 13 of the Debts Recovery Tribunal (Procedure Rule) 1993) in the matter of **OA No 469/2025** DATE: 27.01.2026
PUNJAB NATIONAL BANK .APPLICANT VERSUS
M/S ARYA INFRAHEIGHT .RESPONDENT
PVT LTD & ORS.

To, DEFENDANT
(1) ARYAN INFRAHEIGHT PRIVATE LIMITED PLOT NO 27 BLOCK B 1ST FLOOR SECTOR 64 B NAGAR NOIDA UP ALSO AT SHED NO 1 RAO LAL SINGH MKT OPPOSITE MUNJAL SHOWA COURT SECTOR 18 VILL SARHAUL HRY - 122015 ALSO AT H-14/16 MALVIYA NAGAR NEW DELHI ALSO AT FLAT NO B-1/302 3RD FLOOR KH NO 558 MAJIA CHAUMHAN AMRAPALI KANHA APARTMENT TEHSIL CHHATA DISTT MATHURA UP 281001
(2) PRABHAT KUMAR AA 201 AMRAPALI TITANIUM PLATINUM NEAR TRIPATHI HOSPITAL SECTOR 119 NOIDA GAUTAM BUDDHA NAGAR-201301 GAUTAM BUDDHA NAGAR, UTTAR PRADESH-201301
(3) TANU PRABHA A 201 AMRAPALI TITANIUM PLATINUM NEAR TRIPATHI HOSPITAL SECTOR 119 NOIDA GAUTAM BUDDHA NAGAR-201301 GAUTAM BUDDHA NAGAR, UTTAR PRADESH-201301

Whereas the above named applicant(s) has / have instituted a case for recovery of **Rs. 2,64,40,935.64/- (RUPEE TWO CRORES SIXTY FOUR LAKH FORTY THOUSAND NINE HUNDRED THIRTY FIVE AND SIXTY FOUR PAISE ONLY)** against you and where as it has been shown to the satisfaction of the Tribunal that it is not possible to serve you in the ordinary way therefore, this notice is given by advertisement directing you to make appearance in the Tribunal on **09.07.2026** At 11:00 A.M.
Take notice that in default of your appearance on the day before the mentioned, the case will be heard and determined in your absence. **All the matters will be taken up through Video Conferencing or Physical and for that purpose:**
(i) All the Advocates/Litigants shall download the "Cisco Webex" application/ software;
(ii) "Meeting ID" and Password for the date of hearing qua cases to be taken by Hon'ble Presiding officer/Registrar shall be displayed in the daily case list itself at DRT Official Portal <http://drt.gov.in>.
(iii) In any exigency which the Advocate/ Litigants can contact the concerned official at **Ph. No. 23748478**.
Given under my hand and seal of the Tribunal this 27th day of Jan, 2026
BY ORDER OF THE TRIBUNAL
SECTION OFFICER, DRT-II, DELHI

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF M/s. Aashima Garg
Civil Judge (Junior Division),
BAHADURGARH
Raj Bala
Vs.
General Public
CASE NO. CS/135/2026
CNR No. HIRJAO-000189-2026
Next Date 12-05-2026

PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
General Public
:-
INDIA
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **12-05-2026 at 10:00 am.**
For details logon to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=district> notice & district = Jhajjar
Sd/- M/s. Aashima Garg
Civil Judge (Junior Division)
dated 09-04-2026 **BAHADURGARH**

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
T. Notice No. 230-Elect/TRD/PRY/JE-Tender Notice/2026/627 Date : 08.04.2026

E-Tender Notice

Sr. Divl. Electrical Engineer/TRD/N.C. Rly/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tender, the details of the tenders are as under:-

T. No. : 230-TRD-WC-1016-2026	Advertised value : Rs. 1,04,23,859.95
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Description of work : 25kV OHE Modification work due to raising of platform at Rasulabad (RUB), Kurasti Kalan (KKS), Malwan (MVH), Kanspur Gugauli (KSQ) and Kanwar (KUJ) stations of Prayagraj Division.

Bid Security : Rs. 2,08,500.00 Completion Period : 18 Months

Bidding system : Single Packet Tender Closing date & time : 30.04.2026 & 14:00 Hrs
Tender opening date & Time : 30.04.2026 & 15:00 Hrs

Note :- 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders shall be available on Website **www.ireps.gov.in** 21 days prior to the date of opening of the tender. 2. Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate. 3. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. **769/26 (C)**

North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR



ABHISHEK BANERJEE ON STOLEN'S
WIN AT CHETAK SCREEN AWARDS

'A big victory for independent filmmakers'

'I didn't know it will see the light of the day,' said the actor

On April 5, at the Chetak Screen Awards, *Stolen*, starring Abhishek Banerjee, emerged as one of the biggest winners in the OTT category, taking home four major honours - 'Best OTT Film', 'Best Director' for Karan Tejpal, 'Best Actor (Male)' for Banerjee and 'Best Script'. For the casting director-turned-actor, the film's success is more than just a win - it's a validation of independent filmmaking driven purely by passion, often without any certainty about its future. Reflecting on the win, Abhishek Banerjee told SCREEN, "I think there is an immense level of satisfaction because when you work hard without knowing the future. I think that's the extreme amount of passion anybody can put into any project. When you are doing a film from an ecosystem of Bollywood or the industry, you know it is going to release or come on OTT. But as an actor, when you do a film like 'Stolen', you don't know if it is ever going to see the light of the day." He further added, "You are just taking a part. You are listening to the instinct and you are believing people whom you have never met. I think this whole experience of being able to do a film with completely unknown people and then making them your closest friend in life and then thriving like this in one of the oldest, legendary and credible award shows. I think it is a big win for all independent filmmakers. All youngsters. This shows that no

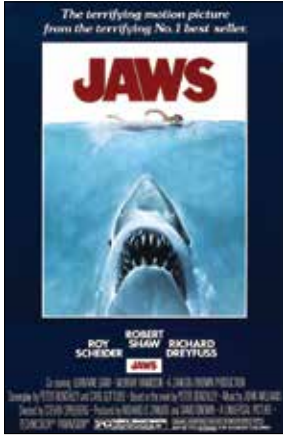


Abhishek also opened up about his versatility across genres

matter where you are from, if you make a good film, you will get all the glitz and glamour attached to it." Abhishek also opened up about his versatility across genres - from making audiences laugh as Jaana in 'Stree', to leaving them unsettled as Vishal Tyagi in 'Pataal Lok', to portraying a tragic, vulnerable character in 'Stolen'. While he initially quipped, "I have multiple personality disorder," he went on to explain, "I simply believe that we humans have all sorts of characteristics in us. It's just that we don't use it in day-to-day life and as actors, we are trained to evoke those emotions through our skill set. There is no extraordinary talent. It is years of practice that make you an actor."

'Jaws' returning to big screen in India

Steven Spielberg's film set the benchmark for the Hollywood summer blockbuster



A 4k restored version of Steven Spielberg's 1975 classic 'Jaws' will be re-released in select theatres at PVR INOX on April 17, the cinema chain announced.

Considered one of the defining genre films in cinema history, 'Jaws' set the benchmark for the Hollywood summer blockbuster. Five decades later, the film continues to hold a special place in popular culture with its story of a killer shark terrorising a beach town during the July 4th holidays.

The film, still remembered for its masterful storytelling, score and edge-of-the-seat tension, was the highest-grossing film upon its release, a record that was broken by 'Star Wars' two years later.

With its return in 4K restoration, 'Jaws' regains its intended visual and sonic depth. The vastness of the open sea, the subtle tension of its unseen menace and its iconic sound design come alive with renewed clarity, offering audiences a rare opportunity to engage with the film as it was originally envisioned, PVR INOX said in a release here.

The re-release is part of PVR INOX's ongoing re-release strategy to bring back iconic films on the big screen. 'Jaws' is also part of 'Auteurs Curation' at PVR INOX, an initiative celebrating filmmakers who have shaped the language of cinema.

The film was the highest-grossing film upon its release

From Anurag Kashyap's 'Dev D' to Steven Spielberg's 'Jaws', the line-up will feature several landmark titles, with more announcements to follow in the coming weeks.

Niharika Bijli, Lead Strategist, PVR INOX Limited, said, "We are constantly looking at ways to enrich our programming. The return of 'Jaws' is a testament to the growing audience's appetite for immersive, high-impact storytelling. It's a film that comes alive in a theatre, where sound, scale and shared anticipation elevate the experience," she said.

Spielberg's 'Jaws' was based on the 1974 novel by Peter Benchley and featured Roy Scheider as police chief Martin Brody, who teams up with marine biologist (Richard Dreyfuss) and a professional shark hunter (Robert Shaw) to hunt a man-eating great white shark that attacks beachgoers at a New England summer resort town.

Benchley and Carl Gottlieb wrote the script.

Jenna Ortega nearly gave up acting

Wednesday star Jenna Ortega revealed she seriously considered walking away from acting after her children's show 'Stuck in the Middle' ended, saying a role in Netflix's thriller series 'You' convinced her to stay. Speaking on rapper Kid Cudi's 'Big Bro' podcast, Ortega said she felt lost after wrapping up the 'Disney' series and faced the challenge of re-establishing herself with a new set of casting directors. "I didn't know what else I was gonna do. I've never really considered anything else, more so recently, just out of curiosity and wanting another life experience. But when I was a teenager, I'd gotten off a children's show and I didn't know what I was going to do. I had to prove myself and meet all these new casting directors who didn't know who I was," she said.

Ortega said the decision to quit was actively discussed

Ortega leads Netflix's 'Wednesday', the adaptation of the popular cartoon 'Addams Family'

with her team before a booking changed everything. In 2019, she landed the role of Ellie Alves, Joe Goldberg's downstairs neighbour, played by Penn Badgley, in the second season of 'You'. "It just felt like a good time to call it quits if I was going to. I was starting high school and 'it was a good run' sort of thing. We talked about it for a few months with my team. Then I booked that show 'You' and went on that set. I loved it and had the best time. I thought, 'Yeah, there's no way I could let this go,'" she said.

The role proved to be a turning point. She has since starred in films such as 'X', 'Scream VI', 'Beetlejuice Beetlejuice' and 'Death of a Unicorn' and leads Netflix's 'Wednesday', the adaptation of the popular cartoon 'Addams Family'.

'Happy to represent older women on-screen'

Hollywood star Meryl Streep said she is happy to represent older women in leading roles ahead of the release of her upcoming film 'The Devil Wears Prada 2'. The '20th Century Studios' film is a sequel to the 2006 hit film 'The Devil Wears Prada' and will also feature Anne Hathaway and Emily Blunt, who are set to reprise their roles.

Streep, known for her acclaimed performances in several projects across the years, including 'Kramer vs Kramer' and 'Out of Africa', said women over 50 'disappear into the wood-work'.

"I do think that there's something in this one that's unusual, because you don't see many 70-, almost 77-year-old women playing parts like this in any movie or under any circumstance... So, I'm happy to represent, you know," she said in a video 'The Associated Press' shared on 'Instagram'. She added, "Often women over 50, I'd say, disappear into the woodwork... Their interests and opinions are less valued in our culture, so it's fun to see this person who is credibly placed in the



Meryl Streep will be seen in her upcoming film 'The Devil Wears Prada 2'

world and having that influence." The first film revolved around Andy Sachs (Hathaway), a smart but fashion-clueless journalism graduate who moves to New York City with dreams of becoming a serious writer. Desperate for work, she lands a job as a junior personal assistant to Miranda Priestly, the cold and tyrannical editor-in-chief of the elite fashion magazine Runway. "The Devil Wears Prada 2" is directed by David Frankel and written by Aline Brosh McKenna. It also features Stanley Tucci and is scheduled for release on May 1.

Siddharth gets candid about performing high-risk action

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Kaptaan has hit 'Amazon MX Player' with the kind of raw intensity that makes crime dramas stick and a big part of that comes from Siddharth Nigam's fully committed turn as Kabir. Set against the volatile backdrop of Jwalabad, where power is defined by control and every decision has far-reaching consequences, the series puts Saqib Saleem's SSP Samardeep against Siddharth Nigam's Kabir in a world of organised crime, personal vendettas and an escalating battle for dominance.



What stands out most about Nigam's character is how physically present he feels in every frame

What stands out most about Siddharth Nigam's character is how physically present he feels in every frame and that's because he went all in on the action. Opening up about performing high-risk sequences, he shared, "I performed all my action sequences myself, from jumping off heights of around 20 feet to executing

continuous one-shot action scenes. There were moments where I even got injured, but for me, that's part of the process when you're fully committed to the character. The intention was always to make the action feel authentic, so that the audience doesn't just see it, but actually experiences it with Kabir." Siddharth also spoke about his experience working with Saqib and the entire cast, adding, "Saqib bhai is extremely supportive and brought a very positive energy on set, which made it easier for everyone to perform more freely."

'Every film has been hard work'

Saqib Saleem said success in the Hindi film industry doesn't always lead to more work

Saqib Saleem said success in the Hindi film industry doesn't always lead to more work, something he has experienced firsthand despite earning acclaim for projects like '83', 'Rangbaaz' and 'Citadel'. The 38-year-old actor calls himself a searcher who is always looking for the right opportunity. "There's so much work happening. There is OTT and theatrical; you have to find the right fit for yourself. Not every project that is happening is for you. So, I'm a searcher. I keep roaming around. And it's not as glamorous as it looks. I've been appreciated for all my work, but every project and film has been hard work.

Nothing comes easy here. It's not like that 'he was in '83' or performed well in 'Citadel', so let's offer him work. That's not the case. This business is very different from every

The 38-year-old actor calls himself a searcher who is always looking for the right opportunity



The actor made his debut with the 2011 hit 'Mujhse Fraaandship Karoge' and followed it up with successful releases such as 'Mere Dad Ki Maruti', 'Bombay Talkies', 'Dishoom' and 'Hawaa Hawaa'. He also earned significant praise for his work in OTT series such

as 'Rangbaaz', 'Crackdown' and 'Citadel'. Saleem said he values his early success, particularly when critic Taran Adarsh called him the 'find of the year'. However, the negative reception of 2018's 'Race 3' served as a turning point. "I realised that going forward I should do roles that I like and even the audiences. But I never regret doing anything. And 'Race' has been a great learning experience for me, having worked with such legendary actors. I realised that I have to carve my own journey and figure out what I want to do and not because your agency told you to do this film, because it'll be good."

